Logic Notes

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Chapter 1

Introduction and Definable Sets

1.1 Introduction

In this class, we will explore techniques that let us apply logic, and model theory in particular, to everyday mathematics. Let's start in a context that should already be familiar, and will only become moreso: structures in the language of ordered rings.

This is centainly an everyday mathematical context. Structures in the language $\{0, 1, +, \times, \leq\}$ include $\mathbb{N}, \mathbb{Z}, \mathbb{Q}, \mathbb{R}$. But what can we actually say about these ordered rings (or in the case of $\mathbb{N}$, a semiring) just using first-order logic in this language?

At the most basic level, we can ask which sentences these different structures satisfy. It's a pretty straightforward exercise to determine that these structures differ already at that level.

Exercise 1.1.1. For each pair of structures in the list $\mathbb{N}, \mathbb{Z}, \mathbb{Q}, \mathbb{R}$, find a sentence that one satisfies, while the other does not.

Meanwhile, if we change the language by dropping multiplication (or down to just $\leq$), we find that in the languages of linear orders $\{\leq\}$ and of ordered (semi)groups $\{0, +, \leq\}$, we can distinguish $\mathbb{N}$ from $\mathbb{Z}$ from $\mathbb{Q}$ and $\mathbb{R}$, but $\mathbb{Q}$ and $\mathbb{R}$ satisfy exactly the same sentences.

Definition 1.1.2. Given a language $\mathcal{L}$ and an $\mathcal{L}$-structure $\mathcal{M}$, let $\mathsf{Th}(\mathcal{M})$ (the *complete theory of* $\mathcal{M}$) denote the set of all $\mathcal{L}$-sentences ϕ such that $\mathcal{M} \vDash \phi$.
Given $\mathcal{L}$-structures $\mathcal{M}$ and $\mathcal{N}$, say that they are *elementarily equivalent*, denoted $\mathcal{M} \equiv \mathcal{N}$, when $\mathsf{Th}(\mathcal{M}) = \mathsf{Th}(\mathcal{N})$. That is, when for each sentence ϕ, $\mathcal{M} \vDash \phi \iff \mathcal{N} \vDash \phi$.

To show that $\mathbb{Q}$ and $\mathbb{R}$ are elementarily equivalent in either of the above languages, we use the same strategy: find an easily-axiomatized complete theory that they both model.

Lemma 1.1.3. *If T is a complete theory, and $\mathcal{M} \vDash T$, then $\mathsf{Th}(\mathcal{M})$ is the set of all consequences of T. Thus if $\mathcal{M}, \mathcal{N} \vDash T$, $\mathcal{M} \equiv \mathcal{N}$.*

In the case of the language of linear orders, the theory they both model and its completeness may be familiar from 5700:

Fact 1.1.4. *There is a complete theory* DLO *(dense linear orders) in the language* $\{\leq\}$ *of linear orders whose models include* $\mathbb{Q}$ *and* $\mathbb{R}$*.*

In the language of ordered groups, things get a little trickier. We will prove the following in this class.

Fact 1.1.5. *There is a complete theory* ODAG *(ordered divisible abelian groups) in the language* $\{0, +, \leq\}$ *of ordered groups whose models include* $\mathbb{Q}$ *and* $\mathbb{R}$*.*

In the rest of this class, we will not care too much about specific structures - we will care more about their complete theories. We will develop tools for proving completeness of such theories, for classifying them based on complexity, and for evaluating formulas and sentences modulo these theories.

We will find that some theories are inherently difficult to understand, because of Gödelian phenomena you have seen in 5700, while others are actually very nice!

Incompleteness gives us some contrived examples of difficult-to-resolve sentences in the structure $(\mathbb{N}; 0, 1, +, \times, \leq)$. Historically, a huge fraction of mathematical effort has been spent trying to resolve the truth of sentences in this structure. To state these, recall that there is a formula in this structure that determines whether a number is prime:

$$\mathsf{Prime}(x) := 1 < x \wedge \forall y, \forall z, (y \times z = x) \to (y = 1 \vee z = 1).$$

Given this, we can state the following sentences:

The Twin Primes Conjecture: $\forall n, \exists p, n \leq p \wedge \mathsf{Prime}(p) \wedge \mathsf{Prime}(p+2)$

The Goldbach Conjecture: $\forall n, 1 < n \to \exists p, \exists q, \mathsf{Prime}(p) \wedge \mathsf{Prime}(q) \wedge p + q = n + n.$

We can view this as a consequence of the *definable set* of primes being somewhat complicated, and the extra quantifiers $(\forall, \exists)$ applied to make it into these sentences drives the complexity higher.

Meanwhile, in $(\mathbb{R}; 0, 1, +, \times, \leq)$, the story is very different. Consider the set in $\mathbb{R}^3$ defined by the formula

$$\phi(a, b, c) \iff \exists x, ax^2 + bx + c = 0.$$

We find that $\phi(a, b, c)$ is equivalent to

$$(a \neq 0 \wedge b^2 - 4ac \geq 0) \vee (a = 0 \wedge (b \neq 0 \vee c = 0)).$$

To evaluate this, we only need to perform a handful of algebraic operations, checks of equality, and boolean operations.

We will find finitely-axiomatized and decidable complete theories, where all of the "paradoxes" of incompleteness are irrelevant. In order to determine which *sentences* are true in a given theory, we will want to find out how to evaluate all formulas, including those with free variables. The main way we will do this is by *eliminating quantifiers*, allowing us to turn the complexity of first-order logic into something tractable, and much closer to propositional logic.

Furthermore, these nice theories come in a variety of different flavors - it is easy to work with vector spaces over a field, and it is easy to work with algebra over the real numbers, but for somewhat different reasons. These subtleties will come out when we look at the combinatorics inherent in these structures.

For all of these purposes, we need to understand formulas, not only syntactically, but semantically in terms of the sets they define.

1.2 Definability

Definition 1.2.1. Let $\mathcal{M}$ be an $\mathcal{L}$-structure, and let $A \subseteq M$. Then a set $D \subseteq M^n$ is called *A-definable* when there is a formula $\phi(\bar{x}; \bar{y}) = \phi(x_1, \ldots, x_n, y_1, \ldots, y_m)$ and parameters $\bar{b} \in A^m$ such that for all $\bar{a} \in M^n$, $\bar{a} \in D \iff \mathcal{M} \vDash \phi(\bar{a}; \bar{b})$.

For some basic examples, let's look at the language $\{0, 1, +, \times\}$ of (semi)rings. We will see that in each of the structures $\mathbb{N}, \mathbb{Z}, \mathbb{Q}, \mathbb{R}$, the set $\{(x, y) : x \leq y\}$ is definable.

This is easy for $\mathbb{N}$: $\exists z, y = x + z$.

This is almost as easy for $\mathbb{R}$: $\exists z, y = x + z^2$.

For $\mathbb{Z}$ and $\mathbb{Q}$, we have to use Lagrange's Four-Square Theorem: Every $n \in \mathbb{Z}$ with $n \geq 0$ can be written as the sum of four perfect squares. Thus for $\mathbb{Z}$, we can use

$$\exists z_1, z_2, z_3, z_4, y = x + z_1^2 + z_2^2 + z_3^2 + z_4^2.$$

This will actually also work in $\mathbb{Q}$ - exercise if you want!

This means that in each of these structures, everything definable in the language $\{0, 1, +, \times, \leq\}$ is already definable without the symbol $\leq$. That's because if there's a formula $\phi(x; y)$ in the ring language equivalent to $x \leq y$, we can just replace every instance of $t_1 \leq t_2$ with $\phi(t_1; t_2)$.

This is an instance of an *expansion by definitions*, which is where we add a symbol whose interpretation is already definable to the language. This does not change the definable sets.

Another example of expansion by definition is in arithmetic. In $(\mathbb{N}; 0, 1, +, \times, \leq)$, the exponentiation operation is definable, so we frequently add it to the language for convenience.

1.2.1 Undefinability

It can be harder to show that sets are *not* definable, but this is just as informative.

In the realm of arithmetic, we will be able to show undefinability by diagonalization:

Fact 1.2.2 (Tarski's Undefinability of Truth (Simple Version))**.** *The set*

$$\{\ulcorner\phi\urcorner : \phi \textit{ is a sentence such that } (\mathbb{N}; 0, 1, +, \times, \leq) \vDash \phi\}$$

of natural numbers is not definable in $(\mathbb{N}; 0, 1, +, \times, \leq)$.

Other structures that model theorists prefer tend to lack the expressive power to even do this diagonalization proof. In these cases, we will be able to place limits on definability by proving structural theorems about definable sets.

This starts by proving *quantifier elimination* in an appropriate language. That is, we will show that, after possibly expanding by definitions a little bit, every formula is equivalent to one that can be written without $\forall$ or $\exists$. This is true, for instance, in the familiar structures

$$\begin{aligned}
&(\mathbb{Q}, <)\\
&(\mathbb{R}, <)\\
&(\mathbb{Z}, 0, +, \leq)\\
&(\mathbb{C}, 0, 1, +, \times)\\
&(\mathbb{R}, 0, 1, +, \times, \leq),
\end{aligned}$$

as we will show.

Because formulas without quantifiers are much easier to study, quantifier elimination will allow us to characterize definable sets quite easily. For instance, over the complex numbers (or any other algebraically closed field):

Fact 1.2.3. *The quantifier-free definable sets (with parameters) in* $(\mathbb{C}; 0, 1, +, \times)$ *are exactly the* constructible *sets - that is, boolean combinations of zerosets of polynomials with coefficients in* $\mathbb{C}$.

Once we characterize definable sets in this way, we can start proving more interesting properties of definable sets, and easily show that other sets are not definable. Staying with the algebraically closed field example:

Corollary 1.2.4. *The structure* $(\mathbb{C}; 0, 1, +, \times)$ *is* strongly minimal*: any definable subset of* $\mathbb{C}$ *(in one dimension) is either finite or cofinite.*

Proof. Zerosets of polynomials are either finite or cofinite, and any boolean combination of finite and cofinite sets is also finite or cofinite. □

Corollary 1.2.5. *There is no definable linear order on* $\mathbb{C}$*. In fact,* $\mathbb{C}$ *is stable - there cannot be an infinite linear order* I*, sequences* $(a_i, b_i : i \in I)$ *with* $a_i \in \mathbb{C}^m, b_i \in \mathbb{C}^n$ *and a formula* $\phi(x, y)$*, even with parameters, such that*

$$i \leq j \iff \mathbb{C} \vDash \phi(a_i, b_j).$$

1.3 Overview

Our first objective in this course is to build up a library of easy-to-understand structures. We will start with countable structures we can explicitly construct from finite structures: *Fraïssé limits*. These include structures such as $(\mathbb{Q}, <)$, the random graph, and the countable atomless Boolean algebra. We will learn how to show completeness, $\aleph_0$-categoricity, and then quantifier elimination, for theories of Fraïssé limits, building on the back-and-forth technique mentioned in 5700.

We will then develop a more comprehensive toolkit for showing quantifier elimination in more complicated structures, such as algebraically closed and real closed fields, at which point we can really begin applying model theory to these structures.

Once we have seen how simple definable sets can be, we will contrast with how *complicated* they can be when we don't have quantifier elimination, such as in arithmetic.

We will also review compactness somewhere around here, including a semantic proof featuring the ultraproduct construction.

Then we will pick up the story of definable sets in specifically *ordered* structures such as $(\mathbb{R}; 0, 1, +, \times, \leq)$. We will see how *o-minimality*: the simplest case for *one-dimensional* definable sets in an ordered structure, implies a powerful structural theorem (the *cell decomposition theorem*) for definable sets in all dimensions, even without quantifier elimination. This will let us work with structures such as $\mathbb{R}_{\text{an,exp}}$, which at the moment is the most fruitful context for applying model theory to other branches of math.

We then have some choices for where to go next. Some of my ideas include the following:

- Dimension theory, and in particular, pregeometries/matroids, in strongly minimal and o-minimal structures

- Incidence combinatorics and distal cell decompositions (the combinatorics of definable sets over $(\mathbb{R}; 0, 1, +, \times, \leq)$)
- NIP, VC-dimension and connections with statistical learning theory.

Please let me know if you have preferences about what you'd like me to cover.

If I *don't* get to cover what you want, I have good news: you can cover it yourself! For students enrolled in graduate class course numbers (perhaps we will change the exact mechanism, but certainly for graduate students who want to), there is a presentation option for grading in this class, requiring one (or possibly two if time allows) 45-minute presentations. I have a list of suggested papers for presenting on the course website, and will add to it over time.

Chapter 2

Fraïssé Limits

2.1 Fraïssé Classes

Before we get into the weeds of model theory, we should spend some time developing a library of examples. These can include famous structures, like the algebraic ones we have seen so far, but should also include complete theories.

We will start with a method for constructing particularly nice countable structures, called *Fraïssé limits*. These are constructed as limits of families of finite substructures. To ground *this* construction in an example to start, recall dense linear orders from 5700:

Fact 2.1.1. *Let* $\mathcal{L}_< = \{<\}$.
The $\mathcal{L}_<$*-theory of* dense linear orders without endpoints*, abbreviated* DLO*, is complete,* $\aleph_0$*-categorical, and* $(\mathbb{Q}, <) \vDash \mathsf{DLO}$.

To generate a structure like $(\mathbb{Q}, <)$, we start by looking at its finite substructures.

Definition 2.1.2. If $\mathcal{L}$ is a relational language (that is, has no function symbols), and $\mathcal{M}$ is an $\mathcal{L}$-structure, let $\mathsf{Age}(\mathcal{M})$ be the class of all $\mathcal{L}$-structures isomorphic to a finite substructure of $\mathcal{M}$.

As described, the age is a proper class. If you don't like this, you can use the set of *isomorphism types* of finite substructures of $\mathcal{M}$ instead.

Example 2.1.3. $\mathsf{Age}(\mathbb{Q}, <)$ consists of all finite linear orders.

Proof. Any finite linear order is isomorphic to any other finite linear order of the same cardinality, and for every finite cardinality n, $(\mathbb{Q}, <)$ contains a finite subset, and thus a finite substructure which is a linear order, of cardinality n. Also, any structure in $\mathsf{Age}(\mathbb{Q}, <)$ must be isomorphic to a finite substructure, and thus must be a finite linear order. □

We can make a few observations about the class of all finite linear orders, which we will describe as properties:

Example 2.1.4. Let $\mathcal{K}$ be the class of all finite linear orders.

- **Essential Countability (EC):** Up to isomorphism, there are only countably many structures in $\mathcal{K}$.
- **Hereditary Property (HP):** If $A \in \mathcal{K}$, and B is a finite substructure of A, then $B \in \mathcal{K}$.
- **Joint Embedding Property (JEP):** If $A, B \in \mathcal{K}$, then there is some $C \in \mathcal{K}$ into which both A and B embed.
- **Amalgamation Property (AP):** If $A, B_1, B_2 \in \mathcal{K}$, and there are embeddings $f_i : A \hookrightarrow B_i$, then there is $C \in \mathcal{K}$ with embeddings $g_i : B_i \hookrightarrow C$ such that $g_1 \circ f_1 = g_2 \circ f_2$, making the following diagram commute:

$$\begin{tikzcd}
 & C & \\
B_1 \arrow[ur, "g_1"] & & B_2 \arrow[ul, "g_2"'] \\
 & A \arrow[ul, "f_1"] \arrow[ur, "f_2"'] &
\end{tikzcd}$$

In fact, the first three of these hold for the age of *any* countable structure.

Proof. We will prove the first three for $\mathsf{Age}(\mathcal{M})$ where $\mathcal{M}$ is an arbitrary countable structure.

- **EC:** A countable structure has only countably many finite subsets, and thus countably many finite substructures.
- **HP:** Any finite substructure of a finite substructure of $\mathcal{M}$ is also a finite substructure of $\mathcal{M}$.
- **JEP:** If A, B are finite substructures of $\mathcal{M}$, then (in a relational language) $A \cup B$ is also a finite substructure, into which both embed.
- **AP:** This one we're only proving for $\mathcal{K} = \mathsf{Age}(\mathbb{Q}, <)$. Enumerate A as $a_1 < a_2 < \cdots < a_n$. Then to define C, we will place elements in the gaps between elements of A. To extend the embedding f_1, we need to make sure that there are at least as many elements of C between a_i, a_{i+1}, as there are in B_1 between $f_1(a_i)$ and $f_1(a_{i+1})$, and similarly for f_2.

□

Definition 2.1.5. When $\mathcal{L}$ is a finite relational language, we call any class $\mathcal{K}$ of finite $\mathcal{L}$-structures a *Fraïssé class* when it satisfies EC, HP, JEP, and AP.

We now turn to another familiar example of a Fraïssë class of finite structures: all finite graphs.

Theorem 2.1.6. *The class of all finite graphs is a Fraïssë class.*

Proof.
- **EC:** For any n, there are finitely many graphs on n vertices up to isomorphism, so there are countably many when we union over all $n \in \mathbb{N}$.

- **HP:** A substructure of a graph is a graph.
- **JEP:** We can just put the two graphs next to each other, and choose arbitrarily whether to put edges between the two graphs.
- **AP:** If A embeds into B_1 and B_2, then we can add both sets of vertices $B_1 \setminus A$ and $B_2 \setminus A$ to A. We know which edges we need between elements of A and B_i, and can choose what edges to put between B_1 and B_2 arbitrarily.

□

These are the two most canonical examples - there are others, but many of those require adding function symbols into the language, which makes things a little more complicated. This complicates the definitions slightly, but the idea of everything we do can be extended to that with a few more assumptions.

Exercise 2.1.7. Show that the class of all finite *triangle-free* graphs is a Fraïssé class.

2.2 Fraïssé Limits

Now that we've noticed that $(\mathbb{Q}, <)$ is a countable structure whose age is a Fraïssé class, I can explain why this structure is special. After all, $(\mathbb{N}, <)$ and $(\mathbb{Z}, <)$ are also countable linear orders with the same age, but their theories are not $\aleph_0$-categorical.

The critical idea is *homogeneity*:

Definition 2.2.1. Call a structure $\mathcal{M}$ *ultrahomogeneous* when for any finite substructures A, B of $\mathcal{M}$ and an isomorphism $f : A \to B$, there is an isomorphism $g : M \to M$ that extends f.
If $\mathcal{L}$ is a relational language, $\mathcal{K}$ is a class of finite $\mathcal{L}$-structures, and $\mathcal{M}$ is a countably infinite ultrahomogeneous $\mathcal{L}$-structure whose age is $\mathcal{K}$, we call $\mathcal{M}$ a *Fraïssé limit* of $\mathcal{K}$.

Example 2.2.2. It is not hard to check that $(\mathbb{Q}, <)$ is ultrahomogeneous, and thus a Fraïssé limit for the class of finite linear orders.

We can start to connect Fraïssé limits to Fraïssé classes:

Theorem 2.2.3. *If $\mathcal{K}$ is a class of finite structures in a relational language with a Fraïssé limit $\mathcal{M}$, then $\mathcal{K}$ is a Fraïssé class.*

Proof. Because $\mathcal{K} = \mathsf{Age}(\mathcal{M})$, it must satisfy **EC**, **HP**, and **JEP**, so we just need to check **AP**. Suppose A, B_1, B_2 are isomorphic to finite substructures of $\mathcal{M}$, and $f_i : A \to B_i$ are embeddings. We can assume (up to an isomorphism of everything involved) that A, B_1, B_2 are actual substructures of $\mathcal{M}$, and that f_1 is the inclusion map of A into B_1, but we can't simultaneously assume that A is a substructure of B_2, or that f_2 is an inclusion.
We can view f_2 as an isomorphism from A to its image, a substructure of B_2, and by ultrahomogeneity, we can let $h : M \to M$ be an automorphism extending f_2. Then $h^{-1} \circ f_2$ is the inclusion map of A into M, and its image is contained in $h^{-1}(B_2)$. We now let C be a finite substructure containing both B_1 and $h^{-1}(B_2)$. We then let $g_1 : B_1 \hookrightarrow C$ be the inclusion map, and let $g_2 : B_2 \hookrightarrow C$ be the inclusion map ι composed with the restriction of h^{-1} to B_2. Then $g_1 \circ f_1$ is the inclusion map of A into C, while in $g_2 \circ f_2$, the restriction of h^{-1} to B_2 cancels with

f_2 to form another inclusion map, giving us the same map in the end. □

Meanwhile, to check that something is a Fraïssé limit, we can check homogeneity step-by-step, in a back-and-forth procedure that may look familiar:

Lemma 2.2.4. *A countable structure $\mathcal{M}$ is ultrahomogeneous if and only if the following holds: For any isomorphism $f : A \to B$ of finite substructures of $\mathcal{M}$, and any finite substructure $A \subseteq C$, the isomorphism f extends to an isomorphism $g : C \to D$ of finite substructures.*

Proof. If $\mathcal{M}$ is ultrahomogeneous, then given $f : A \to B$ and C, we simply let $h : M \to M$ extend f, and then restrict h to C.
For the main direction, we're actually going to prove something a smidgen more general:

Lemma 2.2.5. *Suppose $\mathcal{M}, \mathcal{N}$ are countable structures such that for every isomorphism $f : A \to B$ of finite substructures $A \subset M, B \subset N$, and any finite substructure $A \subseteq C \subset M$, the isomorphism f extends to an isomorphism $g : C \to D \leq N$ of finite substructures, and the same holds with $\mathcal{M}, \mathcal{N}$ switched.*
Then f extends to an isomorphism $h : M \to N$.

All we need for ultrahomogeneity is to apply this to $N = M$.
Now assume $\mathcal{M}, \mathcal{N}$ has this property, and let $f : A \to B$ be an isomorphism of finite substructures. We can construct an isomorphism $h : M \to N$ extending f recursively, as the union of isomorphisms $f_k : A_k \to B_k$, each of which extends the last, where $\bigcup_k A_k = M$ and $\bigcup_k B_k = N$. Enumerate $M = \{m_0, m_1, \dots\}, N = \{n_0, n_1, \dots\}$. We start with $f_0 = f$. Then we recurse a bit differently in even and odd steps. Assuming we have defined $f_{2k} : A_{2k} \to B_{2k}$, we want to make sure that A_{2k+1} contains m_k, which in the long run, will ensure that $\bigcup_k A_k = M$. If $m_k \in A_{2k}$, we don't need to do anything. If not, then let A_{2k+1} be a finite substructure with $A_{2k} \cup \{m_k\} \subseteq A'$. By our assumption, we can then extend to an isomorphism $f : A_{2k+1} \to B_{2k+1}$. Now assuming we have $f_{2k+1} : A_{2k+1} \to B_{2k+1}$ defined, let's make sure that B_{2k+2} contains n_k, ensuring that $\bigcup_k B_k = N$. We pick B_{2k+2} containing $B_{2k+1} \cup \{n_k\}$, then we extend f_{2k+1}^{-1} to an isomorphism $B_{2k+2} \to A_{2k+2}$, whose inverse extends f_{2k+1}. □

2.3 Random Graphs

Let's advance our other example. We had another Fraïssé class, the class of finite graphs. Does this have a Fraïssé limit? If we have no idea how to build one, we may as well try to build it at random. Let's just take a countably infinite set of vertices, and for each pair of vertices, we'll flip a coin to determine whether there should be an edge.

This generates a random countably infinite graph - what's its age? For any finite graph A with n vertices, the probability of a given n vertices forming an isomorphic graph is going to be positive. In fact, it's at least $2^{-\binom{n}{2}}$, because that's the probability of each precise configuration of edges and non-edges. Just call it $p > 0$.

Then we can bound the probability that *no* set of n vertices in the infinite random graph is isomorphic to A. To simplify things, let's split the vertices into an infinite sequence of disjoint sets of n vertices. Then let E_k be the event that the kth set is isomorphic to A - this is p. Then the probability that *none* of these events happen is $\lim_{k\to\infty}(1-p)^k = 0$, so with probability 1, at least one of these events happens, so A is in the age.

Taking the intersection over countably many graphs, we see that the probability of *every* finite graph being in the age is also 1.

But what's the probability of ultrahomogeneity? By (Lemma 2.2.4), to have homogeneity, we

just need to check that for every isomorphism between finite subgraphs, and every extension of one to a larger finite subgraph, the isomorphism extends. There are countably many choices of $f : A \to B$ and $C \geq A$, so let's find the probability of each one extending. We just need to find $|C \setminus A|$ vertices that have the same relationship to the vertices of B, and to each other, as the vertices of $C \setminus A$ have to A. The probability of this happening, for any ordered list of $|C \setminus A|$ vertices, is positive, as it is 2^{-n}, where n is the number of edges we need. As before, the probability of this positive probability failing for each of an infinite sequence of independent ordered lists is 0, so with probability 1, we can extend this map. The probability that each of these countably many probability-1 properties holds is 1, so with probabilistic certainty, we have generated a Fraïssé limit, completely at random.

2.4 Uniqueness

We know that $(\mathbb{Q}, <)$ is a Fraïssé limit of the class of finite linear orders, but what about other countable structures with that age?

We can rule out $(\mathbb{N}, <)$, as any automorphism will leave 0 as the left endpoint This means that the substructure $\{0\}$ can't be mapped by an automorphism to any of the isomorphic substructures $\{n\}$. In general, any Fraïssé limit of this class must not have a left endpoint, or for that matter, a right endpoint.

We can also rule out $(\mathbb{Z}, <)$, as any automorphism will leave consecutive elements consecutive. This means that the substructure $\{0, 1\}$ can't be mapped by an automorphism to the isomorphic substructure $\{0, 2\}$.

We can extend that argument. Let $\mathcal{M}$ is a Fraïssé limit of this class with elements $a < b$. As there is no right endpoint, let $a < b < c$. As $\{a, b\}$ and $\{a, c\}$ are isomorphic, there must be an automorphism $h : M \to M$ with $h(a) = a$ and $h(c) = b$. It must thus send b to some $h(b)$ with $a = h(a) < h(b) < h(c) = b$, showing that $\mathcal{M}$ is dense.

We have thus shown that any Fraïssé limit of this class is a countable model of DLO - we know there's only one of these up to isomorphism. We will now provide another proof of this which works much more generally.

Theorem 2.4.1 (Uniqueness of Fraïssé limits)**.** *If $\mathcal{M}, \mathcal{N}$ are both Fraïssé limits of a class $\mathcal{K}$, then they are isomorphic.*
In fact, if $f : A \to B$ is an isomorphism between a finite substructure of $\mathcal{M}$ and a finite substructure of $\mathcal{N}$, then there is an isomorphism extending f.

Proof. By (Lemma 2.2.5) and symmetry, we only need to check that if $C \supset A$ is a finite substructure of $\mathcal{M}$, then f extends to C.
We know by amalgamation that there is some $D \in \mathcal{K}$, with embeddings $g_B : B \to D$ and $g_C : C \to D$, such that $g_B \circ f$ equals the composition of g_C with the inclusion map, which means g_C extends $g_B \circ f$. We can shrink D to be the range of g_C, in which case g_C is an isomorphism. This would be perfect, with g_C extending f, if $B \subseteq D \subset N$. All we know is that D is isomorphic to a substructure of N - but we may as well assume it actually is one, because composing with that isomorphism won't change anything so far. Then g_B, restricted to its image, is an isomorphism $B \to g_B(B) \subseteq D$, which must extend to an automorphism $h : N \to N$. Thus the substructure we're looking for is $B \subseteq h^{-1}(D) \subset N$, as $h^{-1} \circ g_B$ is just the inclusion map, and then $h^{-1} \circ g_C$, appropriately restricted, gives an isomorphism $C \to h^{-1}(D)$ extending $h^{-1} \circ g_B \circ f$, and thus f. □

To the category theory enthusiasts in the audience, note that this uniqueness is *not* uniqueness up to unique isomorphism. Fraïssé theory is otherwise very categorical, but this provides an unusual wrinkle in categorical presentations of this topic. If you're interested in giving a presentation on the

categorical aspects of Fraïssé theory later in the semester, I have some recommended papers on the course website.

2.5 Examples

Example 2.5.1. The class of finite equivalence relations (in the language $\{E\}$ of one binary relation symbol for equivalence) is Fraïssé, and its Fraïssé limit is the equivalence relation with $\aleph_0$ many $\aleph_0$-sized classes.

Example 2.5.2. The class of finite triangle-free graphs has a Fraïssé limit, one of a family of *Henson graphs*.
One can construct this by ordering the random graph in a particular way, and removing the third vertex of every triangle that appears. (We will see a general Fraïssé-theoretic construction shortly.)

2.5.1 Now With Function Symbols

Most of the construction we've done so far works with function symbols also, although we'll have to reckon with the fact that not every subset is a substructure. For full generality, we'd have to work with *finitely generated* rather than finite substructures, but here are some examples that don't need that:

Example 2.5.3. The class of finite fields of characteristic p is Fraïssé, and its Fraïssé limit is the algebraic closure of F_p.

Example 2.5.4. If K is a finite field, then the class of finite-dimensional K-vector spaces is Fraïssé, and the $\aleph_0$-dimensional K-vector space is its Fraïssé limit.

Example 2.5.5. The class of finite boolean algebras (in the language $\{\top, \bot, \wedge, \vee, \cdot^c\}$) is Fraïssé, and it has a Fraïssé limit, the unique countable atomless boolean algebra.

Example 2.5.6. The classes of finite groups and finite abelian p-groups are also Fraïssé, although their limits are harder to introduce.

Example 2.5.7. If we generalize vastly to allow *continuous logic*, there are quite a few more familiar examples, such as

- the Urysohn space is the Fraïssé limit of finite metric spaces
- the separable Hilbert space is the Fraïssé limit of finite-dimensional/Euclidean Hilbert spaces
- $[0, 1]$ with Lebesgue measure is the Fraïssé limit of finite probability algebras
- various interesting Banach spaces are also Fraïssé limits

Take note that some things will be more complicated - only some of these have $\aleph_0$-categorical theories.

2.6 Existence

Now let's actually construct Fraïssé limits in general.

Theorem 2.6.1 (Existence of Fraïssé limits)**.** *If $\mathcal{K}$ is a Fraïssé class, then it has a Fraïssé limit.*

Proof. We will prove this assuming a relational language, just for simplicity.
We will construct this as a direct limit (union) of a chain of structures in $\mathcal{K}$. If we have a chain

$$D_0 \hookrightarrow D_1 \hookrightarrow D_2 \hookrightarrow \dots$$

of structures, and we think of each embedding as inclusion, then it is easy to check that $\bigcup_n D_n$ is also a structure in a sensible way.

Lemma 2.6.2. *In this construction,* $\mathsf{Age}(\bigcup_n D_n) = \bigcup_n \mathsf{Age}(D_n)$.

Proof. Any finite subset of $\bigcup_n D_n$ must already be contained in some D_n, and is thus already a finite substructure of some element of the chain. □

Thus to get the correct age, we only need to make sure that each element of $\mathcal{K}$ embeds into some element of our chain.
To get ultrahomogeneity, we need to make sure that for each D_n, and all substructures $A, B, C \subseteq D_n$ with $A \subseteq C$ and $f : A \to B$ an isomorphism, f can be extended to an isomorphism from C to some other substructure of the direct limit. For this, we will need to make sure that for some $m > n$, f can be extended to an isomorphism from C to another substructure of D_m.
To do all this, use essential countability to enumerate a representative of each isomorphism type in $\mathcal{K}$ as $A_0, A_1, A_2, \dots$. Then for each structure $D \in \mathcal{K}$, enumerate the triples (f, A, C) where $A \subseteq C$ are substructures and f is an isomorphism from A to another substructure. as $T(D)$.
Now fix a bijection $\pi : \mathbb{N} \to \mathbb{N} \times \mathbb{N}$ such that if $\pi(n) = (j, k)$, we always have $j \leq n$.
Let $D_0 \in \mathcal{K}$. For our recursive construction, assume we have defined the chain through D_n. Then to define D_{n+1} extending D_n, let $(j, k) = \pi(n+1)$. We will make sure that A_n embeds into D_{n+1}, and that if (f, A, C) is the kth triple in $T(D_j)$, then f extends to an isomorphism from C into another substructure of D_{n+1}.
To do this, we first use JEP to find E into which both D_n and A_n embed, and for notational purposes, assume $D_n \subseteq E$. Then f embeds A into D_n, and thus into E, while inclusion embeds A into C. By AP, we can find embed C and E into another structure F making this square commute, and we may assume that the map from E to F is inclusion. We then let $D_{n+1} = F$. □

2.7 Axiomatizability and Categoricity

So, how do we get from all of this to the theory DLO being complete?

Lemma 2.7.1. *Any countable model of* DLO *is a Fraïssé limit for the class of finite linear orders.*

Proof. Any infinite linear order has this age, so it suffices to check ultrahomogeneity.
Suppose $\mathcal{M} \vDash \mathsf{DLO}$, $f : A \to B$ is an isomorphism of finite substructures, and $C \supseteq A$ is a finite substructure. Then we can extend the isomorphism one element at a time. To add $c \notin A$ to the domain A, we first see how it compares to A in the order. It must be in some interval with endpoints in A, either between consecutive elements, or above or below all elements of A. In each of these cases, by density, we can find an element d that fits in the corresponding interval of B by density, and by sending $c \mapsto d$, we can extend the isomorphism. □

Recall that if κ is an infinite cardinal, a theory is *κ-categorical* when it has precisely one model of cardinality κ up to isomorphism.

Theorem 2.7.2. DLO *is $\aleph_0$-categorical.*

Proof. Any two models of cardinality $\aleph_0$ are Fraïssé limits for the same class, and are thus isomorphic. □

This also gives us completeness.

Theorem 2.7.3 (Łoś-Vaught Test)**.** *If an $\mathcal{L}$-theory T is κ-categorical, and $\kappa \geq \aleph_0, |\mathcal{L}|$, then T is complete.*

Proof. Let $\mathcal{M}, \mathcal{N} \vDash T$ be two models. We can then find, by Löwenheim-Skolem, two models $\mathcal{M}', \mathcal{N}' \vDash T$ with $\mathcal{M}' \equiv \mathcal{M}, \mathcal{N}' \equiv \mathcal{N}$, of size κ. These must be isomorphic, and thus elementarily equivalent, so

$$\mathcal{M} \equiv \mathcal{M}' \equiv \mathcal{N}' \equiv \mathcal{N}.$$

□

What we can generalize from this is that if there is a theory whose countable models are precisely the Fraïssé limits of $\mathcal{K}$, then that theory is $\aleph_0$-categorical and thus complete.

We will now examine when this is possible.

Lemma 2.7.4. *Let $\mathcal{L}$ be a finite language, and $A = \{a_1, \ldots, a_n\}$ a finite $\mathcal{L}$-structure. Then there is a formula $\phi(\bar{x})$ with $\bar{x} = (x_1, \ldots, x_n)$ such that in any $\mathcal{L}$-structure $\mathcal{M}$, if $\bar{m} \in M^n$, then $\mathcal{M} \vDash \phi(\bar{m})$ if and only if the map $a_i \mapsto m_i$ defines an isomorphism from A to the set $\{m_1, \ldots, m_n\}$, which is a substructure.*
Furthermore, ϕ doesn't use any quantifiers.

Proof. We need to construct $\phi(\bar{x})$ to check that each of the finitely many symbols of $\mathcal{L}$ is respected. We can write down a formula checking this for each symbol separately, and then take a conjunction.
For a relation symbol $R(x_1, \ldots, x_k)$, we will build a large conjunction. For each of the n^k tuples $(i_1, \ldots, i_k) \in [n]^k$, if $A \vDash R(a_{i_1}, \ldots, a_{i_k})$, we include the literal $R(x_{i_1}, \ldots, x_{i_k})$, and if not, we include the literal $\neg R(x_{i_1}, \ldots, x_{i_k})$.
For a function symbol $f(x_1, \ldots, x_k)$, we still build a large conjunction. For each of the n^k tuples $(i_1, \ldots, i_k) \in [n]^k$, there is a unique $j \in [n]$ such that if $A \vDash f(a_{i_1}, \ldots, a_{i_k}) = a_j$, so we include the literal $f(x_{i_1}, \ldots, x_{i_k}) = x_j$. □

Theorem 2.7.5. *Let $\mathcal{L}$ be a finite language, and let $\mathcal{K}$ be a Fraïssé class of finite $\mathcal{L}$-structures that is* uniformly locally finite*: there is a function $F : \mathbb{N} \to \mathbb{N}$ such that for any n and any subset A of a structure $C \in \mathcal{K}$, there is a substructure B of C with $A \subseteq B \subseteq C$ and $|B| \leq F(|A|)$.*
Then there is a theory T whose models are precisely Fraïssé limits of $\mathcal{K}$.

Proof. First, we will want to limit the age of a model of T. One consequence of uniform local finiteness is that for each n, there is a finite subclass of $\mathcal{K}$ (say, those of size at most $F(n)$), which we call $\mathcal{K}_n$, such that for any n elements in a structure in $\mathcal{K}$, or with age a subsclass of $\mathcal{K}$, those n elements must belong to a substructure isomorphic to one in $\mathcal{K}_n$.
We can then add to T the sentences, for each n,

$$\forall \bar{x}, \bigvee_{A \in \mathcal{K}} \exists \bar{y} \phi_A(\bar{x}, \bar{y}),$$

where $|\bar{x}| = n$, and $\phi_A(\bar{x}, \bar{y})$ is the formula indicating that the elements of $\bar{x}, \bar{y}$ enumerate a structure isomorphic to A.
Any finite tuple of elements in a model of T will now have to be contained in a substructure isomorphic to one of $\mathcal{K}$, ensuring that the age of this model is a subclass of $\mathcal{K}$.
To make sure the age is *all* of $\mathcal{K}$, we can add the sentences

$$\exists \bar{x}, \phi_A(\bar{x})$$

for each $A \in \mathcal{K}$.
Now we wish to ensure ultrahomogeneity. We need to show that if $A \subseteq C \in \mathcal{K}$, then any substructure isomorphic to A extends to one isomorphic to C. We can do this with the sentence

$$\forall \bar{x}, \phi_A(\bar{x}) \to \exists \bar{y}, \phi_C(\bar{x}, \bar{y}).$$

□

Corollary 2.7.6. *Each of the following Fraïssé limits is the unique countable model of a complete, $\aleph_0$-categorical theory:*

- *the countable random graph*
- *the $\aleph_0$-dimensional K-vector space whenever K is a finite field*
- *the countable atomless boolean algebra.*

We should also note that the *quantifiers* $(\forall, \exists)$ appeared in every sentence of these theories in about the same way. Every single sentence can be written (with perhaps a bit of rewriting effort) as $\forall \bar{x}, \exists \bar{y}, \phi(\bar{x}, \bar{y})$, where ϕ has no quantifiers at all.

Chapter 3

Quantifier Elimination

Most of this chapter is based on the approach in [9].

3.1 Quantifier-Free Formulas

Formulas and definable sets can be complicated, but *quantifier-free* formulas and definable sets are much simpler to work with.

Definition 3.1.1. A formula $\phi(\bar{x})$ is *quantifier-free* when, as a string, it does not contain the symbols $\exists$ and $\forall$.
A set $D \subseteq M^n$ is *quantifier-free definable* (with parameters in $A \subseteq M$) when there is a quantifier-free formula $\phi(\bar{x})$ with parameters from A such that $\bar{a} \in D \iff M \vDash \phi(\bar{a})$.

Lemma 3.1.2. *Any quantifier-free formula is equivalent to a boolean combination of atomic formulas.*

Proof. Exercise. □

Quantifier-free definable sets in algebra are easy to understand:

Lemma 3.1.3. *The quantifier-free definable sets (with parameters) in a (semi)ring* $(R; 0, 1, +, \times)$ *are exactly the* constructible *sets - that is, boolean combinations of zerosets of polynomials with coefficients in* R.

Proof. These sets are precisely the boolean combinations of sets definable by atomic formulas. As the only relation is $=$, we find that the only atomic formulas are of the forms $t_1(\bar{x}) = t_2(\bar{x})$ Each of these terms evaluates to a polynomial - if we allow all parameters, these can be any polynomial in $R[\bar{x}]$. □

Many of the definable sets we care about are not quantifier-free definable, even with parameters. Recall that the set of prime numbers is defined in $(\mathbb{N}; 0, 1, +, \times, \leq)$ by

$$\mathsf{Prime}(x) := 1 < x \wedge \forall y, \forall z, (y \times z = x) \to (y = 1 \vee z = 1).$$

It certainly seems important to state this with quantifiers, but often formulas with quantifiers can be nonobviously equivalent to quantifier-free formulas. Consider the theory of $(\mathbb{R}; 0, 1, +, \times, \leq)$

and the formulas

$$x \neq 0 \iff \exists y, x \times y = 1.$$

To confirm that the set of primes is not quantifier-free definable, let's briefly explore what quantifier-free definable sets look like in this language.

Lemma 3.1.4. *In the ordered rings* $(\mathbb{R}; 0, 1, +, \times, \leq)$ *and* $(\mathbb{Z}; 0, 1, +, \times, \leq)$ *the only definable subsets of the ring (not its cartesian product) are finite unions of intervals and points.*

Proof. Let $\mathcal{M}$ be one of these structures.
First, let's figure out which subsets are definable by atomic formulas (with parameters). These formulas are all of the form either $t_1(x, \bar{a}) = t_2(x, \bar{a})$ or $t_1(x, \bar{a}) \leq t_2(x, \bar{a})$. By subtracting, we may assume $t_1 = 0$, so each of these formulas is equivalent to one of the form either $t(x, \bar{a}) = 0$ or $t(x, \bar{a}) \geq 0$.
As the term $t(x, \bar{a})$ must be interpreted as a single-variable polynomial in $M[x]$, we see that $t(x, \bar{a}) = 0$ defines a finite set, which is indeed a finite union of intervals and points. If $\mathcal{M} = (\mathbb{R}; 0, 1, +, \times, \leq)$, then $t(x, \bar{a}) \geq 0$ defines a union of intervals whose endpoints satisfy $t(x, \bar{a}) = 0$, which is thus finite. If $\mathcal{M} = (\mathbb{Z}; 0, 1, +, \times, \leq)$, then $t(x, \bar{a}) \geq 0$ defines the intersection of a finite union of intervals in $\mathbb{R}$ with $\mathbb{Z}$, which is also a finite union of intervals.
The set of finite unions of intervals and points is closed under boolean combinations, finishing the proof. □

Applying this lemma to the ordered ring $(\mathbb{Z}; 0, 1, +, \times, \leq)$, in which $\mathbb{N}$ is quantifier-free definable, we see that all quantifier-free definable subsets of $(\mathbb{N}; 0, 1, +, \times, \leq)$ must also be quantifier-free definable subsets of $\mathbb{Z}$, satisfying the result of the lemma.

It is now easy to check that the set of primes is not a finite union of intervals and points, as there are infinitely many primes, but (with the exception of 2 and 3) no two can belong to the same interval contained in the set of primes.

3.2 Quantifier Elimination

Definition 3.2.1. A theory T *eliminates quantifiers*, or *has quantifier elimination (QE)*, if every formula $\phi(\bar{x})$ is equivalent modulo T to some quantifier-free formula $\psi(\bar{x})$.
Equivalently, every $\emptyset$-definable set in a model of T is $\emptyset$-quantifier-free definable.

In such a theory, we will be able to understand formulas and definable sets easily, by eliminating quantifiers first. It may be necessary to add a few extra symbols to the language first, as this definition is language-dependent.

3.3 Theories of Fraïssé Limits

Our first examples of theories with QE come from Fraïssé theory.

Theorem 3.3.1. *Let* $\mathcal{L}$ *be a finite language, let* $\mathcal{K}$ *be a Fraïssé class of finite* $\mathcal{L}$*-structures that is uniformly locally finite. By (Theorem 2.7.5), there is a theory* T *whose countable models are precisely Fraïssé limits of* $\mathcal{K}$*. This theory eliminates quantifiers.*

Proof. Let $\mathcal{M} \vDash T$ be countable, and thus a Fraïssé limit of $\mathcal{K}$.
Let $\phi(\bar{x})$ be a formula, where $|\bar{x}| = n$. Recall that there is a finite subclass $\mathcal{K}_n \subseteq \mathcal{K}$ such that

any tuple of n elements in a model of T (or any other structure with age contained in $\mathcal{K}$) is contained in a substructure isomorphic to a structure in $\mathcal{K}_n$. We may furthermore assume that this substructure is the minimal substructure containing these elements, without compromising finiteness. This means that any element of the substructure can be generated from those elements by applying function symbols, which we can summarize as saying that for any element in this substructure, there is some term $t(\bar{x})$ which evaluates to that element.

For each structure $A \in \mathcal{K}_n$, recall that there is a quantifier-free formula $\phi_A(\bar{x})$ such that $\mathcal{M} \vDash \phi_A(\bar{m})$ if and only if $a_i \mapsto m_i$ is an isomorphism of finite structures. If A is the minimal substructure containing a tuple $\bar{b}$, then we may write every element in $A = \{a_1, \ldots, a_r\}$ as $a_i = t_i(\bar{b})$. We then see that

$$\phi_{A,\bar{a}}(\bar{x}) = \phi_A(t_1(\bar{x}), \ldots, t_r(\bar{x}))$$

is true of $\bar{m} \in M^n$ if and only if $\bar{m}$ generates a substructure isomorphic to A, with the isomorphism sending a_i to m_i.

We now see that for each $\bar{m} \in M^n$, there is some one $A \in \mathcal{K}_n$ such that $\mathcal{M} \vDash \phi_{A,\bar{a}}(\bar{m})$. We may then let $\psi(\bar{x})$ be the disjunction of all of the finitely-many formulas $\phi_{A,\bar{a}}(x)$ where there is some $\bar{m}$ such that both $\mathcal{M} \vDash \phi_{A,\bar{a}}(\bar{m})$ and $\mathcal{M} \vDash \phi(\bar{m})$.

This formula $\psi(\bar{x})$ is quantifier-free, let's check that it is equivalent to $\phi(x)$. For each $\bar{m} \in M^n$, if $\mathcal{M} \vDash \phi(\bar{m})$ holds, then we know that there are some $A, \bar{a}$ for which $\mathcal{M} \vDash \phi_{A,\bar{a}}(\bar{m})$, so $\phi_{A,\bar{a}}(\bar{x})$ is in the disjunction, and $\mathcal{M} \vDash \psi(\bar{m})$. Conversely, if $\mathcal{M} \vDash \phi(\bar{m})$, then it is because there are some $A, \bar{a}$ such that $\mathcal{M} \vDash \phi_{A,\bar{a}}(\bar{m})$ and $\phi_{A,\bar{a}}(\bar{x})$ is in the disjunction. This means there is some $\bar{m}'$ with $\mathcal{M} \vDash \phi_{A,\bar{a}}(\bar{m})$ and $\mathcal{M} \vDash \phi(\bar{m}')$. This means that A is isomorphic to the substructures generated by $\bar{m}, \bar{m}'$, and the isomorphisms send $\bar{a}$ to $\bar{m}, \bar{m}'$ respectively. Thus there is an isomorphism between these substructures sending $\bar{m}$ to $\bar{m}'$, which can be extended to an automorphism of M, showing that $\mathcal{M} \vDash \phi(\bar{m}')$ implies $\mathcal{M} \vDash \phi(\bar{m})$ as desired. □

3.4 Tests for Quantifier Elimination

To go beyond Fraïssé theory, we're going to need to develop more tests for quantifier elimination.

Lemma 3.4.1. *Let T be a theory, and assume that for every quantifier-free formula $\theta(\bar{x}, y)$, the formula $\exists y, \theta(\bar{x}, y)$ is equivalent mod T to a quantifier-free formula.*
Then T eliminates quantifiers.

Proof. The set of formulas equivalent to quantifier-free formulas includes all quantifier-free formulas and is closed under boolean combinations, so we only need to show that it is closed under quantification. In fact, as $\forall y, \phi(\bar{x}, y)$ is equivalent to $\neg\exists y, \neg\phi(\bar{x}, y)$, we only need closure under existential quantification, which is our assumption. □

To prove our main semantic test for quantifier elimination, we want to see how quantifier-free formulas pass between structures and substructures, and also how they can determine if a structure has a given substructure.

Lemma 3.4.2. *Let $\phi(\bar{x})$ be quantifier-free. If $f : \mathcal{A} \hookrightarrow \mathcal{M}$ is an embedding, then*

$$\mathcal{A} \vDash \phi(\bar{a}) \iff \mathcal{M} \vDash \phi(f(\bar{a})).$$

In particular, if $\mathcal{A}$ is a substructure of $\mathcal{M}$, then

$$\mathcal{A} \vDash \phi(\bar{a}) \iff \mathcal{M} \vDash \phi(\bar{a}).$$

Proof. We can check this by induction on the construction of ϕ. This is true for any atomic formula by the definition of an embedding, and is preserved under boolean combinations. $\square$

Lemma 3.4.3. *Let $\mathcal{A}$ be an $\mathcal{L}$-structure generated by $B \subseteq A$, and let $\mathcal{L}_B$ be the language extending $\mathcal{L}$ by additional constants $\{c_b : b \in B\}$. Interpret $\mathcal{A}$ as a $\mathcal{L}_B$-structure so that $c_b^{\mathcal{A}} = b$.*
Then let $\mathsf{Diag}_{\mathcal{A}}$, the atomic diagram *of $\mathcal{A}$, be the theory consisting of all quantifier-free $\phi(\bar{c})$ such that $\mathcal{A} \vDash \phi(\bar{c})$.*
If $\mathcal{M} \vDash \mathsf{Diag}_{\mathcal{A}}$, then $\mathcal{A}$ embeds into $\mathcal{M}$.

Proof. Because each element $a \in \mathcal{A}$ can be written as $t(\bar{c})$ for some term t, we can send $t(\bar{c})^{\mathcal{A}}$ to $t(\bar{c})^{\mathcal{N}}$.

Exercise 3.4.4. Show that this is well-defined and a valid embedding. All requirements will be given by quantifier-free sentences in $\bar{c}$.

$\square$

There are syntactic tests we can try, but here's the semantic test that we will usually apply:

Theorem 3.4.5. *Let T be a theory, $\phi(\bar{x})$ a formula. TFAE:*

1. *$\phi(\bar{x})$ is equivalent to a quantifier-free formula*
2. *Whenever a finitely generated structure $\mathcal{A}$ embeds into both $\mathcal{M}, \mathcal{N} \vDash T$ with embeddings f, g, then for any $\bar{a} \in A^n$, $\mathcal{M} \vDash \phi(f(\bar{a}))$ if and only if $\mathcal{N} \vDash \phi(g(\bar{a}))$.*
3. *Whenever a $\mathcal{M}, \mathcal{N} \vDash T$ admit a common substructure $\mathcal{A}$, then for any $\bar{a} \in A^n$, $\mathcal{M} \vDash \phi(\bar{a})$ if and only if $\mathcal{N} \vDash \phi(\bar{a})$.*

Proof. It is simple to see that 1 implies 2 and 3 - suppose $\phi(\bar{x})$ is equivalent to $\psi(\bar{x})$ which is quantifier-free. Then because ψ is quantifier-free, it doesn't matter which structure we evaluate $\phi(\bar{a})$ in, so

$$\mathcal{M} \vDash \psi(\bar{a}) \iff \mathcal{A} \vDash \psi(\bar{a}) \iff \mathcal{N} \vDash \psi(\bar{a}).$$

Statements 2 and 3 are equivalent, as it doesn't really matter for our statement whether the embeddings are inclusions.
To get 1 from 2, we start by adding extra constant symbols for the variables of $\bar{x}$. Call these $c_1, \ldots, c_n$, and call the tuple of all of them $\bar{c}$. We'll replace $\bar{x}$ with $\bar{c}$, and use the compactness theorem a bunch of times to build the structures $\mathcal{M}, \mathcal{A}, \mathcal{N}$ we need.
Let T_1 be the set of all sentences $\psi(\bar{c})$ where ψ is quantifier-free and $T \vDash \phi(\bar{x}) \to \psi(\bar{x})$. We will prove that $T \cup T_1 \vDash \phi(\bar{c})$ in a bit. From this, we can conclude that a finite subtheory of $T \cup T_1$ also implies $\phi(\bar{c})$, so there is a finite subtheory $T_0 = \{\psi_1(\bar{c}), \ldots, \psi_k(\bar{c})\} \subseteq T_1$ such that $T \cup T_0 \vDash \phi(\bar{c})$ also. Then we find that $T \vDash \bigwedge_i \psi_i(\bar{x}) \to \phi(\bar{x})$, but also, by construction, for each i, $T \vDash \phi(\bar{x}) \to \psi_i(\bar{x})$, so $T \vDash \phi(\bar{x}) \leftrightarrow \bigwedge_i \psi_i(\bar{x})$.
We now finish proving the remaining claim that $T \cup T_1 \vDash \phi(\bar{c})$. To prove this, we show by contradiction that $T \cup T_1 \cup \{\neg\phi(\bar{c})\}$ is inconsistent. If not, then let $\mathcal{M} \vDash T \cup T_1 \cup \{\neg\phi(\bar{c})\}$, and let $\mathcal{A}$ be the substructure generated by $\bar{c}^{\mathcal{M}}$.
We now consider whether

$$T \cup \mathsf{Diag}_{\mathcal{A}} \cup \{\phi(\bar{c})\}$$

is consistent. If it's not consistent, we can find an inconsistent finite subtheory $T \cup \{\psi_i(\bar{a}) : 1 \leq$

$i \leq k\} \cup \{\phi(\bar{c})\}$. Then we have

$$T \vDash \bigwedge_i \psi_i(\bar{c}) \to \neg\phi(\bar{c}),$$

so by contrapositive,

$$T \vDash \phi(\bar{c}) \to \bigvee_i \neg\psi_i(\bar{c}),$$

so the quantifier-free sentence $\bigvee_i \neg\psi_i(\bar{c})$ is in T_1 by construction. This means that $\mathcal{M} \vDash \bigvee_i \neg\psi_i(\bar{c})$, and because of quantifier-free transfer, $\mathcal{A} \vDash \bigvee_i \neg\psi_i(\bar{c})$. That gives us a contradiction, as by construction of each ψ_i, $\mathcal{A} \vDash \psi_i(\bar{c})$.
Now we can conclude

$$T \cup \mathsf{Diag}_{\mathcal{A}} \cup \{\phi(\bar{c})\}$$

actually is consistent, so it has a model, $\mathcal{N}$. Because $\mathcal{N} \vDash \mathsf{Diag}_{\mathcal{A}}$, there is an embedding $g : \mathcal{A} \hookrightarrow \mathcal{N}$, sending $\bar{c}^{\mathcal{A}}$ to $\bar{c}^{\mathcal{N}}$.
The models $\mathcal{M}, \mathcal{N} \vDash T$ have $\mathcal{A}$ as a common substructure, but $\mathcal{M} \vDash \neg\phi(\bar{c})$ and $\mathcal{N} \vDash \phi(\bar{c})$, contradicting our assumption. □

Corollary 3.4.6. *To check that a theory T eliminates quantifiers, we only need to check the following:*
Whenever $\phi(\bar{x}, y)$ is a formula, and $\mathcal{M}, \mathcal{N} \vDash T$ share a common finitely-generated substructure $\mathcal{A}$, then for any $\bar{a} \in A^n$, if there is $b \in M$ such that $\mathcal{M} \vDash \phi(\bar{a}, b)$, then there is $c \in N$ with $\mathcal{N} \vDash \phi(\bar{a}, c)$.

Proof. This allows us to apply (Theorem 3.4.5) to the formulas we need in (Lemma 3.4.1). □

We can even restrict further than checking this for quantifier-free ϕ, but first we need a lemma, essentially from propositional logic:

Lemma 3.4.7. *If $\phi(\bar{x})$ is a quantifier-free formula, then it is equivalent to a quantifier-free formula in* disjunctive normal form

$$\bigvee_{i=1}^{r} \bigwedge_{j=1}^{s} \theta_{i,j}(\bar{x})$$

where each $\theta_{i,j}$ is a literal*: either an atomic formula or the negation of one.*

Proof. We know that $\phi(\bar{x}, y)$ is quantifier-free, so it is some boolean combination of atomic formulas (this is basically propositional logic of atomic formulas). Up to logical equivalence, we have some flexibility as to the structure of this boolean combination.
First, a moment of notation. If $\theta(\bar{x})$ is a formula, and $b \in \{0, 1\}$, let $(\neg)^b\theta(\bar{x})$ denote $\neg\theta(\bar{x})$ if $b = 1$ and $\theta(\bar{x})$ if $b = 0$.
Let $\theta_1, \ldots, \theta_k$ be the atomic formulas that appear in ϕ. Then the truth value of ϕ only depends on the truth values of the θ_is, so for any $(b_1, \ldots, b_k) \in \{0, 1\}^k$, the conjunction $\bigwedge_{i=1}^{k} (\neg)^{b_i}\theta_i(\bar{x})$ implies either $\phi(\bar{x})$ or $\neg\phi(\bar{x})$. Thus ϕ is equivalent to

$$\bigvee_{(b_1,\ldots,b_k)\in S} \bigwedge_{i=1}^{k} (\neg)^{b_i}\theta_i(\bar{x})$$

for some set $S \subseteq \{0, 1\}^k$. □

Theorem 3.4.8. *To check that a theory T eliminates quantifiers, we only need to check the following:*
Whenever $\phi(\bar{x}, y)$ is a conjunction of literals, and $\mathcal{M}, \mathcal{N} \vDash T$ share a common finitely-generated substructure $\mathcal{A}$, then for any $\bar{a} \in A^n$, if there is $b \in M$ such that $\mathcal{M} \vDash \phi(\bar{a}, b)$, then there is $c \in N$ with $\mathcal{N} \vDash \phi(\bar{a}, c)$.

Proof. By (Corollary 3.4.6), it suffices to prove this also holds for all quantifier-free ϕ, and by (Lemma 3.4.7), we may assume that ϕ is of the form $\bigvee_{i=1}^{r} \bigwedge_{j=1}^{s} \theta_{i,j}(\bar{x})$.
If

$$\mathcal{M} \vDash \bigvee_{i=1}^{r} \bigwedge_{j=1}^{s} \theta_{i,j}(\bar{a}, b),$$

then there is some i such that

$$\mathcal{M} \vDash \bigwedge_{j=1}^{s} \theta_{i,j}(\bar{a}, b).$$

By assumption, there is some $c \in N$ with

$$\mathcal{N} \vDash \bigwedge_{j=1}^{s} \theta_{i,j}(\bar{a}, c),$$

implying

$$\mathcal{N} \vDash \bigvee_{i=1}^{r} \bigwedge_{j=1}^{s} \theta_{i,j}(\bar{a}, c).$$

□

3.5 Vector Spaces

We know that theories of vector spaces over a finite field eliminate quantifiers, as each of these theories is $\aleph_0$-categorical, and its unique countable model is a Fraïssé Limit. To extend this to *all* theories of vector spaces, we will need to develop some more techniques, which we will reapply to other theories. This will also give us quantifier elimination for several examples of theories of abelian groups which are basically vector spaces.

We study additive abelian groups in the language $\mathcal{L}_+ = \{0, +, -\}$. To study vector spaces, we extend this language with scalar multiplication, giving us a language $\mathcal{L}_{K,+} = \{0, +, -, c\cdot : c \in K\}$ where K is some field of scalars.

Definition 3.5.1. Given a field K, let VS_K be the $\mathcal{L}_{K,+}$-theory of nontrivial K-vector spaces.

Note: This requires separate axioms for each instance of scalar multiplication. For instance, for each $c, d \in K$, we need an axiom $\forall x, c \cdot (d \cdot x) = (cd) \cdot x$.

Lemma 3.5.2. *If K is an infinite field, the theory VS_K has only infinite models, and is $|\kappa|$-categorical for $\kappa > |\aleph_0|$. If K is countably infinite, then the theory VS_K is κ-categorical if and only if $\kappa > \aleph_0$.*

Proof. Suppose K is an infinite field. Any nontrivial K-vector space is infinite, and if it has dimension κ, then it has cardinality $\max(\kappa, |K|)$. Thus if $\kappa > |K|$, any K-vector space of

cardinality κ must also have dimension κ, and all such vector spaces are isomorphic.
If K is countably infinite, then any finite or $\aleph_0$-dimensional vector space has cardinality $\aleph_0$, so VS_K is not $\aleph_0$-categorical. □

By Łoś-Vaught Test (Theorem 2.7.3), VS_K is complete. We will now show that it eliminates quantifiers.

Theorem 3.5.3. *Each theory VS_K eliminates quantifiers.*

Proof. Suppose $\mathcal{M}, \mathcal{N} \vDash \mathsf{VS}_K$ have a common substructure $\mathcal{A}$. This substructure must also be a K-vector space, which will be nontrivial as long as $\mathcal{A}$ contains a nonzero element. We may assume it does, because if $A = \{0\}$, we can just extend it to a 1-dimensional subspace of both $\mathcal{M}, \mathcal{N}$.
Now suppose that $\phi(\bar{x}, y)$ is a conjunction of literals $\bigwedge_{i=1}^{r} \theta_i(\bar{x}, y)$, and $\bar{a} \in A^n, b \in M$ satisfy $\mathcal{M} \vDash \phi(\bar{a}, b)$. We will show that there is $c \in A$ such that $\mathcal{A} \vDash \phi(\bar{a}, c)$, so as $A \subseteq N$, there is $c \in N$ such that $\mathcal{N} \vDash \phi(\bar{a}, c)$, completing our test.
Now we have to think about what atomic formulas actually look like in a vector space. There are no relation symbols, so any atomic formula is an equation of terms, and any term is a linear combination of variables. By subtracting and dividing, we see that each such atomic formula is equivalent to one of one of the forms

$$t(\bar{x}) = 0, y = t(\bar{x}),$$

where t is a term/linear combination.
We may ignore any terms of the former category, as they don't depend on the value of y. For the others, we see that $\theta_i(\bar{a}, y)$ is equivalent to either $y = a$ or $y \neq a$ for some $a \in \mathcal{A}$. If any of these is of the form $y = a$, then we know that $b = a$, so $b \in \mathcal{A}$ already, and

$$\mathcal{A} \vDash \bigwedge_{i=1}^{r} \theta_i(\bar{a}, b).$$

Otherwise, we see that

$$\mathcal{M} \vDash \bigwedge_{i=1}^{r} \theta_i(\bar{a}, b),$$

just means $b \notin S$ for a particular finite set $S \subset A$, and we can find some $c \in A \setminus S$ thus satisfying

$$\mathcal{A} \vDash \bigwedge_{i=1}^{r} \theta_i(\bar{a}, c)$$

as $\mathcal{A}$ is infinite. □

This gives us a good picture of the definable sets in any vector space. They are going to be the boolean combinations of those definable by atomic formulas, which are going to be of the form $t(\bar{x}) = 0$, where t is a term representing a linear combination. These define hyperplanes.

In the one-dimensional case, hyperplanes are just single points, so the definable subsets of a model $\mathcal{M}$ itself are exactly finite or cofinite sets. (This is a hugely important property of these theories: they are *strongly minimal*.)

3.5.1 Lessons

We can summarize the key steps of this proof in a way that will let us replicate them. First, we've seen that any substructure of a model $\mathcal{VS}_K$ basically generates a model. In this case, any such

substructure *is* a model unless it's the trivial substructure $\{0\}$, but we can come up with a property that describes both. To do this, let's note that we can axiomatize substructures of models of a theory:

Exercise 3.5.4. Given a theory T, let $T_\forall$ be the theory consisting of all universal sentences (of the form $\forall x, \phi(\bar{x})$ with ϕ quantifier-free) that are consequences of T.
Then $\mathcal{A}$ embeds into a model of T if and only if $\mathcal{A} \vDash T_\forall$.

Proof. See Marker 2.5.10. Hint: Use the theory $\mathsf{Diag}_{\mathcal{A}}$ and compactness. □

We can now cleanly define the property we've seen.

Definition 3.5.5. A theory T has *algebraically prime models* when for every $\mathcal{A} \vDash T_\forall$, there is a model $\mathcal{M} \vDash T$ and an embedding $i : \mathcal{A} \hookrightarrow \mathcal{M}$ that every other embedding $j : \mathcal{A} \hookrightarrow \mathcal{N} \vDash T$ factors through: $j = h \circ i$ for some $h : \mathcal{M} \hookrightarrow \mathcal{N}$.

Corollary 3.5.6. *Each theory VS_K has algebraically prime models.*

We can now describe the rest of the proof with the following test:

Lemma 3.5.7. *If T has algebraically prime models, then T has quantifier elimination if and only if the following holds:*
For any models $\mathcal{M}, \mathcal{N} \vDash T$ with $M \subseteq N$, if $\phi(\bar{x}, y)$ is a conjunction of literals, and $\bar{a} \in M^{|\bar{x}|}$, then $\mathcal{N} \vDash \exists y, \phi(\bar{a}, y)$ implies $\mathcal{M} \vDash \exists y, \phi(\bar{a}, y)$.

Proof. We've seen in the proof of (Theorem 3.5.3) that this suffices for precisely the reason of algebraically prime models. Meanwhile, if T has quantifier elimination, then $\exists y, \phi(\bar{x}, y)$ is equivalent to a quantifier-free formula, so this transfer between models is trivial. □

Lastly, we often won't have to prove quantifier elimination and completeness separately.

Lemma 3.5.8. *If a theory T eliminates quantifiers, it is also* model complete*: If $f : \mathcal{M} \hookrightarrow \mathcal{N}$ is an embedding with $\mathcal{M}, \mathcal{N} \vDash T$, then f is elementary.*

Proof. We know that f preserves all quantifier-free formulas, and all other formulas are equivalent to those, and thus preserved. □

The following test gives another proof of completeness of VS_K. It also justifies the term "model complete," which says that all you need to get completeness is to work in extensions of a specific model.

Lemma 3.5.9. *Suppose that T is a theory with quantifier elimination, and $\mathcal{M} \vDash T$ embeds into every other model of T. Then T is complete.*

Proof. If $\mathcal{N} \vDash T$, then $\mathcal{M}$ embeds *elementarily* into $\mathcal{N}$ by model-completeness, so $\mathsf{Th}(\mathcal{N}) = \mathsf{Th}(\mathcal{M})$, and T is complete. □

This applies to VS_K, because the 1-dimensional K-vector space K embeds into all other nontrivial vector spaces.

3.6 Divisible Abelian Groups

The next theory we'll consider is the theory of *torsion-free divisible abelian groups*, or DAG.

Definition 3.6.1. If t is a term and $n \in \mathbb{N}$, let $n \cdot t$ abbreviate the term $\underbrace{t + t + \cdots + t}_{n \text{ times}}$.

Let DAG be the $\mathcal{L}_+$-theory consisting of the axioms of abelian groups, as well as, for each $n \in \mathbb{N}$, the torsion-free axioms

$$\forall x, x \neq 0 \to n \cdot x \neq 0$$

and the divisibility axioms

$$\forall y, \exists x, n \cdot x = y.$$

Lemma 3.6.2. *A nontrivial abelian group models* DAG *if and only if it admits a* $\mathbb{Q}$*-vector space structure. In this case, that vector space structure is unique.*

Proof. It is easy to see that a $\mathbb{Q}$-vector space models DAG.
Suppose $\mathcal{M} \vDash \mathsf{DAG}$. Then for $\frac{p}{q} \in \mathbb{Q}$, we can define $\frac{p}{q}\cdot$ on M through divisibility, letting $\frac{p}{q} \cdot x$ be such that $q \cdot \left(\frac{p}{q} \cdot x\right) = p \cdot x$. This is well-defined, because if y, z both satisfy these assumptions, we find that

$$q \cdot (y - z) = q \cdot y - q \cdot y = p \cdot x - p \cdot x = 0,$$

so by the torsion-free assumption, $y - z = 0$. It is then easy to check the vector space axioms.
This vector space structure is also unique, because any $\mathbb{Q}$-vector space structure must satisfy the equations $q \cdot \left(\frac{p}{q} \cdot x\right) = p \cdot x$. □

This lets us transfer results between groups and $\mathbb{Q}$-vector spaces.

Lemma 3.6.3. *The theory* DAG *has algebraically prime models.*

Proof. If $\mathcal{A} \vDash \mathsf{DAG}_\forall$, then $\mathcal{A}$ is a torsion-free abelian group. We also know that $\mathcal{A}$ embeds into a divisible abelian group $\mathcal{M} \vDash T$, which has a natural $\mathbb{Q}$-vector space structure. We assume $A \subseteq M$. Let D be the $\mathbb{Q}$-span of A in M - we call the group structure $\mathcal{D}$ the *divisible hull* of $\mathcal{A}$. If A is nontrivial, then we can see that any embedding of A into a $\mathbb{Q}$-vector space must factor through $\mathcal{D}$. If A is trivial, then instead, any embedding of A into a $\mathbb{Q}$-vector space must factor through the 1-dimensional vector space $\mathbb{Q}$. □

Theorem 3.6.4. *The theory* DAG *eliminates quantifiers and is complete.*

Proof. Suppose $\mathcal{M}, \mathcal{N} \vDash \mathsf{DAG}$ are such that $M \subseteq N$, $\bar{a} \in M^n$, $b \in N$, and $\mathcal{N} \vDash \phi(\bar{a}, b)$ where ϕ is a conjunction of literals.
Then if we expand the language, we know that ϕ is also a formula in $\mathcal{L}_{+,\mathbb{Q}}$, so it is equivalent in models of DAG, which are in this extended language, uniquely models of $\mathsf{VS}_\mathbb{Q}$, to a quantifier-free $\mathcal{L}_{+,\mathbb{Q}}$-formula ψ. Thus there is $c \in N$ with $\mathcal{M} \vDash \phi(\bar{a}, c)$.
Completeness follows because the group $\mathbb{Q}$ embeds into all other models, or by reference to $\mathsf{VS}_\mathbb{Q}$. □

3.7 Ordered Divisible Abelian Groups and Vector Spaces

We can tack $<$ onto these languages to get the languages $\mathcal{L}_{+,<}$ and $\mathcal{L}_{+,K,<}$ of *ordered* groups and vector spaces.

By swapping the torsion-free axioms in DAG for the axioms of a linearly ordered group, we construct the theory ODAG of ordered divisible abelian groups. If K is an ordered field, we add the axioms of a linearly ordered group to VS_K along with axioms (one per scalar) that multiplication by any positive scalar is order-preserving, and axioms that multiplication by any negative scalar is order-reversing, getting the theory OVS_K of ordered K-vector spaces.

Lemma 3.7.1. *The theories* OVS_K *for any ordered field* K *imply* ODAG*, which in turn implies* DLO*.*

Proof. The ordered field $\mathbb{Q}$ embeds uniquely into any ordered field K. Using this embedding, any ordered K-vector space is uniquely an ordered $\mathbb{Q}$-vector space. Then any $\mathbb{Q}$-vector space is a divisible abelian group, and an ordered one is an ordered divisible abelian group.
The axioms of ordered divisible abelian groups include those of linear orders, so it suffices to check density and lack of endpoints. Given $a, b \in M$ with $\mathcal{M} \vDash \mathsf{ODAG}$, there is some $c \in M$ with $c + c = a + b$ by divisibility. We can check that if $a < b$, $a < c < b$.
Similarly, we check that $a \in M$ is not a minimum or a maximum. If $a > 0$, $-a < a < 2a$, and $a < 0$, then $2a < a < -a$. If $a = 0$, nontriviality lets us find $b \neq 0$, and either $-b < 0 < b$ or $b < 0 < -b$. □

Theorem 3.7.2. *If* K *is an ordered field,* OVS_K *is complete and has quantifier elimination.*

Proof. This has algebraically prime models, just as in the non-ordered case, as all nontrivial substructures are models, and the trivial one factors through K itself.
Now let $\mathcal{M}, \mathcal{N} \vDash \mathsf{OVS}_K$ be such that $M \subseteq N$, and let $\phi(\bar{x}, y)$ be a conjunction of literals, $\bar{a} \in M^{|\bar{x}|}, b \in N$ with $\mathcal{N} \vDash \phi(\bar{a}, b)$. Each literal is equivalent (repeating the argument from before) to either a form that doesn't depend on the value of y, which we can ignore, or something of the form $t(\bar{x}) < y$, $t(\bar{x}) = y$, or the negation of one of these. If $t(\bar{x}) = y$ ever appears in this conjunction, then $b = t(\bar{a}) \in M$ already. Thus we may assume that each of these literals is of one of the forms $y < t(\bar{x}), y \neq t(\bar{x}), y > t(\bar{x})$. We may even replace any instance of $y \neq t(\bar{x})$ with one of the inequalities $<, >$, depending on which b satisfies. We thus find ourselves with a conjunction of formulas of the form $y < a_i$ where $b < a_i = t_i(\bar{a})$, or $y > a_i$ where $b > a_i = t_i(\bar{a})$. If a_+ is the smallest a_i of the former category, and a_- is the largest of the latter, we find that all we need to satisfy this formula is $a_- < y < a_+$. As $a_- < b < a_+$, this is possible, as we can simply take $\frac{1}{2} \cdot (a_- + a_+) \in M$.
Completeness follows by embedding K itself into all other models. □

Theorem 3.7.3. *The theory* ODAG *is complete and has quantifier elimination.*

Proof. Any model of ODAG is itself torsion-free (all ordered groups are) and thus models DAG, and thus extends to a unique model of $\mathsf{VS}_{\mathbb{Q}}$. This is actually a model of $\mathsf{OVS}_{\mathbb{Q}}$, as it's not hard to check that multiplication by any positive scalar is order-preserving and any negative scalar is order-reversing. As in the non-ordered case, it will thus suffice to prove algebraically prime models and refer to $\mathsf{OVS}_{\mathbb{Q}}$.
Suppose that $\mathcal{A} \vDash \mathsf{ODAG}_\forall$. Embedding this into $\mathcal{M} \vDash \mathsf{ODAG}$, which we view as a model of $\mathsf{VS}_{\mathbb{Q}}$, we see that the divisible hull or $\mathbb{Q}$-span of $\mathcal{A}$ models ODAG, and embeddings into other models factor through this as before. We deal with the trivial case as before. □

These theories are *not* strongly minimal. In any model $\mathcal{M}$ of any of these theories, the interval $(-\infty, 0)$ is infinite but not cofinite.

However, they are *o*-minimal:

Definition 3.7.4. A $\mathcal{L}$-theory T is o-minimal when $\mathcal{L}$ contains a binary symbol $<$ and any model $M \vDash T$ is a dense linear order (sometimes the density assumption is not included) such that all definable subsets of M are finite unions of (points and) intervals.

Corollary 3.7.5. *The theories* ODAG *and* OVS_K *for any ordered field* K *are o-minimal.*

Proof. By quantifier elimination, and the fact that finite unions of points and intervals are closed under boolean combinations, it suffices to check that any atomic formula defines a finite union of points and intervals. In OVS_K, these are all of the form (after subtraction) $x = t(\bar{a})$, $x < t(\bar{a})$, or $x > t(\bar{a})$ for some term t, each of which defines an interval. In ODAG, we note that any definable set is definable in $\mathsf{OVS}_{\mathbb{Q}}$. □

3.8 Presburger Arithmetic

We know that the theory of $(\mathbb{N}; 0, 1, +, \times, \leq)$ doesn't have quantifier elimination, and a similar story applies to $(\mathbb{Z}; 0, 1, +, -, \times, \leq)$, but what happens if we remove the troublesome $\times$? This gives us an ordered abelian group (although with an extra constant 1) $(\mathbb{Z}; 0, 1, +, -, \leq)$, and we've had some success with those before.

We will not immediately succeed in this case either. As we have already seen, the quantifier-free definable subsets of $\mathbb{Z}$ itself in this language are finite unions of intervals. However, there are other definable sets. Take for instance, the even numbers, definable by $\exists y, y + y = x$, or by similar logic, the subgroup $n\mathbb{Z}$ for any $n \geq 2$.

Perhaps these are the only obstructions. If we add to the language $\mathcal{L}_{\mathsf{or}}$ of ordered rings extra predicates P_n for these definable sets, we don't change the algebra of definable sets overall, as this is an expansion by definitions.

We call this language the *Presburger language* $\mathcal{L}_{\mathsf{Pr}}$, and in this language, we can more easily describe the peculiarities of this structure with a theory T_{Pr}, known as *Presburger arithmetic*.

We start with the theory of ordered abelian groups, and add to it first the sentence

$$\forall x, x \leq 0 \vee 1 \leq x,$$

which ensures that this is a discrete linear order. Then we add sentences

$$\forall x, P_n(x) \leftrightarrow \exists y, n \cdot y = x,$$

ensuring that these symbols are just abbreviations for these already existing formulas.

Lastly, since we know that these finite-index subgroups are definable, we can add sentences ensuring that the quotients by them are indeed isomorphic to $\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}$. That is, we can make sure that for every $a \in \mathcal{M} \vDash T_{\mathsf{Pr}}$, and every $n \geq 2$, there is a unique $0 \leq i < n$ such that $a \equiv i \pmod{n}$:

$$\forall x, \bigvee_{i=0}^{n-1} \left(P_n\left(a - i \cdot 1\right) \wedge \bigwedge_{j \neq i} \neg P_n\left(a - j \cdot 1\right) \right).$$

3.8.1 The below was not proven in class, but the results were discussed.

Lemma 3.8.1. *Presburger arithmetic T_{Pr} has algebraically prime models.*

Proof. Let $\mathcal{M} \vDash T_{\mathsf{Pr}}$, $\mathcal{A} \subseteq \mathcal{M}$. Then let D be the *relative divisible hull of $\mathcal{A}$ in $\mathcal{M}$*, that is, the set of all $m \in M$ such that for some $n \in \mathbb{N}$, $n \cdot m \in A$. We claim that $\mathcal{D}$ is a substructure with $\mathcal{D} \vDash T_{\mathsf{Pr}}$, and that all embeddings $\mathcal{A} \hookrightarrow \mathcal{N}$ factor through the inclusion map $\mathcal{A} \hookrightarrow \mathcal{D}$.
To check that $\mathcal{D}$ is a substructure, we only need it to be a subgroup, as it already contains $\mathcal{A}$ and thus both constants. This holds, because if $d_1, d_2 \in D$ are such that $n_1 \cdot d_1, n_2 \cdot d_2 \in A$, we have $(n_1 n_2) \cdot (d_1 - d_2) \in A$, so $d_1 - d_2 \in D$.
As $\mathcal{D}$ is a substructure of $\mathcal{M} \vDash T_{\mathsf{Pr}}$, it is an ordered divisible group satisfying the discreteness axiom, as well as the universal axioms of T_{Pr} governing the quotients $\mathcal{D}/P_n(\mathcal{D})$. We only need to check that

$$\mathcal{D} \vDash \forall x, P_n(x) \leftrightarrow \exists y, n \cdot y = x$$

for each $n \geq 2$. For one direction, it suffices to check that if $d \in D$, $n \geq 2$, then $\mathcal{D} \vDash P_n(n \cdot d)$. This is true because $\mathcal{M} \vDash P_n(n \cdot d)$. For the other direction, suppose $d \in D$ satisfies $\mathcal{D} \vDash P_n(d)$. Then there is some $m \in M$ with $n \cdot m = d$, and some $k \in \mathbb{N}$ with $k \cdot d \in A$, so $(kn) \cdot m \in A$, and thus $m \in D$, so $\mathcal{D} \vDash \exists y, n \cdot y = d$.
Now suppose $f : \mathcal{A} \hookrightarrow \mathcal{N} \vDash T_{\mathsf{Pr}}$ is an embedding into a model of T_{Pr}. We will try to extend f to $\mathcal{D} \hookrightarrow \mathcal{N}$ by mapping any d with $k \cdot d = a \in A$ to some $g(d) = n \in N$ with $k \cdot n = f(a)$. There is always such an n, as for any such a, $\mathcal{A} \vDash P_k(a)$, so $\mathcal{N} \vDash P_k(f(a))$. In fact there is a unique such n, (ensuring in particular that this is an extension of f,) because $\mathcal{N}$ is ordered and thus torsion-free. It is then straightforward to check that this map is injective, a group homomorphism, and order-preserving, ensuring that it is an embedding in the language of ordered abelian groups. (These checks are decent exercises.) We still need to check that each relation P_k is preserved. If $d \in D$ satisfies $\mathcal{D} \vDash P_k(d)$, then d is actually divisible by k in $\mathcal{D}$ and thus $g(d)$ must be divisible by k in N. If $\mathcal{N} \vDash P_k(g(d))$, then let j be such that $j \cdot d \in A$. We see that $\mathcal{N} \vDash P_{jk}(g(j \cdot d))$, so $\mathcal{A} \vDash P_{jk}(j \cdot d)$, so there is actually an element $d' \in D$ with $(jk) \cdot d' = j \cdot d$. The lack of torsion implies that $k \cdot d' = d$. □

Theorem 3.8.2. *Presburger arithmetic T_{Pr} eliminates quantifiers and is complete.*

Proof. Suppose $\mathcal{M}, \mathcal{N} \vDash T_{\mathsf{Pr}}$, $M \subseteq N$, $\phi(\bar{x}, y)$ is a conjunction of literals, and $\bar{a} \in M^{|\bar{x}|}, b \in N$ are such that $\mathcal{N} \vDash \phi(\bar{a}, b)$.
Every term $t(\bar{x}, y)$ is interpreted as a $\mathbb{Z}$-linear combination of variables, so $t(\bar{a}, y)$ can always be interpreted as $m + k \cdot y$ for some $m \in M, k \in \mathbb{Z}$. Any equation of terms is then equivalent to something of the form $k \cdot y = m$, which by divisibility is equivalent to $y = m'$ for some $m' \in M$, any atomic formula using $<$ is equivalent to $k \cdot y < m$, which by divisibility is equivalent to either $y < m'$ or $y > m'$ for some $m' \in M$. As usual, we ignore any atomic formulas that don't depend on y, and if any of the equations $y = m$ appear unnegated in the conjunction, we are done. Any inequality $y \neq m$ can be replaced with $y < m \vee y > m$, and we can get rid of this $\vee$ using the same argument by which we reduced to a conjunction of literals in the first place, so we can assume that the conjunction of all of the literals based on $=$ or $<$ is a conjunction of inequalities, which is to say, an interval (m_-, m_+) with $m_-, m_+ \in M$.
Meanwhile, any atomic formula using P_n is equivalent to $P_n(k \cdot y - m)$. As there is some $0 \leq i < n$ with $P_n(m - i \cdot 1)$, and P_n is interpreted as a subgroup, this is equivalent to $P_n(k \cdot y - i \cdot 1)$, or in a more normal phrasing, $k \cdot y \equiv i \pmod{n}$. If we multiply by a nonzero integer d, we find that this is equivalent to $P_{dn}((dk) \cdot y - di \cdot 1)$, so we may assume that all atomic formulas of this form use the same symbol P_L, where L is the least common denominator of the ns used.
Any inequality $y \neq m$ can be replaced with $y < m \vee y > m$, and each $\neg P_L(k \cdot y - i \cdot 1)$ can be

replaced with a disjunction of atomic formulas $\bigvee_{j \neq i} P_L(k \cdot y - j \cdot 1)$. We can get rid of all of these disjunctions using the same argument by which we reduced to a conjunction of literals in the first place. Thus we may assume that ϕ is of the form

$$m_- < y < m_+ \wedge \bigwedge_{i=1}^{r} P_L(k_i \cdot y - j_i \cdot 1).$$

As there is some $j \in \mathbb{Z}$ with $\mathcal{N} \vDash P_L(b - j \cdot 1)$, we find that anything equivalent to j mod L must satisfy all these P_L congruences. Then there is some $k \in \mathbb{N}$ such that $\mathcal{N} \vDash P_L(m_- + (k - j) \cdot 1)$. If $m_- + k \cdot 1 < m_+$, we can let this be our $c \in \mathcal{M}$, and get $\mathcal{M} \vDash \phi(\bar{a}, c)$.
If not, then $m_- < b < m_+ \leq m_- + k \cdot 1$, so $0 \leq b - m_- < k \cdot 1$. We can prove by induction on k that any such element of a model of T_{Pr} must be itself an integer multiple of 1, so we have $b - m_- = j \cdot 1$, and thus $b = m_- + j \cdot 1 \in M$ already.
This concludes quantifier elimination, and we get completeness by seeing that $\mathbb{Z}$ embeds into any $\mathcal{M} \vDash T_{\mathsf{Pr}}$. □

Corollary 3.8.3. *Presburger arithmetic T_{Pr} is decidable, and quantifier elimination is also computable.*

Proof. The set of axioms we gave for T_{Pr} is computable and T_{Pr} is complete, so the set of consequences of T_{Pr} is computable: We simultaneously enumerate possible proofs of ϕ and $\neg\phi$ from the axioms, and eventually find that one works, resolving whether $T_{\mathsf{Pr}} \vdash \phi$ or $T_{\mathsf{Pr}} \vdash \neg\phi$.
For quantifier elimination, we can enumerate quantifier-free formulas ψ until we find one such that $T_{\mathsf{Pr}} \vdash \forall \bar{x}, \phi(\bar{x}) \leftrightarrow \psi(\bar{x})$. □

For references on the actual algorithmic complexity of Presburger arithmetic, see [11] and other papers by Danny Nguyen and Igor Pak.

3.9 Algebraically Closed Fields

We now turn our attention back to rings and fields, in the language $\mathcal{L}_{+,\times} = \{0, 1, +, -, \times\}$.

Algebraically closed fields can be axiomatized in this language. We start with the theory of fields, and then add axioms, for each $d > 0$, indicating that monic polynomials of degree d have zeroes:

$$\forall x_0, \ldots, x_{d-1}, \exists y, y^d + x_{d-1} \times y^{d-1} + \cdots + x_1 \times y + x_0 = 0,$$

giving the theory ACF.

Theorem 3.9.1. *The theory ACF eliminates quantifiers.*

Proof. We start by checking that this has algebraically prime models. Any substructure of an algebraically closed field is a subring, and thus an integral domain. Any embedding from an integral domain to a field factors through its fraction field, and any embedding from a field to an algebraically closed field factors (not necessarily uniquely) through its algebraic closure. In summary, any embedding from an integral domain to an algebraically closed field factors through the algebraic closure of the fraction field.
Now let $\mathcal{M}, \mathcal{N} \vDash \mathsf{ACF}$ with $M \subseteq N$, and let $\bigwedge_{i=1}^{k} \theta_i(\bar{x}, y)$ be a conjunction of literals such that $\bar{a} \in M^{|\bar{x}|}, b \in N$ satisfy $\mathcal{N} \vDash \bigwedge_{i=1}^{k} \theta_i(\bar{a}, b)$.
An atomic formula here is an equation of terms, and each term without parameters is interpreted as an integer polynomial, so each atomic formula in $\bar{x}, y$ is equivalent to $P(\bar{x}, y) = 0$ for some polynomial $P \in \mathbb{Z}[\bar{x}, y]$.

Now we can write our conjunction of literals as

$$\bigwedge_{i=1}^{m} P_i(\bar{a}, y) = 0 \wedge \bigwedge_{j=1}^{n} Q_j(\bar{a}, y) \neq 0$$

where $P_i, Q_j \in \mathbb{Z}[\bar{x}, y]$, or plugging in our parameters $\bar{a}$, $P_i(\bar{a}, y), Q_j(\bar{a}, y) \in \mathcal{M}[y]$. If there are any literals in the first category, we see that either $P_i = 0$ (we can ignore these),

$$\mathcal{N} \vDash P_i(\bar{a}, b) = 0$$

so b is algebraic over $\mathcal{M}$, and must already be in $\mathcal{M}$. Thus we may consider the case of the formula

$$\bigwedge_{j=1}^{n} Q_j(\bar{a}, y) \neq 0,$$

or equivalently,

$$\neg \bigvee_{j=1}^{n} Q_j(\bar{a}, y) = 0.$$

We may also assume that none of the polynomials Q_j is constant, so that each $Q_j(\bar{a}, y)$ has only finitely many solutions in either $\mathcal{M}$ or $\mathcal{N}$. Thus there are at most finitely many solutions to $\bigvee_{j=1}^{n} Q_j(\bar{a}, y) = 0$ in $\mathcal{M}$, and as $\mathcal{M}$ is infinite, there must be infinitely many $c \in M$ with

$$\neg \bigvee_{j=1}^{n} Q_j(\bar{a}, c) = 0.$$

□

As the quantifier-free definable sets in a field are precisely the constructible sets, this can be phrased as a version of Chevalley's Theorem from algebraic geometry:

Corollary 3.9.2. *If $K \vDash \mathsf{ACF}$ and $D \subseteq K^{m+n}$ is a constructible set, then the projection $\pi(D) \subseteq K^m$ is also constructible.*

Proof. If D is defined by $\phi(\bar{x}, \bar{y})$, then $\pi(D)$ is defined by $\exists \bar{y}, \phi(\bar{x}, \bar{y})$, so the rest is quantifier elimination. □

Exercise 3.9.3. Prove a stronger version of Chevalley's Theorem: For any multivariable polynomial $p : K^m \to K^n$, if $D \subseteq K^m$ is constructible, then so is its image $p(D)$.

Corollary 3.9.4. *The theory ACF is strongly minimal.*

Proof. The only constructible subsets of $K \vDash \mathsf{ACF}$ are finite or cofinite, as the zero set of any one polynomial is finite or K. □

Unlike the previous theories we've shown to have quantifier elimination, ACF is *not* complete. Essentially this is because there is no substructure common to all algebraically closed fields. We can fix this easily by adding the sentence $p \cdot 1 = 0$ for a prime $p > 0$ or all the sentences $p \cdot 1 \neq 0$ for $p = 0$ to form the theory ACF_p of algebraically closed fields of characteristic p.

Theorem 3.9.5. *For p a prime (or 0), ACF_p is complete.*

Proof. Each of these theories eliminates quantifiers, so to show completeness, it suffices to recall that each has a substructure common to all models.
If $p > 0$, then any model $\mathcal{M} \vDash \mathsf{ACF}_p$ contains a substructure isomorphic to $\mathbb{F}_p$. If $p = 0$, then any model $\mathcal{M} \vDash \mathsf{ACF}_0$ contains a substructure isomorphic to $\mathbb{Q}$. □

3.9.1 Ax-Grothendieck

We now have the tools to prove a classic result, the model-theoretic way. (It was proven independently by Ax, this way, and Grothendieck, using more classic algebraic geometry.)

Theorem 3.9.6 (Ax-Grothendieck)**.** *Any injective polynomial map $\mathbb{C}^n \to \mathbb{C}^n$ is also surjective. (Actually, this holds for any algebraically closed field in place of $\mathbb{C}$.)*

Proof. For a fixed degree d and dimension n, there is a sentence ϕ such that

$$(\mathbb{C}; 0, 1, +, -, \times) \vDash \phi$$

is equivalent to all injective polynomial maps of degree at most d being injective. To see this, first note that there's a term $t(\bar{x}, \bar{y})$ with $|\bar{x}| = n$ such that by plugging in different coefficients $\bar{c}$, $t(\bar{x}, \bar{c})$ can be interpreted as any polynomial of degree d. Then we can write our ϕ as

$$\forall \bar{y}_1, \ldots, \bar{y}_n, \left(\forall \bar{x}_1, \bar{x}_2, \bigwedge_{i=1}^{n} t(\bar{x}_1, \bar{y}_i) = t(\bar{x}_2, \bar{y}_i) \to \bar{x}_1 = \bar{x}_2 \right) \to \left(\forall \bar{z}, \exists \bar{x}, \bigwedge_{i=1}^{n} t(\bar{x}, \bar{y}_i) = z_i \right).$$

We can thus frame the theorem as proving $\mathbb{C} \vDash \phi$ for each d, n, or indeed, $\mathsf{ACF}_0 \vDash \phi$.
We start this process by observing that for any finite field k, $k \vDash \phi$, as any injective function $k^n \to k^n$ is surjective.
We now try to go from finite fields to their algebraic closures. For any prime p, we can construct $\mathbb{F}_p^{\text{alg}}$, the algebraic closure of $\mathbb{F}_p$, as a union of an ascending chain of finite subfields - call one such chain $k_0 \subseteq k_1 \subseteq \ldots$. To lift our sentence up this chain, we characterize the quantifier complexity of ϕ, and use the following general result:

Exercise 3.9.7 (See [9, Exercise 2.5.15])**.** If $\mathcal{M}$ is the union of an ascending chain of substructures $\mathcal{A}_0 \subseteq \mathcal{A}_1 \subseteq \ldots$, $\phi = \forall \bar{y}, \exists \bar{x}, \psi(\bar{x}, \bar{y})$ with ψ quantifier-free, and for each i, $\mathcal{A}_i \vDash \phi$, then $\mathcal{M} \vDash \phi$.
(We call such a ϕ an $\forall\exists$ formula, or Π_2.)

With a little bit of effort, we can rewrite ϕ as an $\forall\exists$ formula, and for each i, $k_i \vDash \phi$, so $\mathbb{F}_p^{\text{alg}} \vDash \phi$ and by completeness, $\mathsf{ACF}_p \vDash \phi$.
Now we move to characteristic 0. We know that ACF_0 is complete, so either $\mathsf{ACF}_0 \vDash \phi$ (in which case we're done) or $\mathsf{ACF}_0 \vDash \neg\phi$. In that case, by compactness a finite subtheory of ACF_0 proves $\neg\phi$. This subtheory is a subtheory of $\mathsf{ACF} \cup \{p \cdot 1 \neq 0 : p \leq M\}$ for some M, the maximum of all the finitely many primes such that $p \cdot 1 \neq 0$ appears in the subtheory. However, for any prime $P > M$, $\mathbb{F}_p^{\text{alg}} \vDash \mathsf{ACF} \cup \{p \cdot 1 \neq 0 : p \leq M\}$, so this theory cannot imply $\neg\phi$. □

We can extract a general principle from this compactness argument:

Corollary 3.9.8. *If ϕ is a sentence such that for infinitely many primes p, $\mathsf{ACF}_p \vDash \phi$, then $\mathsf{ACF}_0 \vDash \phi$.*

3.10 Real Closed Fields

We were able to axiomatize $\mathbb{C}$ with ACF_0, and then eliminate quantifiers in that theory. How about $\mathbb{R}$?

First, we observe that to get quantifier elimination, we *must* add a symbol for $<$ or $\leq$. In a ring in the language $\mathcal{L}_{+,\times}$, the only quantifier-free definable sets are constructible sets, and the only one-dimensional constructible sets are finite or cofinite, but $[0, \infty)$ is defined by $\exists y, y^2 = x$. Thus we will work mostly in $\mathcal{L}_{+,\times,<} = \mathcal{L}_{+,\times} \cup \{<\}$.

We will attempt to axiomatize $\mathbb{R}$ in a similar way to how we axiomatized $\mathbb{C}$, but making use of the ordering.

3.10.1 Formally Real Fields

We will start with ordered fields, and what these imply in the plain language of rings. This will let us do as much work as possible to study $\mathbb{R}$ in the language of rings, and use the familiar tools of field theory.

A field being ordered implies, for instance, characteristic 0, and that all squares are nonnegative. We can sum up some of these purely algebraic consequences as follows:

Definition 3.10.1. A field F is *formally real* if -1 is not a finite sum of squares.

Lemma 3.10.2. *Any ordered field is formally real.*

Proof. Easy. □

In fact, we can show the converse in a bit:

Theorem 3.10.3. *Any formally real field is* orderable*, that is, there is a linear ordering that makes it an ordered field.*

We would love to define the ordering as we do in $\mathbb{R}$, by the formula $\exists z, x + z^2 = y$, but this only defines a linear ordering when every element or its negative is a square. Instead, we will incrementally build up to an extension where that's the case, order canonically, and inherit the order from the extension.

Lemma 3.10.4. *If F is formally real and $-a$ is not a sum of squares, then $F(\sqrt{a})$ is formally real.*

Proof. If not, let b_i, c_i be such that

$$-1 = \sum_i (b_i + c_i\sqrt{a})^2 = \sum_i b_i^2 + a\sum_i c_i^2 + 2\sqrt{a}\sum_i b_i c_i.$$

As 1 and $\sqrt{a}$ are F-linearly independent, we find that $\sum_i b_i c_i = 0$ and

$$-a = \frac{1 + \sum_i b_i^2}{\sum_i c_i^2} = \frac{\sum_i c_i^2 + \left(\sum_i b_i^2\right)\left(\sum_i c_i^2\right)}{\left(\sum_i c_i^2\right)^2},$$

which we can see is a sum of squares, giving a contradiction. □

Definition 3.10.5. Call a field *real closed* if it is formally real and has no proper formally real algebraic extensions.

Lemma 3.10.6. *Any real closed field F is uniquely orderable.*

Proof. Because F is real closed, for every $a \in F$, either $-a$ is a sum of squares, or a is already a square. Otherwise, we could extend properly and algebraically by $\sqrt{a}$ and still be formally real. In the former case, any ordering must have $a < 0$, and in the latter case, we must have $a \geq 0$. This tells us that if $a < 0$, then $-a$ is not just a sum of squares, but a square itself.

Exercise 3.10.7. Verify that this is a valid field ordering.

□

We can now prove the theorem:

Proof. If F is formally real, then by Zorn's lemma or transfinite recursion, find a maximal formally real algebraic extension of F. We call such a field a *real closure* of F. This must be real closed by maximality, and thus orderable, so F is. □

3.10.2 Real Closed Fields

We know that $\mathbb{R}$ itself is a real closed field - it only has one proper algebraic extension, $\mathbb{C}$, which is not formally real. We can now collect a few other properties of real closed fields, in order to axiomatize them.

Fact 3.10.8 (Artin-Schreier Theorem)**.** *If R is a formally real field, the following are equivalent:*

1. *R is real closed.*
2. *For every $a \in R$, either $-a$ or a is a square, and every odd-degree polynomial $P(x) \in R[x]$ has a zero in R.*
3. *$R(i)$ is algebraically closed.*
4. *R admits a field ordering under which it has the intermediate value property: If $P(x) \in R[x]$ is a polynomial, and $a < b$ are such that $P(a)P(b) < 0$, then there is $c \in (a, b)$ with $P(c) = 0$.*

Proof. (3) implies that the only irreducible polynomials in $R[x]$ are of degree at most 2. From this, it is fairly easy to show that (3) implies (1) and (4). For (1), it now suffices to rule out proper formally real quadratic extensions, and for (4), it suffices to show the intermediate value property holds for irreducible polynomials.
Now, each of (1) and (4) implies (2) fairly easily. For the former implication, we must show that

adjoining a root of an odd-degree irreducible maintains formal realness. That means that a real closed field must already contain all such roots. For the latter, it we can apply the intermediate value property to polynomials of the form $x^2 - a$ where $a > 0$, and to any polynomial of odd degree.
To complete the equivalence, it suffices to show that (2) implies (3). This requires some light Galois theory.
For more details, see [9, Appendix B], [15, Appendix B.1], or for stronger algebraic statements of the theorem proven with more involved (but still finite-dimensional) Galois Theory, see [6]. □

This now means we can axiomatize real closed fields, two different ways. Let FRCF, the theory of *formally real closed fields*, be the theory of fields together with

- axioms of formal realness: for each n, $\forall \bar{x}, 1 + \sum_{i=1}^{n} x_i^2 \neq 0$
- $\forall x, \exists y, y^2 = x \vee y^2 + x = 0$
- for all odd n, an axiom that any polynomial of degree n always has a root.

Let RCF be the theory *in the ordered language* $\mathcal{L}_{+,\times,<}$ consisting of the axioms of ordered fields together with the axioms of FRCF (we can skip the formally real axioms). Alternately, we could take the axioms of ordered fields together with an axiom, for each n, that polynomials of degree n have the intermediate value property.

We would love to proceed to showing that real closed fields have algebraically prime models, using real closures to generate the common submodels. However, real closures aren't obviously unique.

Example 3.10.9. The field $\mathbb{Q}(x)$ is formally real, but does not have a unique real closure (up to isomorphism of field extensions).

Proof. We can order $\mathbb{Q}(x)$, for instance, by making either x larger than all elements of $\mathbb{Q}$, so it is formally real. However, $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{x})$ and $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{-x})$ are distinct formally real extensions, and each has a real closure. These real closures must be different extensions, as in one, x is a square, and in the other, $-x$ is. □

We can fix this just be requiring that the real closure respect the ordering.

Lemma 3.10.10. *Every ordered field F has a real closure F^{re} whose canonical ordering extends that of F. Furthermore, this is unique up to unique F-preserving isomorphism.*

Proof. Constructing such a real closure is easy enough. For each $a > 0$, we can extend the ordering to $F(\sqrt{a})$. By Zorn's Lemma/transfinite recursion, we can eventually get to an ordered field extension where every element is a square. If we take the real closure of *that*, algebraically speaking, the set of squares is preserved, so we must have preserved the ordering.
Proving that this is unique takes some work - it's basically a back-and-forth argument. If R, S are both real closures of F, then we can (transfinitely) recursively construct larger and larger isomorphisms $\phi : R' \to S'$, where $F \leq R' \leq R$ and $F \leq S' \leq S$. To check that we can always extend this isomorphism, we need to check that, say, if we extend R' by one element, by adjoining the roots of an irreducible polynomial, that S has the same number of roots of that polynomial. Essentially, we need the following lemma:

Lemma 3.10.11. *If F is formally real, and $P(x) \in F[x]$ is irreducible, then $P(x)$ has the same number of roots in any real closure of F.*

Proof. We can calculate the number of roots required either by

- reducing to quadratics by Artin-Schreier and using the discriminant
- Sturm's algorithm (see [9, Appendix B]).

□

□

3.10.3 Quantifier Elimination

That was a lot of real algebra, let's eliminate some quantifiers.

Corollary 3.10.12. *Models of the theory* $\mathsf{RCF}_\forall$ *are precisely ordered integral domains, and the theory* RCF *has algebraically prime models.*

Proof. For the first claim, it is easy to see that any substructure of an ordered field is an ordered integral domain. Conversely, any ordered integral domain $\mathcal{A}$ embeds into an ordered fraction field, which then has a real closure modeling RCF.
We then see that if $\mathcal{A} \vDash \mathsf{RCF}_\forall$ embeds into both $\mathcal{M}, \mathcal{N} \vDash \mathsf{RCF}$, the relative algebraic closure of the image of A in M or N (that is, the subfield consisting of elements algebraic over A) must be real closed. These real closures must be isomorphic by unique A-preserving isomorphism, so we can extend our embedding of $\mathcal{A}$ into an embedding of its unique real closure. □

Theorem 3.10.13. *The theory* RCF *eliminates quantifiers and is complete.*

Proof. Suppose $\mathcal{M} \leq \mathcal{N}$, with $\mathcal{M}, \mathcal{N} \vDash \mathsf{RCF}$, and $\mathcal{N} \vDash \phi(\bar{a}, b)$ where $\bar{a} \in M^{|\bar{x}|}, b \in N$, and $\phi(\bar{x}, y)$ is a conjunction of literals. We may assume, by the same argument as for OVS_K, that each literal is of the form $t_1(\bar{x}, y) = t_2(\bar{x}, y)$ or $t_1(\bar{x}, y) < t_2(\bar{x}, y)$ for some terms t_1, t_2, which in turn, because of subtraction, we may write as $t(\bar{x}, y) = 0$, $t(\bar{x}, y) < 0$ or $t(\bar{x}, y) > 0$.
For each such literal, $t(\bar{a}, y)$ is interpreted as a polynomial in $M[y]$, which has finitely many zeroes in N. By real-closedness, each of these zeroes is also in M, so let $Z \subset M$ be the union of these finitely many sets of zeroes. If any of our literals is an equation, we know that $b \in Z \subset M$, so let $c = b$. Otherwise, assume they are all inequalities.
We know that for each of these inequalities, $t(\bar{a}, b) \neq 0$, so $b \notin Z$. Let $I \subseteq N$ be the interval between consecutive elements of Z such that $b \in I$. Because this is an interval between elements of M, $I \cap M$ is an open interval of a dense linear order, so let $c \in I$. If for any of the terms $t(\bar{x}, y)$ in ϕ, $t(\bar{a}, b)$ and $t(\bar{a}, c)$ had different signs, there would be a zero, that is, an element of Z, between them by IVP. This cannot happen as $b, c \in I$, so $\mathcal{M} \vDash \phi(\bar{a}, c)$.
For completeness, we show that $\mathbb{Q}^{\mathrm{re}} = \mathbb{Q}^{\mathrm{alg}} \cap \mathbb{R}$ embeds into every model of RCF. As every model has characteristic 0, it admits an embedding of $\mathbb{Q}$, and thus by algebraically prime models, $\mathbb{Q}^{\mathrm{re}}$. □

3.10.4 Hilbert's 17th Problem

Just as QE and completeness of ACF_p gave us the transfer principles needed to prove Ax-Grothendieck, QE and completeness of RCF gives us the transfer principle we need to prove Hilbert's 17th Problem (or rather, its solution, a theorem of Artin) very quickly.

Theorem 3.10.14. *If* $f \in \mathbb{R}(\bar{X}) = \mathbb{R}(X_1, \ldots, X_n)$ *is a rational function such that whenever* $f(\bar{a})$ *with* $\bar{a} \in \mathbb{R}^n$ *is defined,* $f(\bar{a}) \geq 0$*, then* f *is a sum of squares in the field* $\mathbb{R}(\bar{x})$*.*

Proof. Actually, this works if we replace $\mathbb{R}$ with any other real closed field $R \vDash \mathsf{RCF}$. First, we note that there is a formula $\phi(\bar{x})$ (with parameters in R) such that for $\bar{a} \in R^n, R \vDash \phi(\bar{a}) \iff f(\bar{a}) \geq 0$. If $f(\bar{X}) = \frac{p(\bar{X})}{q(\bar{X})}$ is an expression as a reduced fraction of polynomials, we can use $p(\bar{x})q(\bar{x}) \geq 0$ as a proxy.
We then consider the field $R(\bar{X})$ of rational functions with coefficients in R. If $f(\bar{X})$ is not a sum of squares, then we can order $R(\bar{X})$, extending the ordering on R, so that $f(\bar{X}) < 0$. We can then extend this ordering to a real closure of $R(\bar{X})$, which we call F.
By quantifier elimination, or more directly, model completeness, any embedding, including that of R into F, is elementary. Thus

$$F \vDash \forall \bar{x}, \phi(\bar{x}) \geq 0 \iff R \vDash \forall \bar{x}, \phi(\bar{x}) \geq 0.$$

However, this sentence is true by assumption in R, while in F, we find that plugging in the variables themselves makes $f(\bar{X}) < 0$, so $F \vDash \phi(\bar{X}) < 0$, giving us a contradiction. □

3.10.5 Semialgebraic Sets

Quantifier elimination and the structure of atomic formulas tells us that the definable sets in a model of RCF are precisely the *semialgebraic* sets:

Definition 3.10.15. If F is an ordered field, then a subset $D \subseteq F^n$ is *semialgebraic* when it is a boolean combination of sets given by $P(\bar{x}) > 0$ where $P(\bar{x}) \in F[\bar{x}]$.

Theorem 3.10.16. *The theory* RCF *is o-minimal.*

Proof. By quantifier elimination, it suffices to show that any semialgebraic set $D \subseteq \mathcal{M} \vDash \mathsf{RCF}$ is a finite union of intervals, and as these sets are closed under boolean combinations, it suffices to show that each set defined by $P(x) > 0$ is. This polynomial has finitely many zeroes which split the remainder of M into finitely many open intervals. On each of these intervals, by the intermediate value property, either $P(x) > 0$ or $P(x) < 0$, so our set is the union of the finitely many such intervals where $P(x) > 0$. □

There are a variety of results, often stated in terms of semialgebraic sets specifically, which turn out to be true more broadly for definable sets in an o-minimal structure.

Chapter 4

o-Minimality

For this chapter, I will mostly follow the textbook [16], but I will also make use of online notes at [13, 14].

Let's clarify the definitions again.

Definition 4.0.1. A structure $\mathcal{M}$ in a language $\mathcal{L}$ including the symbol $<$ (or $\leq$) is *o-minimal* if $\mathcal{M} \vDash \mathsf{DLO}$ and every definable set $D \subseteq M$ is a finite union of (points and) intervals.
A $\mathcal{L}$-theory T is then o-minimal if every model of T is o-minimal.

4.1 Tame Topology of Ordered Structures

We'll now take a look at how definability and topology relate in ordered and o-minimal structures. If $\mathcal{M} \vDash \mathsf{DLO}$, we always give M the order topology, and M^n the resulting product topology. This topology has as a basis *open boxes*, that is, products of open intervals. To better write formulas about these, let's introduce some notation: Given variable tuples $\bar{x}, \bar{y}$ of length n, let $\bar{x} < \bar{y}$ denote $\bigwedge_{i=1}^{n} x_i < y_i$ and similarly for $\bar{x} \leq \bar{y}$. Then any open box in M^n can be defined by

$$\bar{a} < \bar{x} < \bar{b},$$

where $\bar{a}, \bar{b} \in M^n$. Because of this, we say that the collection of open boxes in M^n is *uniformly definable*: they are all definable by the same formula, but with different parameters plugged in. Because product-order topology has a uniformly definable basis, we call this a *definable topology*. Let's start to see what this definability property does for us:

Lemma 4.1.1. *If $\mathcal{M} \vDash \mathsf{DLO}$ in a language including the symbol $<$, then*

- *whenever $D \subseteq M^n$ is definable, so are $\mathsf{cl}(D), \mathsf{int}(D)$*
- *whenever $A \subseteq B \subseteq M^n$ are definable and A is relatively open in B, this can be witnessed by a definable open $U \subseteq M^n$ with $A = U \cap B$.*

Proof. For the first bullet point, it's enough to show interiors of definable sets are definable, as definable sets are closed under complement. We find that $\bar{x} \in \mathsf{int}(D)$ if there is an open box containing $\bar{x}$ and contained in D:

$$\exists \bar{y}, \bar{z}, (\bar{y} < \bar{x} < \bar{z}) \wedge (\forall \bar{w}, \bar{y} < \bar{w} < \bar{z} \to \bar{w} \in D).$$

We have defined $\mathsf{int}(D)$ here as the union of all open boxes contained in D. In general, a union

of definable sets is not definable, but uniform definability makes this work.
For the second, we can let U be the union of all open boxes whose intersection with B is contained in A. Because of uniform definability of open boxes, this union is definable:

$$\exists \bar{y}, \bar{z}, (\bar{y} < \bar{x} < \bar{z}) \wedge (\forall \bar{w}, \bar{y} < \bar{w} < \bar{z} \wedge \bar{w} \in B \to \bar{w} \in A).$$

□

Corollary 4.1.2. *If $D \subseteq \mathbb{R}^n$ is semialgebraic, so are $\mathsf{cl}(D), \mathsf{int}(D)$.*

4.1.1 Definable Completeness

If we add in the assumption of o-minimality, we can phrase some facts about definability in one dimension more topologically. These follow pretty quickly from D being a finite union of intervals.

Lemma 4.1.3. *Suppose $D \subseteq M$ is a finite union of intervals, such as a definable set in an o-minimal structure. Then the boundary $\mathsf{bd}(D)$ is finite, and if a, b are consecutive points of $\mathsf{bd}(D)$, then either $(a, b) \subseteq D$ or $(a, b) \cap D = \emptyset$.*

Lemma 4.1.4. *If M is o-minimal, then it is* definably complete*:*
If $D \subseteq M$ is definable, then

- *if D is bounded above, D has a least upper bound* $\sup D$
- *if D is bounded below, D has a greatest lower bound* $\inf D$.

4.1.2 Uniform Definability

We have seen how the family of open balls being uniformly definable helps us define topological ideas. We can also view uniformly definable families as the family of fibers of a larger set. To see this, suppose that $|\bar{x}| = m$, $|\bar{y}| = n$, and $\phi(\bar{x}, \bar{y})$ defines a family $\mathcal{F}$ of subsets of M^n, with different parameters $\bar{a} \in M^m$ plugged in for $\bar{x}$ to define the definable sets in $\mathcal{F}$. Then $\phi(\bar{x}, \bar{y})$ itself defines a set $D \subseteq M^{m+n}$, whose *fibers* over different $\bar{x}$-values range over $\mathcal{F}$:

Definition 4.1.5. Given $D \subseteq M^{m+n}$, $\bar{a} \in M^m$, let $D_{\bar{a}} = \{\bar{b} \in M^n : (a, b) \in D\}$. Call this the *fiber over $\bar{a}$*.

As an exercise, show that if D defines a uniformly definable family of fibers, then the following properties are also definable:

Exercise 4.1.6. Given $D \subseteq M^{m+n}$ definable in an ordered structure $\mathcal{M}$, show that

- $\{\bar{a} \in M^m : D_{\bar{a}} \text{ is open}\}$
- $\{(\bar{a}, \bar{b}) \in M^{m+n} : \bar{b} \in \mathsf{int}(D_{\bar{a}})\}$

are both definable.

Exercise 4.1.7. Assume $\mathcal{M}$ is o-minimal.

- Show that if $D \subseteq M$ is definable and infinite, it contains an open interval.
- Show that if $D \subseteq M^{m+1}$, then $\{\bar{a} \in M^m : D_{\bar{a}} \text{ is finite}\}$ is definable.

4.1.3 Definable Connectedness

There is another important topological idea we should think about definably now: connectedness. If a definable set is disconnected, we care whether the connected components can themselves be made definable.

Definition 4.1.8. Call a definable set $D \subseteq M^n$ *definably connected* when it is not the union of two disjoint nonempty definable open sets of D.

Exercise 4.1.9.

- The image of a definably connected $D \subseteq M^m$ under a continuous function $f : D \to M^n$ whose graph is definable is definably connected.
- If $X \subseteq M^m$ is definably connected and $X \subseteq Y \subseteq \mathsf{cl}(X)$ with Y definable, then Y is definably connected.
- If $X, Y \subseteq M^m$ are definably connected and $\mathsf{cl}(X) \cap Y \neq \emptyset$, then $X \cup Y$ is definably connected.
- If $\mathcal{M}$ is definably complete (for instance, if it is o-minimal), then the definably connected sets $D \subseteq M$ are precisely intervals (with any endpoint behavior, including $\pm\infty$).

We call a function $f : D \to M^n$ whose domain and graph are definable sets *a definable function*. As a consequence of this exercise, we are able to deduce the following lemma:

Lemma 4.1.10. *If $\mathcal{M}$ is definably complete and $D \subseteq M$ is definable, then any definable function $f : D \to M$ that is also continuous has the intermediate value property, which we state without reference to 0 as follows: If $a, b \in D$ and $f(a) < m < f(b)$, then there is some c with $a < c < b$ or $b < c < a$ such that $f(c) = m$.*

Proof. Suppose WLOG that $a < b$. We know that $[a, b]$ is definably connected, so $f([a, b])$ is as well. Thus $m \in f([a, b])$, as otherwise we could partition it into two definable open subsets, $f([a, b]) \cap (-\infty, m)$ and $f([a, b]) \cap (m, \infty)$. □

4.1.4 Why topology of definable sets?

Fact 4.1.11. *There exists a real closed field, for instance* real Puiseux series*, which is not a complete order and is totally disconnected in the order topology.*

For the construction of this example, see [14] and [3, Section 2.6].

This shows us that we not all sets in this real closed field behave topologically as they do in $\mathbb{R}$, so we cannot use the order topology in the way we are accustomed to. However, if we restrict our attention to definable sets, their topological behavior, sometimes called *tame topology*, is much

better, as we know this o-minimal structure must be definably complete with definably connected intervals.

4.2 Classifying O-Minimal Structures

We have already seen some examples of o-minimal theories and thus o-minimal structures. These include models of $\mathsf{DLO}, \mathsf{ODAG}, \mathsf{OVS}_K$, and RCF. We will see that these examples are particularly important, first by seeing that ODAG is *the only* o-minimal theory of groups.

Theorem 4.2.1. *Let $\mathcal{L}$ be a language extending $\mathcal{L}_{+,<}$, and suppose that $\mathcal{M}$ is a $\mathcal{L}$-structure satisfying the theory of ordered groups, which is o-minimal. Then $\mathcal{M} \vDash \mathsf{ODAG}$.*

Proof. Any ordered group is torsion-free, and any o-minimal structure, being a model of DLO, is infinite, and thus nontrivial. To show that $\mathcal{M}$ is abelian and divisible, we will analyze its definable subgroups.

Lemma 4.2.2. *The only definable subgroups of $\mathcal{M}$ are $\{0\}, M$.*

Proof. Let G be a definable subgroup.
First, we see that o-minimality requires that G is convex. If not, we can find $g \in G$ and $m \in M \setminus G$ with $0 < m < g$. Then we can contradict o-minimality by forming the sequence

$$0 < m < g < m + g < 2g + m + 2g < 3g < \dots,$$

and noting that this alternates between $ng \in G$ and $m + ng \notin G$.
If we have a convex proper subgroup, it must be bounded above, so by definable completeness, let $s = \sup G$. If $s = 0$, then $G = \{0\}$. If not, then let $0 < g < s$. We see that $g, s - g \in (0, s) \subseteq G$, so $s \in G$, and then $s < 2s \in G$, contradicting s being the least upper bound. □

Now, for $a \in \mathcal{M}$, let $C_a = \{b \in M : ab = ba\}$ be the centralizer of a. This is a definable subgroup containing a, so by the lemma, it is M (if $a = 0$, $C_0 = M$ by definition). Thus $\mathcal{M}$ is abelian.
For each $n \geq 2$, $nM = \{na : a \in M\}$ is a nontrivial definable subgroup, and is thus M, so M is divisible. □

Exercise 4.2.3. Let $\mathcal{M} \vDash \mathsf{ODAG}$. Show that $+ : M^2 \to M$ and $- : M \to M$ are continuous with respect to the order topology.

Now we will see that the only o-minimal ordered rings are real closed fields.

Theorem 4.2.4. *Let $\mathcal{L}$ be a language extending $\mathcal{L}_{+,\times,<}$, and suppose that $\mathcal{M}$ is an o-minimal $\mathcal{L}$-structure satisfying the theory of ordered rings. Then $\mathcal{M} \vDash \mathsf{RCF}$.*

Proof. We know that $\mathcal{M} \vDash \mathsf{ODAG}$. For any $a \in R$, aM is also a definable subgroup, which must be all of M, so $\mathcal{M}$ is a division ring.
We now construct a new structure, $\mathcal{P}$, consisting of the positive elements of M, equipped with the group operations $1, \times, <$. This is an ordered group, whose support is a definable subset of M, and whose symbols are definable in $\mathcal{M}$. Thus every definable subset of P is definable in M, and $\mathcal{P}$ is o-minimal. We can conclude that $\mathcal{P} \vDash \mathsf{ODAG}$, and in particular, this group is abelian. This means that $\mathcal{M}$ is an ordered field.
To show that $\mathcal{M} \vDash \mathsf{RCF}$, we will check that polynomials satisfy the intermediate value property.

By (Lemma 4.1.10), it suffices to show that they are definable and continuous. Definability is clear, as polynomials are interpretations of terms, and all that remains to show continuity is to check that multiplication is continuous.

Exercise 4.2.5. Let $\mathcal{M}$ be an ordered division ring. Then $\mathcal{M} \vDash \mathsf{DLO}$ (prove this or assume this). Show that $\times : M^2 \to M$ and $\cdot^{-1} : M \setminus \{0\} \to M$ are continuous with respect to the order topology.

□

All of this can be viewed as special cases of a huge theorem by Peterzil and Starchenko:

Fact 4.2.6 (The Trichotomy Theorem, vaguely[12])**.** *Any o-minimal structure locally (on an open neighborhood of any given point) behaves like one of the following three cases:*

- *trivial (among other things, can't define any group structure)*
- *an ordered vector space (over an ordered division ring) with no additional structure*
- *an expansion of a real closed field.*

One part of this that we have seen is that if a structure is an ordered group, then it is definably an ordered $\mathbb{Q}$-vector space (it's an ODAG). In general, we can define scalar multiplication over even larger division ring, the ring of definable additive maps $M \to M$. This will be what lets us classify so many o-minimal structures as "just" an ordered vector space.

As we study o-minimality more, we will develop the language to state the trichotomy theorem a bit more precisely. It could make a good student presentation to give a brief overview of the original paper, with a precise statement and some idea of the proof techniques. The takeaway for now is that while we will mostly work with o-minimal structures in general, the interesting ones are ordered vector spaces, which we already understand very well, and o-minimal expansions of real closed fields.

We will get into precisely how we can find o-minimal expansions of the real closed field $\mathbb{R}$, but let me introduce you to the simplest important one to describe now:

Fact 4.2.7 (Wilkie)**.** *The structure* $(\mathbb{R}; 0, 1, +, \times, \exp, \leq)$ *is o-minimal, where* $\exp(x)$ *is a unary function symbol for* e^x*.*
The theory of this structure is also model-complete.

This was proven by Wilkie, who also showed that it's possible to add restrictions of other analytic functions while maintaining o-minimality.

4.3 Uniform Finiteness

All of the o-minimal structures we have discussed so far are not just o-minimal structures on their own, they are models of specific o-minimal theories. This will turn out not to be a coincidence, but in the meantime, let's see what o-minimality at the level of a theory tells us.

Theorem 4.3.1. *If* $\mathcal{M}$ *is o-minimal, then* $\mathsf{Th}(\mathcal{M})$ *is o-minimal if and only if* $\mathcal{M}$ *has the* uniform finiteness property*:*
For any definable $D \subseteq M^{n+1}$*, there is some* $k \in \mathbb{N}$ *such that for each* $\bar{a} \in M^n$ *with* $D_{\bar{a}}$ *finite,* $|D_{\bar{a}}| \leq k$*.*

Proof. Suppose for contradiction that every model of $\mathsf{Th}(\mathcal{M})$ is o-minimal, but that there are fibers of D, defined by $\phi(\bar{x}, y)$, of arbitrarily large finite size. If ϕ has parameters, we can just incorporate those into $\bar{x}$ and assume ϕ does not use parameters - each fiber that appeared before will still be a fiber. By an earlier exercise, the set of $\bar{a}$ such that $D_{\bar{a}}$ is finite is definable, so we may intersect D with $\{\bar{a} : D_{\bar{a}} \text{ is finite}\} \times M$ to get a definable set with *only* finite fibers, which still have arbitrarily large finite size. Thus we may assume D has only finite fibers, and that $\mathsf{Th}(\mathcal{M})$ implies a sentence indicating (in any o-minimal structure) that every fiber of the set defined by $\phi(\bar{x}, y)$ is finite, as it does not contain an interval.
Then we add symbols $\bar{c}$ to our language for the variables of $\bar{x}$, and claim that the theory

$$\mathsf{Th}(\mathcal{M}) \cup \{\exists y_1, \ldots, y_k, \bigwedge_{i=1}^{k-1} y_i < y_{i+1} \wedge \bigwedge_{i=1}^{k} \phi(\bar{c}, y_k) : k \in \mathbb{N}\}$$

is finitely satisfiable. Any finite subtheory is implied by

$$\mathsf{Th}(\mathcal{M}) \cup \{\exists y_1, \ldots, y_k, \bigwedge_{i=1}^{k-1} y_i < y_{i+1} \wedge \bigwedge_{i=1}^{k} \phi(\bar{c}, y_k)\}$$

for a particular value of k, and this is satisfied by $\mathcal{M}$ when we interpret $\bar{c}$ so that the fiber of $D_{\bar{c}}$ has size at least k.
By compactness, there is a model $\mathcal{N} \vDash \mathsf{Th}(\mathcal{M})$, which is thus o-minimal, where no fiber of $\phi(\bar{x}, y)$ contains an interval, but where $\bar{c}$ is interpreted so that $\phi(\bar{c}, y)$ has size $\geq k$ for all $k \in \mathbb{N}$, a contradiction.
Now conversely, let's assume that $\mathsf{Th}(\mathcal{M})$ has the uniform finiteness property, and let $\mathcal{N} \vDash \mathsf{Th}(\mathcal{M})$. To show that $\mathcal{N}$ is o-minimal, we will show that the set defined by $\phi(\bar{a}, y)$ must always be a finite union of intervals for all $\phi, \bar{a} \in N^{|x|}$. Let D be the set defined by $\phi(\bar{x}, y)$ in $\mathcal{M}$. Then the set $\{(\bar{a}, b) : b \in \mathsf{bd}(D_{\bar{a}})\}$ is definable, and has only finite fibers, so there is some k bounding the sizes of its fibers. As each fiber $D_{\bar{a}}$ has boundary of size at most k, it is the union of a set of intervals with at most k endpoints. We can write a sentence to this effect:

$$\forall \bar{x}, \exists y_1, \ldots, y_k, \bigwedge_{i=1}^{k-1} (y_i < y_{i+1} \wedge (\forall z, y_i < z < y_{i+1} \to \phi(\bar{x}, z)) \vee (\forall z, y_i < z < y_{i+1} \to \neg\phi(\bar{x}, z)))\,.$$

(Ok, we also need to talk about the rays $(-\infty, y_1), (y_k, \infty)$ - that's easy enough to add.) As $\mathcal{N}$ also satisfies this sentence, we see that the set defined by $\phi(\bar{a}, y)$ in $\mathcal{N}$ is a finite union of intervals with at most k endpoints, as desired. □

It will turn out that unlike most similar model-theoretic properties (such as strong minimality), where we have to require a property to hold of every model of a theory, o-minimality of structures and their theories is the same thing.

Fact 4.3.2. *Every o-minimal structure has the uniform finiteness property, and thus its theory is also o-minimal.*

Proving this will require a tricky induction in dimension, interleaved with the proof of the *cell decomposition theorem*, which will characterize definable sets and functions in o-minimal structures.

4.4 Monotonicity

The first step towards proving uniform finiteness and cell decomposition is a one-dimensional result to understand definable functions. Throughout, unless specified otherwise, we let I be an open interval of M, which may have $\pm\infty$ as one or both endpoints.

First, we will see that any definable $f : I \to M$ has predictable behavior just to the left and right of any point.

Lemma 4.4.1. *Given an open interval I and a definable function $f : I \to M$, we can partition I into definable sets $L_{\bowtie}$ for $\bowtie \in \{<, =, >\}$ such that for $x \in I$, $x \in L_{\bowtie}$ if and only if there is an interval (y, x) on which $z \in (y, x)$ implies $f(z) \bowtie f(x)$.*
Similarly, we can define I into definable sets $R_{\bowtie}$ describing the behavior on the right *of $x \in I$.*

Proof. Given $x \in I$, the three sets

$$D_{\bowtie}(x) = \{z \in I : z < x \wedge f(z) \bowtie f(x)\}$$

for $\bowtie \in \{<, =, >\}$ are definable, and partition $I \cap (-\infty, x)$. Thus we can partition $I \cap (-\infty, x)$ into finitely many intervals, each of which belongs to precisely one of these three sets. Then letting (y, x) be the rightmost of these intervals, we see that $(y, x) \subseteq D_{\bowtie}(x)$, so $x \in L_{\bowtie}$.
We also can check that each $L_{\bowtie}$ is definable.
By symmetry, we see that the sets $R_{\bowtie}$ also partition I. □

Now we will prove a series of lemmas establishing nice local behavior of f, that is, that there is some subinterval $J \subseteq I$ on which f is good. By repeatedly using these to shrink to smaller subintervals, we can establish more constraints on the behavior of f.

Lemma 4.4.2. *Given an open interval I and a definable function $f : I \to M$, there is an open subinterval $J \subseteq I$ on which f is either constant or injective.*

Proof. For all $m \in M$, $f^{-1}(\{m\})$ is definable, so if for some m this preimage is infinite, it contains an interval, on which f is constant.
We thus assume that for each m, $f^{-1}(\{m\})$ is finite, and use this to define $g : f(I) \to I$ so that $g(m)$ is the minimum value with $f(g(m)) = m$. By the construction of g as partial inverse, g is injective. Our assumption also implies that since I is infinite, $f(I)$ is infinite, so $g(f(I))$ is also, containing an interval J. Then f is injective on $g(f(I))$, and thus on J. □

Lemma 4.4.3. *Given an open interval I and a definable function $f : I \to M$, there is an open subinterval $J \subseteq I$ on which f is either constant, increasing, or decreasing.*

Proof. By (Lemma 4.4.2), we may reduce to a subinterval on which f is constant, in which case we are done, or injective.
Assuming injectivity and using (Lemma 4.4.1), we can partition I into intervals, each of which belongs to either $L_<$ or $L_>$, and either $R_<$ or $R_>$. At least one of these intervals must contain an open interval, call this J.
If $J \subseteq L_< \cap R_>$, then we can show that f is increasing on J, and by symmetry if $J \subseteq L_> \cap R_<$, f will be decreasing. To show this, fix $x \in J$. WLOG, we will show that $y > x$ implies $f(y) > f(x)$, or put differently, if $D = \{y \in J : y > x \wedge f(y) > f(x)\}$, then $D = J \cap (x, \infty)$. If not, then by definable completeness, let $d = \sup D$, and we see that $d \in J$. As $d \in L_<$, there is an interval (y, d), on $f(z) < f(d)$. As $(x, d) \subseteq D$, there is some $z \in (y, d) \cap (x, d) \subseteq D$, and we see that

$f(x) < f(z) < f(d)$. As $d \in R_>$, there is an interval (d, y) on which $f(z) > f(d) > f(x)$, and then this whole interval is in D, contradicting the minimality of d.
Now we will rule out the other cases. Without loss of generality, we assume that $J \subseteq L_> \cap R_>$ and prove a contradiction, and the case $J \subseteq L_< \cap R_<$ will be analogous. Basically, we are assuming that every element of J is a local minimum of f.
Let

$$C_{\bowtie} = \{x \in J : \exists y_1, y_2, y_1 < x < y_2 \wedge \forall z_1 \in (y_1, x), z_2 \in (x, z_2), z_1 \bowtie z_2\}.$$

We will show that $C_>$ is infinite, and thus contains a subinterval. We can then reduce J to that subinterval and apply the same logic to find a subinterval of *that* contained in $C_<$. We can then derive a contradiction from the fact that $C_< \cap C_> = \emptyset$.
Let $B = \{x \in J : \forall y \in J, y > x \to f(y) < f(x)\}$. Clearly f is increasing on B - if B contains an interval, reduce J to that. We can now derive a contradiction from $J \subseteq L_>$.
Otherwise, B is finite, and we can reduce J to an interval to the right of all elements of B, and thus assume that $\forall x \in J, \exists y \in J, y > x \wedge f(y) < f(x)$. That is, every element is a local minimum, but globally there is a smaller value somewhere to the right.
Now fix $c \in J$, and we will find that there is $d > c$ with $d \in C_>$. By generality of c, this means $C_>$ is infinite.
Note that we can split $J \cap (c, \infty)$ into intervals on which either $f(x) > f(c)$ or $f(x) < f(c)$, and one of these will be cofinal. Thus for large enough $x \in J$, one of these inequalities holds.
If the inequality that holds eventually is $f(x) < f(c)$, let d be the infimum of the cofinal interval on which this holds. Because $c \in R_>$, we see that $c < d$, and $d \in R_>$, tells us that $f(d) < f(c)$ as well. Then the minimality of d tells us that on the interval to the left of d, $f(x) > f(c)$, while on the interval to the right, $f(x) < f(c)$, so $d \in C_>$.
Now assume that $f(x) > f(c)$ holds eventually, and prove a contradiction to rule it out. Once again, let d be the infimum of the cofinal interval on which this holds. This tells us that on an interval to the left of d, $f(x) < f(c)$, while to the right, $f(x) > f(c)$. Because $d \in L_>$, we must have $f(d) < f(c)$. By our reduction earlier, there is some $e > d$ where $f(e) < f(d)$, however, $e > d$ implies that $f(e) > f(c)$, giving us a contradiction. □

Lemma 4.4.4. *Given an open interval I and a definable function $f : I \to M$, there is an open subinterval $J \subseteq I$ on which f is continuous and either constant, increasing, or decreasing.*

Proof. First, restrict to a subinterval on which f is constant, increasing, or decreasing. Any constant function is continuous, so WLOG, assume f is increasing. Then f is injective, so $f(I)$ is infinite and definable, containing an interval K. Given $r < s$ in K, let $J = (f^{-1}(r), f^{-1}(s))$. We can then see that $f : J \to K$ is also surjective, and any increasing bijection is a homeomorphism. □

Theorem 4.4.5. *If $\mathcal{M}$ is an o-minimal structure and $f : I \to M$ is definable on an interval $I = (a, b)$ (possibly letting $a = -\infty$ and/or $b = +\infty$ to allow unbounded intervals), then f is* piecewise continuous and monotone*, that is,*
there is a finite sequence $a = a_0 < a_1 < \cdots < a_m = b$ such that on each interval (a_i, a_{i+1}), $f|_{(a_i, a_{i+1})}$ is continuous and either constant, increasing, or decreasing.

Proof. First check that the set of points $a \in M$ where f is locally continuous/monotone *at* $a \in M$ is definable. We can do this with local continuity:

$$\forall \varepsilon_1, \varepsilon_2, \varepsilon_1 < f(x) < \varepsilon_2 \wedge \exists \delta_1, \delta_2, \delta_1 < x < \delta_2 \wedge \forall y, \delta_1 < y < \delta_2 \to \varepsilon_1 < f(y) < \varepsilon_2.$$

We can do this similarly with being locally constant, locally increasing, or locally decreasing, and the union of these three definable points we will call the set of points where f is *locally monotone*.

Suppose we show that for each interval I for each f definable on I, there is some open subinterval $J \subseteq I$ where f is continuous and monotone.
Then suppose we fix our original f, I, and let $D \subseteq I$ be the definable set of points where f is locally continuous and monotone. However, the definable set $I \setminus D$ of points where f is not locally continuous and monotone cannot contain an interval, because if it did, that interval would contain a subinterval where f actually *is* continuous and monotone, and that subinterval would have to be contained in D.
Thus $I \setminus D$ is finite, so I can be partitioned into a finite set of points and open intervals, where each of the open intervals is contained in D. On each such open interval, f is locally continuous everywhere, so it is continuous. This interval is definably connected, and the union of three disjoint definable open sets, where f is locally constant, locally increasing, or locally decreasing. Thus it is contained in one of them. □

4.5 Cell Decomposition

O-minimality now describes both definable sets $D \subseteq M$ and definable functions $f : M \to M$ in terms of partitioning M into a finite set of intervals.

We will be able to prove similar results in higher dimensions, but we will instead partition M^{n+1} into *cells*.

Definition 4.5.1. Let $\mathcal{M}$ be an ordered structure. For $n \geq 0$, we define the collection of *n-cells* recursively to be a particular collection of definable subsets of M^n.
The only 0-cell is the entirety of M^0.
An $(n+1)$-cell for $n \geq 0$ is of one of the following two forms, where C is an n-cell:

- $\Gamma_C(f) := \{(a, f(a)) : a \in C\}$, where $f : C \to M$ is definable and continuous
- $(f, g)_C := \{(a, b) : a \in C, f(a) < b < g(a)\}$, where $f, g : C \to M$ are definable and continuous. (We permit f to be $-\infty$ or g to be $+\infty$ for notation's sake.)

Also, we define *open cells* so that the 0-cell is open and the open $(n+1)$-cells are the cells of the form $(f, g)_C$ where C is an open n-cell.

In particular, 1-cells are precisely points and open intervals.

Exercise 4.5.2. A cell is an "open cell" if and only if it is an open set, justifying the notation.

Lemma 4.5.3. *Each cell is definably connected.*

Proof. We know this holds for 1-cells. Given an $(n+1)$-cell C, its projection $\pi(C)$ onto the first n coordinates is an n-cell, which we may assume is definably connected for induction.
Suppose $C \subseteq U \cup V$, where U and V are definable opens with $U \cap V = \emptyset$. Each nonempty fiber $C_{\bar{a}}$ is a point or interval, and is thus definably connected, so belongs to either U or V but not both, so $\pi(U)$ and $\pi(V)$ partition $\pi(C)$. By definable connectedness of $\pi(C)$, one of these is $\pi(C)$, and the other is empty. □

We can now state the main part of the cell decomposition theorem:

Theorem 4.5.4 (Cell Decomposition)**.** *If $\mathcal{M}$ is o-minimal and $D_1, \ldots, D_m \subseteq M^n$ are definable, then there is a finite set $\mathcal{C}$ of cells partitioning M such that each D_i is a union of cells in $\mathcal{C}$.*

In the case where $n = 1$, this is just the definition of o-minimality.

We will not prove this by itself, but by induction on n in conjunction with other results, including the generalization to higher dimensions of (part of) the monotonicity theorem:

Theorem 4.5.5 (Piecewise Continuity)**.** *If $\mathcal{M}$ is o-minimal and $f : D \to M$ is a definable function with $D \subseteq M^n$ (which we could call a partial function $M^n \to M$), there is a finite set $\mathcal{C}$ of cells partitioning D such that on each cell $C \in \mathcal{C}$, f is continuous.*

We can prove these two in conjunction if we are willing to assume $\mathsf{Th}(\mathcal{M})$ is o-minimal. In order to show that $\mathsf{Th}(\mathcal{M})$ is o-minimal without assuming it, we need to prove uniform finiteness as part of our induction on dimension. Technically what we'll do is more of a strong induction, but here's the overall sketch:

Theorem 4.5.6. *Let CD_n be the statement of the cell decomposition for sets $\subseteq M^n$, PC_n the statement of the cell decomposition for partial functions $M^n \to M$, and UF_n the uniform finiteness property for sets $\subseteq M^{n+1}$, viewed as families of subsets of M indexed by elements of M^n.*
Then CD_1 is o-minimality, and

$$\mathsf{CD}_n \implies \mathsf{PC}_n \implies \mathsf{UF}_n \implies \mathsf{CD}_{n+1},$$

so in an o-minimal structure $\mathcal{M}$, these properties all hold for all n, and $\mathsf{Th}(\mathcal{M})$ is o-minimal.

4.5.1 Cell Decomposition Induction Step

Fix n, and assume that $\mathsf{CD}_n, \mathsf{PC}_n, \mathsf{UF}_n$ all hold. We will prove CD_{n+1}.

Let $D_1, \ldots, D_k \subseteq M^{n+1}$ be definable sets. Then let $B \subseteq M^{n+1}$ be the definable set whose fibers $B_{\bar{a}} \subseteq M$ are the unions of the boundaries of the fibers $(D_i)_{\bar{a}}$. These are uniformly finite by UF_n, so let r be their maximum size.

Then we can define partial functions $f_1, \ldots, f_r$ such that for each $\bar{a} \in M^n$, $f_i(\bar{a})$ is the ith element, in increasing order, of $B_{\bar{a}}$, if there is one, so that B is the union of the graphs of these functions.

We now start constructing a finite set of definable sets in M^n, for which we will find a cell decomposition by inductive hypothesis.

For each $1 \leq i \leq r$, let F_i be the domain of f_i. For each $1 \leq i \leq r$ and $1 \leq j \leq k$, let G_{ij} be the definable set of $\bar{a} \in F_i$ such that $f_i(\bar{a}) \in (D_j)_{\bar{a}}$.

For notation's sake, let $f_0 = -\infty$ everywhere, with $F_0 = M^n$. For each $0 \leq i < r$ and $1 \leq j \leq k$, let H_{ij} be the definable set of $\bar{a} \in F_{i+1}$ such that $(f_i(\bar{a}), f_{i+1}(\bar{a})) \subseteq (D_j)_{\bar{a}}$. Let I_{ij} be the definable set of $\bar{a} \in F_i \setminus F_{i+1}$ such that $(f_i(\bar{a}), \infty) \subseteq (D_j)_{\bar{a}}$.

We now can construct a cell decomposition $\mathcal{C}$ which partitions each $F_i, G_{ij}, H_{ij}, I_{ij}$ using CD_n, and using PC_n, can further refine it such that on each cell in F_i, f_i is continuous.

Our cell decomposition for M^{n+1} will now consist of the cells $\Gamma_C(f_i)$ for $C \in \mathcal{C}, C \subseteq F_i$, the cells $(f_i, f_{i+1})_C$ for $C \in \mathcal{C}, C \subseteq F_{i+1}$ for $0 \leq i < r$, the cells $(f_i, \infty)_C$ for $C \in \mathcal{C}, C \subseteq F_i \setminus F_{i+1}$. These are valid cells because of the assumption that each f_i defined on $C \in \mathcal{C}$ is continuous.

These cells partition M^{n+1} because $\mathcal{C}$ partitions M^n, and for each $\bar{a} \in C \in \mathcal{C}$, the fiber over $\bar{a}$ is partitioned by the fibers of the cells $\Gamma_C(f_i), (f_i, f_{i+1})_C, (f_i, \infty)_C$.

We now check that each $C \in \mathcal{C}$ is either contained in or disjoint from each D_j. In the case of $\Gamma_C(f_i)$, this is because C is contained in or disjoint from G_{ij}. In the case of $(f_i, f_{i+1})_C$, this is because C is contained in or disjoint from H_{ij}. In the case of $(f_i, \infty)_C$, this is because C is contained in or disjoint from I_{ij}.

4.5.2 Piecewise Continuity Induction Step

Fix n, and assume that $\mathsf{CD}_{n+1}, \mathsf{PC}_n, \mathsf{UF}_n$ all hold. We will prove PC_{n+1}.

For this, we will want two lemmas, starting with a generally useful observation about cells:

Lemma 4.5.7. *If C is an n-cell, then there is an open m-cell for some $m \leq n$, and projection $\pi : M^n \to M^m$ omitting some subset of the variables such that π is a definable homeomorphism from C to an open m-cell U.*
If C is not an open cell, then we can do this with $m < n$.

Proof. We (unsurprisingly by this point) prove this by induction on n. This is trivial for 0-cells, as the only 0-cell is open.
Now assume this is true for all $\leq n$-cells, and consider an $(n+1)$-cell.
If our cell is $\Gamma(f)_C$ for C an n-cell, then it is definably homeomorphic by a projection to C, which by assumption is definably homeomorphic by a projection to an open cell. The homeomorphism can be given by the projection $\pi : \Gamma(f)_C \to C$ in one direction and $\bar{a} \mapsto (\bar{a}, f(\bar{a}))$ in the other.
If our cell is of the form $(f, g)_C$, then by the induction hypothesis, let U be an open cell, and let $\pi : M^n \to M^m$ be a coordinate projection which induces a definable homeomorphism $h : C \to U$. We then see that $(f \circ h^{-1}, g \circ h^{-1})_U$ is an open cell, and claim that the coordinate projection $(\bar{a}, b) \mapsto (\pi(\bar{a}), b)$ gives a definable homeomorphism $(f \circ h^{-1}, g \circ h^{-1})_U \to (f, g)_C$. This definition clearly gives a definable homeomorphism $(-\infty, \infty)_C \to (-\infty, \infty)_U$, and the restriction of this gives the definable homeomorphism we want, as for all $\bar{a} \in C, b \in M$,

$$(\bar{a}, b) \in (f \circ h^{-1}, g \circ h^{-1})_U \iff f(h^{-1}(\bar{a})) \leq b \leq g(h^{-1}(\bar{a})) \iff (h^{-1}(\bar{a}), b) \in (f, g)_C.$$

□

Lemma 4.5.8. *Suppose X is a topological space, D_1, D_2 dense linear orders, and $f : X \times D_1 \to D_2$ a function such that*

- *for each $d \in D_1$, $f(\cdot, d)$ is continuous*
- *for each $x \in X$, $f(x, \cdot)$ is continuous and nondecreasing.*

Then f is continuous.

Proof. Given $(x, d) \in X \times D_1$ and an interval $J \ni f(x, d)$, we want to find a neighborhood $U \ni x$ and an interval $I \ni m$ with $f(U \times I) \subseteq J$.
As $f(x, \cdot)$ is continuous and nondecreasing, let $b, c \in D_1$ be such that $b < d < c$, and $f(x, b), f(x, c) \in J$. Let $I = (b, c)$. By continuity, there exist open neighborhoods U_b, U_c of x such that $f(U_b, b) \subseteq J, f(U_c, c) \subseteq J$. Let $U = U_b \cap U_c$.
Then for $(y, a) \in U \times I$, we have $f(y, b) \leq f(y, a) \leq f(y, c)$, and $f(y, b), f(y, c) \in J$, so $f(y, a) \in J$. □

We now put these together to prove PC_{n+1}. Let $D \subseteq M^{n+1}$ and $f : D \to M$ be definable. Then use CD_{n+1} to find a cell decomposition $\mathcal{C}$ for the sets

- D
- $\{(\bar{a}, b) : f(\cdot, b) \text{ is continuous at } \bar{a}\}$
- $\{(\bar{a}, b) : f(\bar{a}, \cdot) \text{ is continuous at } b\}$
- $\{(\bar{a}, b) : f(\bar{a}, \cdot) \text{ is constant on a neighborhood of } b\}$
- $\{(\bar{a}, b) : f(\bar{a}, \cdot) \text{ is increasing on a neighborhood of } b\}$
- $\{(\bar{a}, b) : f(\bar{a}, \cdot) \text{ is decreasing on a neighborhood of } b\}$.

If $C \in \mathcal{C}$ with $C \subseteq D$ is not open, then it is definably homeomorphic to an open m-cell $U \subseteq C$ with $m \leq n$, with definable homeomorphism $h : C \to U$ given by a coordinate projection. Then we can apply PC_m to $f \circ h^{-1}$ on U, getting a cell decomposition $\mathcal{C}'$ of C where that $f \circ h^{-1}$ is continuous on each cell. We may now replace C with the cells $\{h(C') : C' \in \mathcal{C}'\}$, as the union of these will be $h(U) = C$, and f will be continuous on each.

We now claim that f is continuous on each open cell $C \in \mathcal{C}$. For each $(\bar{a}, b) \in C$, as C is open, we can find an open box $U \ni \bar{a}$ be an open box and an open interval $I \ni b$. We then wish to apply (Lemma 4.5.8) with $X = U, D_1 = I, D_2 = M$.

If we apply PC_n to $f(\cdot, b)$, we can partition U into cells on which $f(\cdot, b)$ is continuous. At least one of these cells must be open, because U is. (We can prove by an easy induction that any open cell is not a finite union of non-open cells at this point, but we will also give a formal proof in the next section.) As $f(\cdot, b)$ is continuous at any point of that open cell, and $U \times \{b\} \subseteq C \in \mathcal{C}$, $f(\cdot, b')$ is continuous at $\bar{a}'$ for all $(\bar{a}', b') \in C$.

Then we also find that there is some subinterval J of I on which $f(\bar{a}, \cdot)$ is continuous and increasing, constant, or decreasing. By the construction of $\mathcal{C}$ again, we may assume this holds on all of I, and for all $\bar{a}' \in U$.

Thus the requirements of (Lemma 4.5.8) are satisfied, unless $f(\bar{a}, \cdot)$ is decreasing, in which case we replace $D_2 = M$ with its order dual.

4.6 Sparsity

Before we do the uniform finiteness induction step, it will help us to examine *sparse* sets.

Definition 4.6.1. A definable set $D \subseteq M^n$ is *sparse* when it has empty interior.

For $D \subseteq M^1$, this is equivalent to being finite.

Lemma 4.6.2. *If $D \subseteq M^{n+1}$ is definable, TFAE:*

1. *D is sparse*
2. *The set D' of $\bar{a} \in M^n$ with $D_{\bar{a}}$ infinite is sparse*
3. *D is nowhere dense (its closure is sparse).*

Proof. We will prove this in the case $n = 1$, and leave the rest as an exercise.
In this $n = 1$ case, for (1) $\implies$ (2), we must show that D' is finite. If not, then it contains an interval, and for each $\bar{a} \in D'$, $D_{\bar{a}}$ contains an interval. Define the partial function $f(\bar{x})$ so that $f(\bar{x})$ is the least element of $D_{\bar{x}}$ such that $D_{\bar{a}}$ contains an interval above $f(\bar{x})$, and similarly, let $g(\bar{x})$ be the least element such that $(f(\bar{x}), g(\bar{x})) \subseteq D_{\bar{x}}$.
For any $\bar{a} \in D'$, these are defined unless $D_{\bar{a}}$ is unbounded in some direction.

Using the definition of o-minimality, we can find an open interval $I \subseteq D'$ where $D_{\bar{a}}$ is either bounded above or unbounded above, and similarly below, on the entire interval. If f is not defined on I, we replace it with $-\infty$ and adjust the definition of g accordingly. If g is not defined on I, we replace it with $+\infty$.
If we apply monotonicity to f, g, we find that there is an open interval $J \subseteq I$ on which both are continuous. Thus $(f, g)_J \subseteq D$ is an open cell contained in D, so D has nonempty interior, and is not sparse.
For (2) $\implies$ (3), we will assume D' is finite and show that if $U \subseteq M^2$ is an open box, D is not dense in U. At any $\bar{a} \in \pi(U)$, $D_{\bar{a}} = (D \cap U)_{\bar{a}} \cup (U \setminus D)_{\bar{a}}$. One of these must be infinite, but the set of points for which $(D \cap U)_{\bar{a}}$ is infinite is a subset of D', and thus finite. Thus the set of points for which $U \setminus D$ is infinite is infinite, so $U \setminus D$ is not sparse, and instead has nonempty interior, showing that D is not dense in U.
The last implication (3) $\implies$ (1) follows by definition. □

Exercise 4.6.3. Finish the proof of (Lemma 4.6.2) for arbitrary n.

We now see that any set with only finite fibers is sparse, and the closure of any sparse set is also sparse. For these reasons, we will want to prove uniform finiteness at the generality of sparse sets, rather than just sets with finite fibers. Before we do that, a few more observations:

Exercise 4.6.4. A cell is sparse if and only if it is not open.

As a finite union of sparse sets is sparse, we get the following corollary:

Corollary 4.6.5. *No open cell is a finite union of non-open cells.*

4.6.1 Uniform Finiteness Induction Step

Fix n, and assume that $\mathsf{CD}_n, \mathsf{PC}_n, \mathsf{UF}_{n-1}$ all hold. We will prove UF_n.

Let $D \subseteq M^{n+1}$ be sparse, we will show that its finite fibers have a uniform size.

Define $G(D) \subseteq M^n$ to be the union of all *good* open boxes: boxes B above which all fibers of D are finite and such that for all $(\bar{a}, b) \in D \cap (B \times M)$, there exists an open interval $I \ni b$ such that $D \cap (B \times I) = \Gamma(f)_B$ for some continuous function $f : B \to I$. Because open boxes are uniformly definable, to show G is definable, we just need to show that the set of parameters of good boxes is definable. A definable set being the graph of a function amounts to checking that each fiber is a singleton (which is definable). We can then check continuity with the definable condition that for all intervals $J \subseteq I$, there is an open sub-box B' such that $D \cap (B' \times I) \subseteq B' \times J$.

Lemma 4.6.6. *On a good open box B, the fibers of D all have the same size.*

Proof. Let $\bar{a} \in B$, and let $|D_{\bar{a}}| = k$.
Then we can enumerate $D_{\bar{a}} = \{b_1, \ldots, b_k\}$ with $b_1 < \cdots < b_k$, and find intervals $I_i \ni b_i$ such that $D \cap (B \times I_i)$ is the graph of a continuous function $f_i : B \to I_i$, which is necessarily definable.
Let's show that $f_1 < \cdots < f_k$ everywhere, not just at $\bar{a}$. For each $i < j$, the set of points where $f_i < f_j$ or $f_i > f_j$ are definable and open. We'll show that the set of points where $f_i = f_j$ is also open. By definable connectedness, this partitions B into 3 definable open pieces, so the piece where $f_i < f_j$ must be all of B. To see this, suppose $f_i(\bar{a}') = f_j(\bar{a}')$. Then by continuity, there is an open set $U \ni \bar{a}'$ such that $f_j(U) \subseteq I_i$. Thus $\Gamma_U(f_j) \subseteq D \cap (B \times I_i) = \Gamma_U(f_i)$, so $f_i = f_j$ on the open neighborhood U.

This tells us that for each $\bar{a}' \in B$, $|D_{\bar{a}'}| \geq k = |D_{\bar{a}}|$, so by symmetry, $|D_{\bar{a}'}| = |D_{\bar{a}}|$. $\square$

Now apply CD_n to find a cell decomposition that partitions $G(\mathrm{cl}(D))$ and the set of $\bar{a}$ for which $\mathrm{cl}(D)_{\bar{a}}$ is infinite.

On any non-open cell $C \in \mathcal{C}$, if $\pi : C \to U$ is a projection that is a definable homeomorphism to an open m-cell U with $m < n$, and $\pi'(\bar{x}, y) = (\pi(\bar{x}), y)$ attaches another variable to the projection, then $\pi'(D \cap (C \times M)) = \pi'(D) \cap (U \times M)$, which must have only finite fibers over U, which are uniformly bounded by UF_m.

We now get to the main story, of open cells $C \in \mathcal{C}$. Firstly, we note that over an open cell C, all fibers of $\mathrm{cl}(D)$ are finite, as otherwise the set of infinite fibers must contain all of C, and thus would not be sparse. Thus if we can bound the size of all of these fibers, that bound will also bound the fibers of D. At this point, we're only talking about $\mathrm{cl}(D)$, so for notation's sake, let's just assume D is closed.

Either $C \subseteq G(D)$ or $C \cap G(D) = \emptyset$. If $C \subseteq G(D)$, then we know that C is a union of good open boxes on which the size of fibers is constant. Thus for each k, the set $\{\bar{a} \in C : |D_{\bar{a}}| = k\}$ is not only definable but open. By definable completeness, there is thus one k for which $|D_{\bar{a}}| = k$ on all of C.

By construction of this cell decomposition, the only other case is $C \cap G(D) = \emptyset$. We can rule this out by finding an a good box within C.

Call a point $\bar{a} \in M^{n+1}$ *normal* if there is an open box $B \ni \bar{a}$ such that $D \cap B$ is either empty or the graph of a continuous function. This is definable, although that may not be immediately obvious. We quantify several times over open boxes and intervals, but this is fine, because those are uniformly definable. It should then be clear that $D \cap B$ being empty is definable in terms of the parameters of D, B, and so is it being the graph of a function (every fiber is a singleton). Being the graph of a *continuous* function just adds that for all intervals $I \subseteq M$, if $D \cap B$ intersects $M^n \times I$, then there is an open subbox $B' \subseteq \pi(B) \subseteq M^n$ such that $D \cap B \cap (B' \times M) \subseteq M^n \times I$. This is also definable given uniform definability of intervals and boxes.

Now, given $\bar{a} \in M^n$, let $\beta(\bar{a})$ be the infimum of all b such that $(\bar{a}, b)$ is normal, if any such b exists. This is a definable (partial) function. We can define two more definable partial functions, α, γ, such that $\alpha(\bar{a})$ is the greatest element of $D_{\bar{a}}$ less than $\beta(\bar{a})$ if any exists, and $\gamma(\bar{a})$ is the least element of $D_{\bar{a}}$ greater than $\beta(\bar{a})$ if any exists. Let $\mu(\bar{a})$ be the maximum element of $D_{\bar{a}}$ if any exists.

Now apply CD_n and PC_n to form a cell decomposition $\mathcal{C}'$ partitioning C and the domains of α, β, γ and the set $\{\bar{a} : (\bar{a}, \beta(\bar{a})) \in D\}$, such that on each cell α, β, γ are continuous. This cell decomposition splits C into a finite union of cells, one of which must be open, call this C'. We will show that C' contains a good box.

Lemma 4.6.7. *If $\bar{a} \in C'$, then $(\bar{a}, b)$ is normal.*

Proof. This amounts to showing that $\beta(\bar{a})$ is not defined. If it is, then β is defined and continuous on all of C'. To derive a contradiction, we consider the behavior of α, β, γ on C'. Technically, we have 8 cases to consider here, depending on whether α, γ are each defined, and whether $\Gamma(\beta)_{C'}$ is a subset of D or disjoint from it.

If α, γ are both defined, then $\Gamma(\beta)_C \subseteq (\alpha, \gamma)_{C'}$, and $D \cap (\alpha, \gamma)_{C'}$ is either $\emptyset$ or $\Gamma(\beta)_{C'}$. In either case, we find that $(\bar{a}, \beta(\bar{a}))$ is actually normal, giving us a contradiction, because there is open box B around it lying entirely in the open cell $(\alpha, \gamma)_{C'}$, so $D \cap B = \Gamma(\beta) \cap B$, making our point normal.

If α is not defined, we can replace it with $-\infty$ in the above argument, and if γ is not defined, we can replace it with $+\infty$. $\square$

Now suppose $\bar{a} \in C'$. The fiber $D_{\bar{a}}$ is finite, and for each $b_i \in D_{\bar{a}}$, $(\bar{a}, b_i)$ is contained in an open box $B_i \times I_i$ on which D is empty or the graph of a continuous function. Let $B = \bigcap_i B_i$, and because $D' = D \cap (B \times (M \setminus \bigcup_i I_i))$ is closed, the projection $\pi(D')$ of that set is closed in B. By construction, the fiber $D_{\bar{a}}$ is contained in $\bigcup_i I_i$, so $\bar{a} \notin \pi(D')$. We can thus let $B' \subseteq B \setminus \pi(B)$ be an open box

containing $\bar{a}$ disjoint from $\pi(D')$. We then see that $D \cap (B' \times M)$ is contained in $\bigcup_i (B' \times I_i)$, and the intersection of D with this set is a finite union of graphs of continuous functions, so B' is good.

Chapter 5

Dimension Theory

5.1 Dimension

All of this section is in the context of an o-minimal structure $\mathcal{M}$.

Definition 5.1.1. Given a cell C, define its *dimension* inductively on n:

- The unique 0-cell has dimension 0.
- If C has dimension d, then $\Gamma(f)_C$ has dimension d.
- If C has dimension d, then $(f, g)_C$ has dimension $d + 1$.

Note that this means an n-cell has dimension n ("full dimension") if and only if it is open, and has dimension 0 iff it is finite iff it is a singleton.

Definition 5.1.2. Given a definable set D, define its dimension to be the dimension of the largest cell $C \subseteq D$.
If there is no such cell, then $D = \emptyset$, and we say $\dim D = -\infty$.

This tells us that a definable set $D \subseteq M^n$ has dimension n if and only if it contains an open cell, and by cell decomposition, D has dimension 0 iff it is finite.

This also tells us that dimension is monotone ($X \subseteq Y$ implies $\dim(X) \leq \dim(Y)$).

Lemma 5.1.3. *If $f : C \to D$ is an injective definable function between definable sets C, D, then* $\dim(C) \leq \dim(D)$.

Proof. By a series of reductions, we will construct a *continuous* injective definable function $f' : C' \to D'$ between open cells C' and D' with the same dimensions as C and D. We will then show that $\dim(C') \leq \dim(D')$.
As C contains a cell of dimension $\dim(C)$, we can assume that C is that cell. By composing with a definable homeomorphism, we may assume that C is an open n-cell, so $\dim(C) = n$.
Partition $f(C) = D_1 \cup \cdots \cup D_k$ into cells, and note that $C = f^{-1}(D_1) \cup \cdots \cup f^{-1}(D_k)$. If we split each of *these* into cells, we see that this partition of C into cells must contain an open cell of the same dimension as C. By reducing C to that open cell, and D to whichever cell D_i contains $f(C)$. By composing with another definable homeomorphism, we may assume D is an open cell

without changing its dimension. Finally by piecewise continuity, find cell decomposition for C into cells on which f is continuous. One of those cells must be open, so we can reduce C to that cell.
We now show that after these reductions, $\dim(C) \leq \dim(D)$. We show this by induction on $\dim(C)$, noting that for $\dim(C) = 0$, it is trivial.
Now assume this holds whenever $\dim(C) \leq n$, and let $\dim(C) = n+1$. Suppose for contradiction that $\dim(D) \leq n$. As C is open, find an open box $B \times (a, b) \subseteq C$ where $a, b \in M$. Now pick $c \in (a, b)$ and define g on B by $f(\cdot, c)$. By the induction hypothesis, $n \leq \dim(g(B)) \leq \dim(D)$, so we may assume $\dim(D) = n$. Because $g(B)$ has full dimension, it has nonempty interior, so let $x \in B$ be such that $f(x, c) = g(x) \in \operatorname{int}(g(B))$. Then by continuity of f, there is some c' (in fact, any c' close to c) such that $f(x, c') \in \operatorname{int}(g(B))$ also. Thus there is some $x' \in B$ with $g(x') = f(x', c) = f(x, c')$, contradicting the injectivity of f. □

Corollary 5.1.4. *If $f : C \to D$ is a definable bijection between definable sets, then* $\dim(C) = \dim(D)$.
In particular, the dimension of a cell is also the dimension of the open cell to which it is definably homeomorphic.

Lemma 5.1.5. *If $X, Y \subseteq M^n$ are definable, then* $\dim(X \cup Y) = \max(\dim(X), \dim(Y))$.

Proof. Let $C \subseteq X \cup Y$ be a cell of dimension $d = \dim(X \cup Y)$, and let $\pi : C \to C' \subseteq M^d$ be a definable homeomorphism to an open d-cell.
We then have $C' = \pi(X) \cup \pi(Y)$, so we can partition C' into cells, each of which is contained in $\pi(X)$ or $\pi(Y)$. One of these cells is open, so WLOG let C_X be an open cell with $C_X \subseteq \pi(X)$. Because C_X is open in $\pi(X)$, and $\pi : C \to C'$ is a definable homeomorphism, if we restrict the codomain to C_X, we get a definable homeomorphism to a subcell of C with dimension d. Thus $\dim(X) \geq \dim(C_X) = d$.
In general, we have found that $\dim(X \cup Y) \leq \dim(X)$ or $\dim(X \cup Y) \leq \dim(Y)$, completing the proof. □

Corollary 5.1.6. *Any cell decomposition of a definable set $D \subseteq M^n$ contains a cell of the same dimension as D.*

Proof. By induction, $\dim(\bigcup_{i=1}^{k} C_i) = \max_i \dim(C_i)$. □

Lemma 5.1.7. *Let $D \subseteq M^m \times M^n$ be definable, and given a dimension $d \in \{-\infty\} \cap \mathbb{N}$, define*

$$D(d) = \{\bar{a} \in M^m : \dim(D_{\bar{a}}) = d\}.$$

Then $D(d)$ is definable, and the dimension of $\{(\bar{a}, \bar{b}) : \bar{a} \in D(d)\}$ is $\dim(D(d)) + d$.

Proof. First, we consider what happens if C is a cell, which follows largely by definition.

Exercise 5.1.8. If C is a cell, and we let $\pi : M^{m+n} \to M^m$ be the projection, then both the projection $\pi(C)$ is a cell and every fiber $C_{\bar{a}} \subseteq M^n$ is a cell of the same dimension. Furthermore, for any $\bar{a} \in \pi(C)$, $\dim(C) = \dim(\pi(C)) + \dim(C_{\bar{a}})$.

We now construct a cell decomposition $\mathcal{C}$ for D, noting that in our construction, we may assume that the projections of cells in $\mathcal{C}$ are either equal or disjoint, forming a cell decomposition for

$\pi(D)$. Let that cell decomposition be $\mathcal{P}$. Then for any $P \in \mathcal{P}$, the original cell decomposition $\mathcal{C}$ partitions $D \cap (P \times M^n)$ into cells with projection P. If these cells are $C_1, \ldots, C_k$, then for any $\bar{a} \in P$, $D_{\bar{a}} = \bigcup_{i=1}^k (C_i)_{\bar{a}}$, so $\dim(D_{\bar{a}}) = \max_{i=1}^k \dim((C_i)_{\bar{a}})$, which does not depend on the choice of $\bar{a}$. Thus each $D(d)$ is a union of a subset $\mathcal{P}_d \subseteq \mathcal{P}$, and is thus definable.
Thus also $\{(\bar{a}, \bar{b}) : \bar{a} \in D(d)\}$ is the disjoint union of all cells $C \in \mathcal{C}$ with $\dim(\pi(C)) = d$, or put in other words, $\pi(C) \in \mathcal{P}_d$. The dimension of any such C is $\dim(C) = \dim(C_{\bar{a}}) + d$ for any $\bar{a} \in \pi(C)$. The dimension of $\{(\bar{a}, \bar{b}) : \bar{a} \in D(d)\}$ is then

$$\max_{C \in \mathcal{P}_d} \dim(C) = \max_{C \in \mathcal{P}_d} \dim(C_{\bar{a}}) + d = \dim(D(d)) + d.$$

□

Corollary 5.1.9. *If X, Y are definable, then* $\dim(X \times Y) = \dim(X) + \dim(Y)$.

We know that $D \subseteq M^n$ having full dimension is equivalent to having a nonempty interior in M^n. We can extend this to a few more topological statements, allowing us to understand how dimension and subspace topologies relate.

First, recall from basic point-set topology that if $A \subseteq B \subseteq X$, then the closure of A in the subspace topology of B is $\mathrm{cl}_B(A) = \mathrm{cl}_X(A) \cap B$, while for interiors, all we can say is $\mathrm{int}_X(A) \subseteq \mathrm{int}_B(A)$. Thus defining the boundary also depends on which subspace we evaluate in, but the *frontier*, defined by $\partial A = \mathrm{cl}(A) \setminus A$, will satisfy $\partial_B(A) = \partial_X(A) \cap B$.

Lemma 5.1.10. *For $D \subseteq M^n$ definable,* $\dim(\partial D) < \dim(D)$.

Proof. If $\mathcal{C}$ is a partition of D into cells, then $\mathrm{cl}(D) = \bigcup_{C \in \mathcal{C}} \mathrm{cl}(C)$, so $\partial D \subseteq \bigcup_{C \in \mathcal{C}} \partial C$. Thus we can assume that D is a cell.

Exercise 5.1.11. If C is a cell, construct an explicit cell decomposition for $\mathrm{cl}(C)$ and use it to show that $\dim(\partial C) < \dim(C)$.

□

Corollary 5.1.12. *For $D \subseteq M^n$ definable,* $\dim(\mathrm{cl(D)}) = \dim(D)$.

Lemma 5.1.13. *For $D \subseteq E \subseteq M^n$ definable, if* $\dim(D) = \dim(E)$, *then* $\dim(\mathrm{bd}_E(D)) < \dim(D) = \dim(\mathrm{int}_E(D))$, *and in particular, D has nonempty interior in E.*

Proof. It suffices to prove $\dim(\mathrm{bd}_E(D)) < \dim(D)$. We can split the boundary $\mathrm{bd}_E(D) = \partial_E(D) \cup \partial_E(E \setminus D)$ as a disjoint union of frontiers. Then as $\dim(D) = \dim(E \setminus D) = \dim(E)$, it suffices without loss of generality to show that $\dim(\partial_E(D)) < \dim(D)$, but this follows as $\partial_E(D) \subseteq \partial(D)$ and $\dim(\partial(D)) < \dim(D)$. □

5.2 Euler Characteristic

As one application of the o-minimal notion of dimension, we will use it to define the Euler characteristic of definable sets. Again, all of this is in the context of an o-minimal structure $\mathcal{M}$.

Definition 5.2.1. Given a partition $\mathcal{C}$ of a set D into cells, let

$$E_{\mathcal{C}}(D) = \sum_{C \in \mathcal{C}} (-1)^{\dim(C)}$$

be the *Euler characteristic* of D with respect to $\mathcal{C}$.
We will show that $E_{\mathcal{C}}(D)$ depends only on D, but not $\mathcal{C}$. After this point, it will make sense to drop the subscript refer to it simply as $E(D)$.

We will also eventually show that Euler characteristic is invariant under definable bijections. To do this, we need a bit more notation about some cell decompositions.

Definition 5.2.2. Given a collection $\mathcal{C}$ of $(n+1)$-cells, let $\pi\mathcal{C} = \{\pi(C) : C \in \mathcal{C}\}$, where $\pi : M^{n+1} \to M^n$ is the usual projection.
Call a partition $\mathcal{C}$ of $D \subseteq M^n$ into cells a *proper cell decomposition* when it satisfies the following inductive definition:

- For $D \subseteq M^0, D \subseteq M^1$, any partition is a proper cell decomposition.
- $\mathcal{C}$ partitioning $D \subseteq M^{n+1}$ into cells is a proper cell decomposition if $\pi\mathcal{C}$ is also.

Lemma 5.2.3. *For any proper cell decomposition $\mathcal{C}$ of a cell C,*

$$E_{\mathcal{C}}(C) = (-1)^{\dim(C)}.$$

Proof. Let C be an n-cell and induct on n. As usual, the base case $n = 0$ is trivial.
Assume this works for all n-cells, we will prove this for cells $\Gamma_C(f)$ and $(f, g)_C$. In either case, let $\mathcal{C}$ be a proper cell decomposition of that cell, and note that $\pi\mathcal{C}$ is a proper cell decomposition of C, so $E_{\pi\mathcal{C}}(C) = (-1)^{\dim(C)}$.
In the case of $\Gamma_C(f)$, we can see that each cell of $\mathcal{C}$, to be contained in the graph of f, must be of the form $\Gamma_P(f)$ for a distinct $P \in \pi\mathcal{C}$. Thus as for any cell C', $\dim(\Gamma_{C'}(f)) = \dim(C')$, we have

$$E_{\mathcal{C}}(\Gamma_C(f)) = \sum_{P \in \pi\mathcal{C}} (-1)^{\dim(\Gamma_P(f))} = \sum_{P \in \pi\mathcal{C}} (-1)^{\dim(P)} = E_{\pi\mathcal{C}}(C) = (-1)^{\dim(C)}.$$

In the case of $(f, g)_C$, we can partition $\mathcal{C}$ into collections based on their projection. for $P \in \pi\mathcal{C}$, let

$$\mathcal{C}_P = \{C' \in \mathcal{C} : \pi C' = P\}$$

so that

$$\mathcal{C} = \bigcup_{P \in \pi\mathcal{C}} \mathcal{C}_P$$

is a partition.
Then

$$E_{\mathcal{C}}((f, g)_C) = \sum_{P \in \pi\mathcal{C}} \sum_{C' \in \mathcal{C}_P} (-1)^{\dim(C')}.$$

We will check that for each P, $\sum_{C' \in \mathcal{C}_P} (-1)^{\dim(C')} = (-1)^{\dim(P)+1}$, so we then can conclude that

$$E_{\mathcal{C}}((f, g)_C) = \sum_{P \in \pi\mathcal{C}} (-1)^{\dim(P)+1} = -E_{\pi\mathcal{C}}(C) = (-1)^{\dim(C)+1}$$

as desired.
For each P, $\mathcal{C}_P$ must itself be a partition of $(f,g)_P$ into cells whose projection is P. If F is the finite set of functions f_i such that $\Gamma_P(f_j)$ $(f_i, f_j)_P$ appears, we can check that these functions can be ordered such that $F = \{f_0, \dots, f_k\}$ with

$$f = f_0 < \cdots < f_k = g$$

on P, so to be a partition, $\mathcal{C}_P$ must consist of each cell $\Gamma_P(f_i)$ for $0 < i < k$ and $(f_i, f_{i+1})_P$ for $0 \leq i < k$. We thus have $k-1$ cells of dimension $\dim(P)$ and k cells of dimension $\dim(P)+1$, so

$$\sum_{C' \in \mathcal{C}_P} (-1)^{\dim(C')} = (k-1)(-1)^{\dim(P)} + k(-1)^{\dim(P)+1} = (-1)^{\dim(P)+1}.$$

□

Lemma 5.2.4. *If D is a definable set and $\mathcal{C}_1, \mathcal{C}_2$ are partitions of D into cells, there is a proper cell decomposition $\mathcal{C}$ refining both of these partitions.*

Proof. The proof of Cell Decomposition (Theorem 4.5.4) constructs proper cell decompositions, so we can just find a proper cell decomposition for the collection of definable sets $\mathcal{C}_1 \cup \mathcal{C}_2$, and let $\mathcal{C}$ consist of all the cells in this decomposition that are subsets of D. □

Theorem 5.2.5. *If D is a definable set and $\mathcal{C}_1, \mathcal{C}_2$ are partitions of D into cells, then*

$$E_{\mathcal{C}_1}(D) = E_{\mathcal{C}_2}(D),$$

allowing us to drop the subscript from our notation.

Proof. Let $\mathcal{C}$ refine both of these, and we will show that $E_{\mathcal{C}_1}(D) = E_{\mathcal{C}}(D)$. By splitting $\mathcal{C}$ into proper cell decompositions of the cells of $\mathcal{C}_1$, we see that

$$E_{\mathcal{C}}(D) = \sum_{C \in \mathcal{C}_1} \sum_{C' \in \mathcal{C} : C' \subseteq C} (-1)^{\dim(C')},$$

and for each $C \in \mathcal{C}_1$, by (Lemma 5.2.3),

$$\sum_{C' \in \mathcal{C} : C' \subseteq C} (-1)^{\dim(C')} = (-1)^{\dim(C)},$$

so

$$E_{\mathcal{C}}(D) = \sum_{C \in \mathcal{C}_1} (-1)^{\dim(C)} = E_{\mathcal{C}_1}(D).$$

□

We can now calculate how Euler characteristic depends on some basic set operations.

Lemma 5.2.6. *For $D_1, D_2 \subseteq M^n$ definable, we have*

$$E(D_1 \cup D_2) = E(D_1) + E(D_2) - E(D_1 \cap D_2).$$

Proof. First, we see that if $D_1 \cap D_2 = \emptyset$, we can just sum over cells in two partitions to get $E(D_1) + E(D_2)$.
Then we partition $D_1 \cup D_2$ into disjoint sets $D_1 \setminus D_2, D_1 \cap D_2, D_2 \cap D_1$. As the Euler characteristics

of the first two add to $E(D_1)$, and of the second two add to $E(D_2)$, we can solve for the Euler characteristics of all three, and get

$$\begin{aligned} E(D_1 \cup D_2) &= (E(D_1) - E(D_1 \cap D_2)) + E(D_1 \cap D_2) + (E(D_2) - E(D_1 \cap D_2)) \\ &= E(D_1) + E(D_2) - E(D_1 \cap D_2). \end{aligned}$$

□

Lemma 5.2.7. *If $D \subseteq M^{m+n}$ is definable and $\mathcal{C}$ is a proper cell decomposition for D, then if $\pi : M^{m+n} \to M^m$ and $P \in \pi\mathcal{C}$, there is some e_P such that*

- $\forall \bar{a} \in P, E(D_{\bar{a}}) = e_P$
- $E(D \cap (P \times M^n)) = E(P)e_P$.

Proof. For any $P \in \pi\mathcal{C}$, the projection of each cell in $\mathcal{C}$ is either P or disjoint from it. Thus $\mathcal{C}_P = \{C \in \mathcal{C} : \pi(C) = P\}$ is a proper cell decomposition for $D \cap (P \times M^n)$. For each $\bar{a} \in P$, this induces a proper cell decomposition of $D_{\bar{a}}$ consisting of exactly the fibers of the cells of $\mathcal{C}_P$. Thus $E(D_{\bar{a}}) = \sum_{C \in \mathcal{C}_P} E(C_{\bar{a}}) = \sum_{C \in \mathcal{C}_P} (-1)^{\dim(C_{\bar{a}})}$. For each $C \in \mathcal{C}_P$, as $\pi(C) = P$, $\dim(C_{\bar{a}}) = \dim(C) - \dim(P)$ holds for all $\bar{a} \in P$. Thus for each $\bar{a} \in P$,

$$E(D_{\bar{a}}) = (-1)^{\dim(P)} \sum_{C \in \mathcal{C}_P} (-1)^{\dim(C)},$$

so we can let $e_P = \sum_{C \in \mathcal{C}_P} (-1)^{\dim(C)}$. □

This has a few straightforward corollaries:

Corollary 5.2.8. *If $D \subseteq M^{m+n}$ is definable, then $\pi(D) \subseteq M^m$ can be partitioned into finitely many sets on which $E(D_{\bar{a}})$ is constant.*
If $E(D_{\bar{a}})$ is constant on all of $\pi(D)$ with value e, then

$$E(D) = E(\pi(D))e.$$

If $C \subseteq M^m, D \subseteq M^n$ are definable, $E(C \times D) = E(C)E(D)$.

We now work towards proving definable invariance.

Lemma 5.2.9. *Given a definable set $D \subseteq M^n$ and a permutation $\sigma \in S_n$, applying σ to the coordinates of D does not change $E(D)$.*

Proof. By additivity, it suffices to show this for a cell $C \subseteq M^n$. As permutations are generated by transpositions $(i, i+1)$, these transpositions will suffice. Let $\sigma : M^n \to M^n$ be the map swapping these coordinates.
We can then split up the coordinates as $M^n = M^{i+1} \times M^{n-(i+1)}$. The set of fibers in $M^{n-(i+1)}$ given by $C_{\bar{a}}$ and $(\sigma(C))_{\bar{a}}$ is the same, so there is some e that is the Euler characteristic of all fibers of each. Thus $E(C) = E(\pi(C))e$ and $E(\sigma(C)) = E(\pi(\sigma(C)))e$, so as $\pi(\sigma(C)) = \sigma(\pi(C))$, we can reduce to the case of $C = \pi(C)$ and assume $n = i + 1$.
We can now split up the coordinates as $M^n = M^{i-1} \times M^2$, and see that while the fibers may be different, the projections $\pi(C), \pi(\sigma(C)) \subseteq M^{i-1}$ are the same. Thus if we fix $\bar{a} \in \pi(C)$, it will suffice to show that $E(C_{\bar{a}}) = E(\sigma(C_{\bar{a}}))$. Reducing C to $C_{\bar{a}}$, we can assume $i = 1, n = 2$.
We will show that C an be partitioned into cells which remain cells after applying σ. By finite

additivity, we can then assume C is such a cell, and calculate

$$E(\sigma(C)) = (-1)^{\dim(\sigma(C))} = (-1)^{\dim(C)} = E(C).$$

In two dimensions, there are only 4 types of cell:

- $\Gamma_{\{a\}}(f)$, a singleton
- $(f,g)_{\{a\}}$
- $\Gamma_I(f)$ where I is an open interval
- $(f,g)_I$ where I is an open interval.

Applying σ to a singleton gives another singleton.
Applying σ to $(f,g)_{\{a\}}$ gives $\Gamma_I(h)$, where $h(x) = a$, and $I = (f(a), g(a))$.
For $\Gamma_I(f)$, we apply monotonicity and split I into points and open intervals on which f is monotone. This splits $\Gamma_I(f)$ into singletons and graphs of f over subintervals, so let's assume f is monotone.
The case where f is constant is symmetrical to the case of $(f,g)_{\{a\}}$ above.
Now WLOG we may assume f is increasing. Then f is injective and $f(I)$ is an open interval, so applying σ gives us $\Gamma_{f(I)}(f^{-1})$.
Now we consider $(f,g)_I$. Again, we can partition and assume that f, g are either constant, increasing, or decreasing on I. Even after this, $\sigma((f,g)_I)$ probably has to be partitioned into several pieces, with several cases for what the pieces could look like. For the gory details, see [16, Prop. 2.13], but to illustrate some of what's going on, suppose that after some partitioning, we're looking at a cell (f,g) with f constant and g increasing. Then if $I = (a,b)$, $\lim_{x\to a^-} g(x) = c$ and $\lim_{x\to b^+} g(x) = d$, then we can further partition into $(f,c)_I$ which is a box (and will be after σ) and $(c,g)_I$. We can then compute that $\sigma((c,g)_I) = (g^{-1}, b)_{(c,d)}$. □

Theorem 5.2.10. *If $f : C \to D$ is a definable bijection then $E(C) = E(D)$.*

Proof. Assume $C \subseteq M^m$, $D \subseteq M^n$ and let $\Gamma(f) \subseteq M^{m+n}$ be the graph of f. The projection of $\Gamma(f)$ onto M^m is $\pi(\Gamma(f)) = C$, and for $\bar{a} \in C$, the fiber $(\Gamma(f))_{\bar{a}} = \{f(\bar{a})\}$ has Euler characteristic 1. Thus $E(\Gamma(f)) = E(C)$.
Applying the same fact to f^{-1}, we see that $E(\Gamma(f^{-1})) = E(D)$. The graphs $\Gamma(f)$ and $\Gamma(f^{-1})$ only differ by a permutation of coordinates, so

$$E(C) = E(\Gamma(f)) = E(\Gamma(f^{-1})) = E(D).$$

□

Corollary 5.2.11. *If $A \subseteq M^n$ is definable, $a \in A$, then there is no definable bijection from A to $A \setminus \{a\}$.*

5.3 Dimension from Algebraic Closure

In this section, we return to $\mathcal{M}$ being an arbitrary $\mathcal{L}$-structure for a bit.

Definition 5.3.1. Fix $A \subseteq M$.
Say $b \in M$ is A-*definable* when $\{b\}$ is. Define the *definable closure* of A to be the set

$$\mathrm{dcl}(A) = \{b : b \text{ is } A\text{-definable}\}.$$

Say $b \in M$ is A-*algebraic* when there is a finite A-definable set B with $b \in B$. Define the *algebraic closure* of A to be the set

$$\mathrm{acl}(A) = \{b : b \text{ is } A\text{-algebraic}\}.$$

Trivially, $\mathrm{dcl}(A) \subseteq \mathrm{acl}(A)$.

Exercise 5.3.2. Suppose $\mathcal{M} \vDash \mathsf{VS}_K$ for some field K. Then for $A \subseteq M$,

$$\mathrm{dcl}(A) = \mathrm{acl}(A) = \mathrm{Span}_K(A).$$

Exercise 5.3.3. Suppose $\mathcal{M} \vDash \mathsf{ACF}$. Then for $A \subseteq M$, $\mathrm{acl}(A)$ is the algebraic closure of the subfield generated by A.

Lemma 5.3.4. *If $\mathcal{M}$ is an ordered structure and $A \subseteq M$, then* $\mathrm{dcl}(A) = \mathrm{acl}(A)$.

Proof. If $b \in \mathrm{acl}(A)$, let B be the finite A-algebraic set containing b. Enumerate B as $b_1 < b_2 < \cdots < b_m$ with $b = b_k$, and suppose B is defined by $\phi(x, \bar{a})$ with $\bar{a} \in A^n$. Then $\{b_i\}$ is defined by

$$\exists y_1, \ldots, y_m, \bigwedge_{i=1}^{m} \phi(y_i; \bar{a}) \wedge \bigwedge_{i=1}^{m-1} y_i < y_{i+1} \wedge x = y_k.$$

□

5.3.1 Pregeometries

In what follows, we will use some standard shorthand for model theory. If A is a set, and a an element, Aa denotes $A \cup \{a\}$. Similarly, if $\bar{a}$ is a tuple, $A\bar{a}$ is $A \cup \{a_1, \ldots, a_n\}$. We may also just use a instead of $\{a\}$ or $\bar{a}$ instead of $\{a_1, \ldots, a_n\}$ in contexts where it is clear we must mean a set.

Definition 5.3.5. Given a set X, call a function $\mathrm{cl} : \mathcal{P}(X) \to \mathcal{P}(X)$ *a closure operator* when

- $\forall A \subseteq X, A \subseteq \mathrm{cl}(A)$
- $\forall A \subseteq B \subseteq X, \mathrm{cl}(A) \subseteq \mathrm{cl}(B)$
- $\forall A \subseteq X, \mathrm{cl}(\mathrm{cl}(A)) = \mathrm{cl}(A)$.

Call a closure operator cl *finitary* when

$$\forall A \subseteq X, \mathrm{cl}(A) = \bigcup_{A_0 \subseteq A \text{ finite}} \mathrm{cl}(A_0).$$

If cl is a finitary closure operator, call (X, cl) a *pregeometry* when it satisfies the *exchange property*: If $a, b \in X$, $A \subseteq X$, and $a \in \mathrm{cl}(Ab) \setminus \mathrm{cl}(A)$, then $b \in \mathrm{cl}(Aa)$.

Fact 5.3.6. *In any structure,* dcl *and* acl *are finitary closure operators.*

Exercise 5.3.7. Prove that $\forall A \subseteq X, \mathrm{dcl}(\mathrm{dcl}(A)) = \mathrm{dcl}(A)$, and that both $\mathrm{dcl}, \mathrm{acl}$ are finitary.

We can define independence and dimensions in pregeometries in analogy to linear algebra:

Definition 5.3.8. Let (X, cl) be a pregeometry.
Call a set $B \subseteq X$ *independent* when $\forall, b \in B$, $b \notin \mathrm{cl}(B \setminus \{b\})$.
Call a maximal independent set $B \subseteq X$ a *basis*.

The proof of this is essentially the same as the classic linear algebra proof for span, but abstracted:

Fact 5.3.9. *If* (X, cl) *is a pregeometry, then*

- X *contains a basis* B
- *If* B *is a basis,* $\mathrm{cl}(B) = X$
- *If* B_1, B_2 *are bases, then* $|B_1| = |B_2|$.

This allows us to define dimension:

Definition 5.3.10. Define the *dimension* of a pregeometry (X, cl) to be $\dim(X) = |B|$, where B is an arbitary basis.

We can define dimensions on subsets by relativizing the closure, as if $A \subseteq X$, $(A, C \mapsto \mathrm{cl}(C) \cap A)$ is also a pregeometry.

5.3.2 Back to Minimality

Our main example for a pregeometry is span in a vector space, which is also given by dcl or acl, which we know to be finitary closure operators in general.

We can generalize this, with the exchange property, to strongly minimal theories, including ACF:

Lemma 5.3.11. *If T is a strongly minimal theory and $\mathcal{M} \vDash T$, show that (M, acl) is a pregeometry.*

Proof. Suppose $A \subseteq M$, $a, b \in M$, $b \in \mathrm{acl}(Aa) \setminus \mathrm{acl}(A)$. If we name all of A as constants, then $\mathcal{M}$ is still strongly minimal, and $\mathrm{acl}(Aa) = \mathrm{acl}(a)$, while $\mathrm{acl}(A) = \mathrm{acl}(\emptyset)$, so we may then assume $A = \emptyset$.
We now search for a finite b-definable set containing a.
There is thus some formula $\phi(x, y)$ and some $n \in \mathbb{N}$ such that $\mathcal{M} \vDash \phi(a, b)$ and

$$|\{a' \in M : \mathcal{M} \vDash \phi(a', b)\}| = n.$$

Then let $\psi(y)$ be the formula indicating that there are exactly n values of x satisfying $\phi(x, y)$.
As $\mathcal{M} \vDash \phi(a, b) \wedge \psi(b)$, if the set defined by $\phi(a; y) \wedge \psi(y)$ is finite, we are done, so assume it is cofinite, with complement of size m. We can let $\chi(x)$ be the formula that states that there are exactly m values of y for which $\phi(x, y) \wedge \psi(y)$ is false. As $\mathcal{M} \vDash \chi(a)$ and $a \notin \mathrm{acl}(\emptyset)$, we may assume that χ defines a cofinite set, and derive a contradiction.
Let $a_1, \ldots, a_{n+1}$ satisfy $\mathcal{M} \vDash \chi(a_1)$, and for each i, let

$$B_i = \{b' \in M : \mathcal{M} \vDash \phi(a_i, y) \wedge \psi(y)\}.$$

Then $\bigcap_i B_i$ is a finite intersection of cofinite sets, and thus cofinite, so let $b_0 \in \bigcap_i B_i$. This gives a contradiction, as for each i, $\mathcal{M} \vDash \phi(a_i, b_0)$, but $\mathcal{M} \vDash \psi(b_0)$ indicates that there can be only n such values. □

This is hugely important to the study of strongly minimal structures, largely due to the following fact:

Fact 5.3.12. *If T is a complete strongly minimal theory and $\mathcal{M}, \mathcal{N} \vDash T$, then there is an isomorphism $f : M \to N$ if and only if $\dim(M) = \dim(N)$.*

Corollary 5.3.13. *The theory VS_K is κ-categorical for infinite $\kappa > |K|$, and for each p including 0, ACF_p is κ-categorical for $\kappa > \aleph_0$.*

We now return to o-minimality:

Theorem 5.3.14. *If $\mathcal{M}$ is o-minimal, then (M, acl) is a pregeometry.*

Proof. For consistency with strong minimality, we refer to this as acl, but we will rely on the fact that this is the same as dcl.
Suppose $A \subseteq M$, $a, b \in M$, $b \in \mathrm{dcl}(Aa) \setminus \mathrm{dcl}(A)$. If we name all of A as constants, $\mathcal{M}$ is still o-minimal, so assume $A = \emptyset$ again.
Let $\phi(x, y)$ be such that $\phi(x, a)$ defines $\{b\}$. Then $\phi(x, y) \wedge \exists! y, \phi(x, y)$ defines a partial function $f : D \to M$ with D a definable set and $f(a) = b$.
By monotonicity, there are $c_1 < \cdots < c_k$ such that on each interval (c_i, c_{i+1}) (with $c_0 = -\infty, c_{k+1} = +\infty$) f is either undefined, increasing, decreasing, or constant.
If we assume k is minimal, we can show that $\{c_1, \ldots, c_k\}$ is definable, so if $a = c_i$, then $a \in \mathrm{acl}(\emptyset) = \mathrm{dcl}(\emptyset)$, from which we can derive a contradiction that $b \in \mathrm{dcl}(\emptyset)$.
If $a \in (c_i, c_{i+1})$ with f constant on that interval, then $f = b$ on that whole interval. Then the set of values that f takes on an open interval is definable, and finite, so $b \in \mathrm{acl}(\emptyset)$, another contradiction.

Thus we can assume $a \in (c_i, c_{i+1})$ and that WLOG f is increasing on that interval. Then as c_i, c_{i+1} are definable, $f|_{(c_i,c_{i+1})}$ is definable, so by switching the variables in the defining formula, the inverse function g is definable as well. As $a = g(b)$, $a \in \mathrm{dcl}(Ab)$. $\square$

We can now compare this to the dimension based on cells.

Lemma 5.3.15. *If $\mathcal{M}$ is o-minimal, $D \subseteq M^n$, and $\bar{a} \in D$, then $\dim(\bar{a})$, defined as the dimension of $\{a_1, \ldots, a_n\}$, satisfies $\dim(\bar{a}) \leq \dim(D)$.*

Proof. Let C be a cell with $\bar{a} \in C \subseteq D$. Then as $\dim(C) \leq \dim(D)$, it suffices to show that $\dim(\bar{a}) \leq \dim(C)$.
We show this by induction on n, where this is trivial with $n = 0$. Suppose this works up to n, consider $\bar{a} \in C \subseteq M^n$ and $b \in M$ such that $(\bar{a}, b) \in \Gamma_C(f)$ or $(\bar{a}, b) \in (f, g)_C$.
If $(\bar{a}, b) \in \Gamma_C(f)$, then $b = f(\bar{a})$, so $b \in \mathrm{dcl}(\bar{a})$, so

$$\dim(\bar{a}, b) = \dim(\bar{a}) \leq \dim(C) = \dim(\Gamma_C(f)).$$

Meanwhile if $(\bar{a}, b) \in (f, g)_C$, then $\dim(\bar{a}, b) \leq \dim(\bar{a}) + 1$ in general, so

$$\dim(\bar{a}, b) \leq \dim(\bar{a}) + 1 \leq \dim(C) + 1 = \dim((f, g)_C).$$

$\square$

The converse is more difficult, as we would *like* to be able to say that every definable set D, there is some $\bar{a}$ with $\dim(\bar{a}) = \dim(D)$. We call such a tuple *generic*. It suffices to show this for cells, which requires an inductive step where if $\bar{a} \in C$ is generic, and f, g are definable functions with $(f, g)_C$ a cell, then there is $b \in (f(\bar{a}), g(\bar{a}))$ such that $(\bar{a}, b)$ is generic in $(f, g)_C$. This means having dimension $\dim(\bar{a}) + 1$, which is equivalent to $b \notin \mathrm{dcl}(\bar{a})$. We can do this as long as for every open interval I, there is some point in $I \setminus \mathrm{dcl}(\bar{a})$. This is not *necessarily* true for $\mathcal{M}$, but we *can* find that point in some elementary extension $\mathcal{M} \preceq \mathcal{N}$.

Fact 5.3.16. *If $\mathcal{M}$ is o-minimal, and $\phi(\bar{x}, \bar{b})$ is a formula with $\bar{b} \in M^n$ defining $D \subseteq M^m$ with dimension $\dim(D) = d$, then there is some elementary extension $\mathcal{N} \succeq \mathcal{M}$ and $\bar{a} \in M^m$ with $\mathcal{M} \vDash \phi(\bar{a}, \bar{b})$ such that $\dim(\bar{a}) = d$.*

Thus by going to an elementary extensions, we can find generic points, and define dimension in terms of them. This tends to be the preferred way of defining and using dimension in model theory in these structures.

Chapter 6

Combinatorics

6.1 Shattering and VC Dimension

We now start to examine the *combinatorics* of definable sets in o-minimal and other nice structures. This will start with some combinatorics that we will largely define outside the context of definable sets, but with definable families of sets in mind.

Definition 6.1.1. Let X be a set, and let $\mathcal{F}$ be a family of subsets of X. If $A \subseteq X$ is a subset of X, then we define

$$\mathcal{F} \cap A = \{S \cap A : S \in \mathcal{F}\}.$$

We say that $\mathcal{F}$ *shatters* A if $\mathcal{F} \cap A$ is the whole powerset of A.
Call the largest d such that $\mathcal{F}$ shatters a set of size d the *VC-dimension* of $\mathcal{F}$. If there's no such d, we say the VC-dimension of $\mathcal{F}$ is ∞.

Consider $X = \mathbb{R}$, $\mathcal{F}$ is the set of intervals. We can easily shatter any set of size ≤ 2, but suppose $A = \{a_1 < a_2 < a_3\}$. In this case, $\{a_1, a_3\} \notin \mathcal{F} \cap A$, because if $\{a_1, a_3\} \subseteq I \cap A$ for some interval I, $a_2 \in I \cap A$ as well. Thus A is not shattered, and we can deduce that the VC-dimension of $\mathcal{F}$ is 2.

Exercise 6.1.2. For the following families of sets, what is the VC-dimension of $\mathcal{F}$?

- X is infinite, and $\mathcal{F}$ is the set of subsets of X of size at most d (where d is some natural number)
- $X = \mathbb{R}^2$, $\mathcal{F}$ is the set of half-planes - one side of a line
- $X = \mathbb{R}^2$, $\mathcal{F}$ is the set of convex sets (a set S is convex when any line segment containing two points of S is also contained in S)
- $X = \mathbb{R}^2$, $\mathcal{F}$ is the set of axis-aligned rectangles (sides are parallel to x- and y-axes)
- $X = \mathbb{R}^d$, $\mathcal{F}$ is the set of half-spaces (a half-space is the the solution set of an inequality $a_1x_1 + \cdots + a_dx_d \leq c$ for some numbers $a_1, \ldots, a_d, c$)

Hint: See Radon's Theorem below.

Our prototypical examples of set families are *definable* ones. (Perhaps I should say *uniformly definable*, but this is the only kind of definability we care about for a family of sets.) That is, start

with a structure $\mathcal{M}$ and a formula $\phi(\bar{x}, \bar{y})$ with $|\bar{x}| = m$, $|\bar{y}| = n$. If $\bar{b} \in M^n$, we let $\phi(M, \bar{b}) = \{\bar{a} \in M^m : \mathcal{M} \vDash \phi(\bar{\dashv}, \bar{\rfloor})\}$. Then let $\mathcal{F}_\phi$ be $\{\phi(M, \bar{b}) : \bar{b} \in M^n\}$ be a family of subsets of M^m.

With a bit of work, we can see that

Exercise 6.1.3. Which of the following families are definable?

- $X = \mathbb{R}$, $\mathcal{F}$ is the set of intervals
- X is infinite, and $\mathcal{F}$ is the set of subsets of X of size at most d (where d is some natural number)
- $X = \mathbb{R}^2$, $\mathcal{F}$ is the set of half-planes - one side of a line
- $X = \mathbb{R}^2$, $\mathcal{F}$ is the set of convex sets (a set S is convex when any line segment containing two points of S is also contained in S)
- $X = \mathbb{R}^2$, $\mathcal{F}$ is the set of axis-aligned rectangles (sides are parallel to x- and y-axes)
- $X = \mathbb{R}^d$, $\mathcal{F}$ is the set of half-spaces (a half-space is the the solution set of an inequality $a_1x_1 + \cdots + a_dx_d \leq c$ for some numbers $a_1, \ldots, a_d, c$)

6.1.1 Shatter Functions

We can also measure a degree of shattering with the *shatter function*. Define

$$\pi_{\mathcal{F}}(A) = |\mathcal{F} \cap A|$$

and for $n \in \mathbb{N}$,

$$\pi_{\mathcal{F}}(n) = \max_{|A|=n} |\mathcal{F} \cap A|.$$

Note that $\mathcal{F}$ shatters a set of size n if and only if $\pi_{\mathcal{F}}(n) = 2^n$.

Return to the case of $X = \mathbb{R}$ with $\mathcal{F}$ the set of intervals. Then the first few values of $\pi_{\mathcal{F}}(n)$ are $1, 2, 4, 7$. To calculate $\pi_{\mathcal{F}}(n)$ in general, let $A = \{a_1 < \cdots < a_n\}$, and consider an interval I. Without changing $I \cap A$, we can assume $I = (b, c)$, and note that all that matters is which gaps b, c lie in in the set A. As there are $n + 1$ such gaps, and to get a nonempty intersection with A, we must choose b, c from two different gaps, and there are $\binom{n+1}{2}$ ways to do this, each of which will give a different intersection with A. Including the empty set gives us $\pi_{\mathcal{F}}(n) = \binom{n+1}{2} + 1$, matching our observations. For large n, this quadratic polynomial is vastly smaller from 2^n.

Exercise 6.1.4. Let $X = \mathbb{R}^2$, and let $\mathcal{F}$ be the set of half-planes. Calculate $\pi_{\mathcal{F}}(A)$ where A consists of n points arranged around a circle.

Exercise 6.1.5. Suppose X is a set and $\mathcal{F}$ is a finite set of subsets of X, with $|\mathcal{F}| = N$. What can we say about the shatter function $\pi_{\mathcal{F}}(n)$?

Dual Set Families

We can turn around any set family $\mathcal{F}$ on a set X, and get a new set system, called its *dual*.

Definition 6.1.6. Let $\mathcal{F}^*$, the dual of $\mathcal{F}$, be the set family on the set $\mathcal{F}$, consisting of the sets

$$\mathcal{F}^* = \{\{S \in \mathcal{F} : x \in S\} : x \in X\}.$$

If $\mathcal{F}$ is defined by $\phi(\bar{x}, \bar{y})$, then $\mathcal{F}^*$ is defined by the formula $\phi^*(\bar{y}, \bar{x})$ obtained by rearranging the variables.

The dual shatter function $\pi^*_{\mathcal{F}}(n) = \pi_{\mathcal{F}^*}(n)$ essentially denotes the maximum number of nonempty pieces in the Venn diagram created by n sets in $\mathcal{F}$.

If we look at the case of X being a disk, and $\mathcal{F}$ denoting all intersections of X with a half-plane, then this describes the *lazy caterer's problem*, as $\pi^*_{\mathcal{F}}(n)$ is the maximum number of pieces that n lines can cut a disk (or a cake) into.

Exercise 6.1.7. Show that if $\mathcal{F}$ has finite VC-dimension, then so does $\mathcal{F}^*$, and vice versa. Specifically, if we know that $\mathcal{F}$ has VC-dimension at most d, what do we know about the VC-dimension of $\mathcal{F}^*$?

6.2 Sauer-Shelah

In the lazy caterer's problem, and in the case of the family of intervals, it looks like $\pi_{\mathcal{F}}(n) = 2^n$ for a little while, but eventually this fails, because the VC-dimension of this class is finite. In both of these cases, this function turns out to be a polynomial. It won't always necessarily be *exactly* a polynomial, but we can bound it by one.

To calculate this bound, let's start by defining a new family of sets, which we can count more easily: If $\mathcal{F}$ is a family of subsets of X, let $\mathrm{SH}(\mathcal{F})$ be the set of subsets of X shattered by $\mathcal{F}$.

Lemma 6.2.1. *Suppose $\mathcal{F}$ has VC-dimension at most d, and X is finite with $|X| = n$. Then $|\mathrm{SH}(\mathcal{F})| \leq \binom{n}{\leq d} = \sum_{i=0}^{d} \binom{n}{i}$. This bound is tight, as we can see in the case where $\mathcal{F} = \{A \subseteq X : |A| \leq d\}$.*

Proof. In general, we see that $\mathrm{SH}(\mathcal{F}) \subseteq \{A \subseteq X : |A| \leq d\}$, which has size $\binom{n}{\leq d}$. □

This same bound turns out to also bound the shatter function.

Lemma 6.2.2 (Sauer-Shelah)**.** *Let $\mathcal{F}$ be a family of subsets of X with VC-dimension at most d. Then $\pi_{\mathcal{F}}(n) \leq \binom{n}{d}$.*

There are a few interesting proofs in the literature. Let's follow the path through *Pajor's Lemma*, which implies Sauer-Shelah by the observation that if we view $\mathcal{F} \cap A$ as a family of subsets of A, it must have VC-dimension at most that of $\mathcal{F}$, and for some A with $|A| = n$, $\pi_{\mathcal{F}}(n) = |\mathcal{F} \cap A|$.

Lemma 6.2.3 (Pajor)**.** *If X is finite, then $\mathcal{F}$ shatters at least $|\mathcal{F}|$ sets, so $|\mathcal{F}| \leq |\mathrm{SH}(\mathcal{F})|$.*

Proof. We prove this by induction on $|X|$. This is trivial if $X = \emptyset$, so assume it works for $|X| \leq n$, and prove it for $|X| = n + 1$.
Let $X = Y \cup \{a\}$, with $a \notin Y$. Then we'll define two new set families on Y. Let $\mathcal{F}_- = \{S \in \mathcal{F} : a \notin S\}$. Then let $\mathcal{F}_+ = \{S \setminus \{a\} : a \in S \in \mathcal{F}\}$. We have just split $\mathcal{F}$ into two disjoint families, and removed a from the sets that contained it, so $|\mathcal{F}| = |\mathcal{F}_+| + |\mathcal{F}_-|$. The induction hypothesis

tells us that

$$|\mathcal{F}| = |\mathcal{F}_+| + |\mathcal{F}_-| \leq |\mathrm{SH}(\mathcal{F}_+)| + |\mathrm{SH}(\mathcal{F}_-)|.$$

To show that $|\mathrm{SH}(\mathcal{F}_+)| + |\mathrm{SH}(\mathcal{F}_-)| \leq |\mathrm{SH}(\mathcal{F})|$, we first split $\mathrm{SH}(\mathcal{F})$ into two pieces, the shattered sets containing a and the shattered sets not containing a. If $a \notin A \subseteq X$, then $A \subseteq Y$, and if A is shattered by either $\mathcal{F}_+$ or $\mathcal{F}_-$, it is shattered by $\mathcal{F}$. Thus

$$\mathrm{SH}(\mathcal{F}_+) \cup \mathrm{SH}(\mathcal{F}_-) \subseteq \mathrm{SH}(\mathcal{F}) \cap \mathcal{P}(Y).$$

Meanwhile, if $a \in A \subseteq X$, then $\mathcal{F} \cap A$ must be the whole powerset of A. We see that $\mathcal{F}_- \cap A$ must be the powerset of $A \setminus \{a\}$, so $\mathcal{F}_-$ shatters $A \setminus \{a\}$. Meanwhile, $(\mathcal{F} \setminus \mathcal{F}_-) \cap A$ must consist of all subsets of A containing a, and if we remove a from all of these sets, we see that $\mathcal{F}_+$ shatters $A \setminus \{a\}$. Thus the shattered sets A containing a are exactly those for which $A \setminus \{a\}$ is in $\mathrm{SH}(\mathcal{F}_+) \cap \mathrm{SH}(\mathcal{F}_-)$, and we conclude that

$$|\mathrm{SH}(\mathcal{F}) \setminus \mathcal{P}(Y)| = |\mathrm{SH}(\mathcal{F}_+) \cap \mathrm{SH}(\mathcal{F}_-)|$$

Adding these, we see that

$$|\mathrm{SH}(\mathcal{F})| \geq |\mathrm{SH}(\mathcal{F}_+) \cup \mathrm{SH}(\mathcal{F}_-)| + |\mathrm{SH}(\mathcal{F}_+) \cap \mathrm{SH}(\mathcal{F}_-)| = |\mathrm{SH}(\mathcal{F}_+)| + |\mathrm{SH}(\mathcal{F}_-)|.$$

□

Exercise 6.2.4. Let X be a set, and let $\mathcal{F}_1, \mathcal{F}_2$ be two different families of subsets of X, each with finite VC-dimension. Let $\mathcal{F}$ be the set of all sets $S_1 \cap S_2$ where $S_1 \in \mathcal{F}_1$ and $S_2 \in \mathcal{F}_2$. Show that $\mathcal{F}$ has finite VC-dimension.
What other families of sets can you build out of $\mathcal{F}_1$ and $\mathcal{F}_2$ and get the same shatter function bound?

6.3 NIP

We've seen that in a structure $\mathcal{M}$, a formula $\phi(\bar{x}, \bar{y})$ with $|\bar{x}| = m, |\bar{y}| = n$ defines a family $\mathcal{F}$ of subsets of M^m indexed by M^n.

We call the formula $\phi(\bar{x}, \bar{y})$ *NIP* when $\mathcal{F}$ has finite VC-dimension, and call the structure $\mathcal{M}$ NIP when *every* formula $\phi(\bar{x}, \bar{y})$ is NIP. In turn, we call a theory T NIP when every *model* $\mathcal{M} \models T$ is NIP.

We will develop some tests for showing that formulas and theories are NIP. It turns out that these provide the vast majority of set families with finite VC-dimension, even for the other fields (combinatorics, statistical learning theory) that use this dimension.

The first few of these lemmas can be stated and proven at the level of just set families $\mathcal{F}$, but it will sometimes be convenient for us to use the notation of formulas.

Lemma 6.3.1. *If $\phi(\bar{x}, \bar{y})$ is NIP, so is $\neg\phi(\bar{x}, \bar{y})$.*

Proof. This has the effect of replacing each set in $\mathcal{F}$ with its complement, which results in the exact same sets being shattered. □

Lemma 6.3.2. *If $\phi(\bar{x}, \bar{y}), \psi(\bar{x}, \bar{y})$ are both NIP, then so are $(\phi \wedge \psi)(\bar{x}, \bar{y})$ and $(\phi \vee \psi)(\bar{x}, \bar{y})$.*

Proof. Suppose ϕ has VC-dimension d_ϕ and ψ has VC-dimension d_ψ.
For any $A \subseteq M^m$, any set in $\mathcal{F}_{\phi\wedge\psi} \cap A$ can be written as the intersection of a set in $\mathcal{F}_\phi \cap A$ with

one in $\mathcal{F}_\psi \cap A$, so

$$|\mathcal{F}_{\phi\wedge\psi} \cap A| \leq |\mathcal{F}_\phi \cap A||\mathcal{F}_\psi \cap A| \leq \binom{|A|}{d_\phi}\binom{|A|}{d_\psi},$$

and this bound is polynomial of degree $d_\phi + d_\psi$ in $|A|$. For large enough $|A|$, this is less than $2^{|A|}$, so A cannot be shattered.
The same proof applies to $\phi \vee \psi$, or we could apply De Morgan's laws and our existing lemmas. □

Corollary 6.3.3. *If T eliminates quantifiers and every atomic formula $\phi(\bar{x}, \bar{y})$ is NIP over T, then so is T.*

Proof. Each formula is equivalent to one constructed from atomic formulas by operations that preserve NIP. □

Beyond this, the most useful test of all is the following:

Theorem 6.3.4. *If every formula $\phi(x; \bar{y})$ with $|x| = 1$ is NIP, then so is T.*

The proof of this requires a decent amount of Ramsey theory, in the form of a model theorist's favorite gadgets, *indiscernible sequences*. Perhaps we'll return to the proof at some point, but for now, let's use this to get some examples:

Theorem 6.3.5. *If T is o-minimal, then T is NIP.*

Proof. It's enough to check formulas $\phi(x; \bar{y})$. We know that there is some number N such that all the sets in $\mathcal{F}_\phi$ consist of a union of at most N intervals. Thus it suffices to show that the class $\mathcal{F}_N$ consisting of all finite unions of N intervals has finite VC-dimension. Because finite VC-dimension is closed under taking unions, this reduces to just checking $\mathcal{F}_1$, which we've seen has VC-dimension 2. □

But o-minimal structures aren't the only good examples.

Theorem 6.3.6. *If T is strongly minimal, then T is NIP.*

Proof. If $\phi(x; \bar{y})$ is a formula in a strongly minimal theory, then by compactness, there is some N such that for all $\mathcal{M} \vDash T$, $\bar{b} \in M^n$, $\phi(x; \bar{b})$ has size at most N or has complement of size at most N.
Thus if $A \subseteq M^n$ has size at least $2N + 2$, then $\phi(M, \bar{b}) \cap A$ must have size at most N or at least $|A| - N \geq N + 2$, and thus cannot have size exactly $N + 1$. Thus A cannot be shattered. □

For one very notable non-example, let's consider the random graph.

Theorem 6.3.7. *The random graph is not NIP.*

Proof. In this case, the graph relation itself has infinite VC-dimension. For any finite set A of vertices, and any $B \subseteq A$, we can find a vertex that is adjacent to all of B and none of $A \setminus B$, so A is shattered. □

We can actually show that *any* non-NIP (actually should call this IP, because NIP stands for "not the independence property"...) formula, up to applying compactness, contains a trace of the random graph:

Theorem 6.3.8. *Fix $G = (V, E)$ a countable random graph.*
If $\phi(\bar{x}, \bar{y})$ is not NIP in some theory T, then there is some model $\mathcal{M} \vDash T$ and $\bar{a}_v \in M^m, \bar{b}_v \in M^n$ for all $v \in V$ such that

$$\mathcal{M} \vdash \phi(\bar{a}_v, \bar{b}_w) \iff E(v, w).$$

Proof. For notation's sake, well prove this where $|\bar{x}| = |\bar{y}| = 1$, but the proof is easily adjusted. Extend the language to have constants $(c_v : v \in V), (d_v : v \in V)$. Then extend the theory T to a theory T' by adding sentences $\phi(c_v, d_w)$ for every pair v, w such that $E(v, w)$, and $\neg\phi(c_v, d_w)$ for every pair v, w such that $\neg E(v, w)$.
If T' has a model $\mathcal{M}$, then $\mathcal{M} \vDash T$ and we can let $a_v = c_v^{\mathcal{M}}, b_v = d_v^{\mathcal{M}}$. It thus suffices to show that T' is (finitely) satisfiable.
Given a finite subtheory of T', let V_0 be the set of all v such that c_v appears in the subtheory, and W_0 the set of all w such that d_w appears. Then our theory is contained in $T \cup T_0$ where T_0 consists of all sentences $\phi(c_v, d_w)$ or $\neg\phi(c_v, d_w)$ with $v \in V_0, w \in W_0$.
As ϕ is not NIP, fix some model $\mathcal{M}$, and let $A \subseteq M^m$ be a shattered set of size $|V_0|$, and enumerate it as $(a_v : v \in V_0)$. Then interpret c_v as a_v. Given $w \in W_0$, let $B_w \subseteq A = \{a_v : T' \vDash \phi(c_v, d_w)\}$. Then by our shattering assumption, we can interpret d_w such that $\mathcal{M} \vDash \phi(c_v, d_w)$ when $v \in B_w$, and not when $v \in A \setminus B_w$, as desired. □

6.4 Statistical Consequences of VC-dimension

In order to understand what (beyond Sauer-Shelah) NIP tells us about the combinatorics of a structure, we need to start with some statistical properties, including the Vapnik-Chervonenkis theorem that VC-dimension is named for.

We'll focus at first on finitely-supported probability measures, so as to not worry about measurability. In this context, the results we prove are basically just about set families $\mathcal{F}$ on an arbitrary set X. However, if we want to generalize to more interesting measures, definability will provide a convenient way of ensuring that all the moving parts of the proof are measurable.

Definition 6.4.1. Let μ be a finitely-supported probability measure on a set X, and let $\mathcal{F}$ be a set family on X. Then a finite list/tuple/multiset $a_1, \ldots, a_n$ is an *ε-approximation* to μ with respect to $\mathcal{F}$ if $\forall S \in \mathcal{F}$,

$$\left| \frac{1}{n} |\{i : a_i \in S\}| - \mu(S) \right| \leq \varepsilon.$$

Theorem 6.4.2 (Uniform Law of Large Numbers (Vapnik-Chervonenkis))**.** *For all $\varepsilon, \delta > 0$ and $d \in \mathbb{N}$, there exists $n \in \mathbb{N}$ such that if $\mathcal{F}$ has VC-dimension at most d, and μ is a finitely supported probability measure, both on X, and $x_1, \ldots, x_n$ are i.i.d. random samples from X, drawn according to μ, then*

$$\mathbb{P}_{\bar{x}} \left[\sup_{S \in \mathcal{F}} \left| \frac{1}{n} |\{i : x_i \in S\}| - \mu(S) \right| > \varepsilon \right] < \delta,$$

so with high probability, $x_1, \ldots, x_n$ is an ε-approximation.

Proof. It suffices to find, for fixed d, a bounding function $B(n)$ such that

$$\mathbb{E}_{\bar{x}}\left[\sup_{S\in\mathcal{F}}\left|\frac{1}{n}|\{i : x_i \in S\}| - \mu(S)\right|\right] \leq B(n)$$

for all appropriate choices of $\mathcal{F}, \mu$, with $\lim_{n\to\infty} B(n) = 0$. Then we can just choose n large enough that $B(n) < \varepsilon\delta$.

Let χ_S be the indicator function for S. Then we can redescribe $|\{i : x_i \in S\}|$ as $\sum_{i=1}^n \chi_S(x_i)$, and indeed, there's a way to generalize this whole setup to functions $f : X \to [0,1]$ in place of just characteristic functions $\chi_S : X \to \{0,1\}$.

Similarly, we can calculate $\mu(S)$ by picking a new random sample:

$$\mu(S) = \mathbb{E}_y\left[\chi_S(y)\right] = \mathbb{E}_{\bar{y}}\left[\frac{1}{n}\sum_{i=1}^n \chi_S(y_i)\right].$$

Now the expression we're trying to bound becomes

$$\begin{aligned}\mathbb{E}_{\bar{x}}\left[\sup_{S\in\mathcal{F}}\left|\frac{1}{n}\sum_{i=1}^n \chi_S(x_i) - \mathbb{E}_{\bar{y}}\left[\frac{1}{n}\sum_{i=1}^n \chi_S(y_i)\right]\right|\right] &\leq \mathbb{E}_{\bar{x}}\left[\sup_{S\in\mathcal{F}}\mathbb{E}\left[\left|\frac{1}{n}\sum_{i=1}^n(\chi_S(x_i) - \chi_S(y_i))\right|\right]\right] \\ &\leq \frac{1}{n}\mathbb{E}_{\bar{x},\bar{y}}\left[\sup_{S\in\mathcal{F}}\left|\sum_{i=1}^n(\chi_S(x_i) - \chi_S(y_i))\right|\right],\end{aligned}$$

where our last step used the general principle that $\sup\mathbb{E} \leq \mathbb{E}\sup$.

We can call this quantity the *expected discrepancy* between samples $\bar{x}$ and $\bar{y}$. To bound it more effectively, we leverage the symmetry between $\bar{x}$ and $\bar{y}$. If we were to swap x_i and y_i for a given i, it would not change the expected discrepancy, but it would replace $(\chi_S(x_i) - \chi_S(y_i))$ with $-(\chi_S(x_i) - \chi_S(y_i))$, so we know that multiplying that expression by -1 doesn't change the overall answer. Now suppose $\sigma \in \{-1,+1\}^n$, and say we swap x_i and y_i when $\sigma_i = -1$ and leave them be when $\sigma_i = +1$. We haven't changed the expected value, but can rewrite it as

$$\frac{1}{n}\mathbb{E}_{\bar{x},\bar{y}}\left[\sup_{S\in\mathcal{F}}\left|\sum_{i=1}^n \sigma_i(\chi_S(x_i) - \chi_S(y_i))\right|\right].$$

We can now use even more randomness, and generate σ by a series of n coin flips to choose whether to flip each pair of variables separately. This distribution on σ is called the *Rademacher distribution*, and we then find that our expected discrepancy equals

$$\frac{1}{n}\mathbb{E}_{\bar{x},\bar{y},\sigma}\left[\sup_{S\in\mathcal{F}}\left|\sum_{i=1}^n \sigma_i(\chi_S(x_i) - \chi_S(y_i))\right|\right].$$

We can then use the triangle inequality and split the two tuples of variables, using the fact also that $-\sigma$ has the same distribution as σ:

$$\begin{aligned}\frac{1}{n}\mathbb{E}_{\bar{x},\bar{y},\sigma}\left[\sup_{S\in\mathcal{F}}\left|\sum_{i=1}^n \sigma_i\chi_S(x_i) - \sum_{i=1}^n \sigma_i\chi_S(y_i)\right|\right] &\leq \frac{1}{n}\mathbb{E}_{\bar{x},\bar{y},\sigma}\left[\sup_{S\in\mathcal{F}}\left|\sum_{i=1}^n \sigma_i\chi_S(x_i)\right| + \left|\sum_{i=1}^n \sigma_i\chi_S(y_i)\right|\right] \\ &\leq \frac{1}{n}\mathbb{E}_{\bar{x},\sigma}\left[\sup_{S\in\mathcal{F}}\left|\sum_{i=1}^n \sigma_i\chi_S(x_i)\right|\right] + \frac{1}{n}\mathbb{E}_{\bar{y},\sigma}\left[\sup_{S\in\mathcal{F}}\left|\sum_{i=1}^n \sigma_i\chi_S(y_i)\right|\right] \\ &= 2\frac{1}{n}\mathbb{E}_{\bar{x},\sigma}\left[\sup_{S\in\mathcal{F}}\left|\sum_{i=1}^n \sigma_i\chi_S(x_i)\right|\right].\end{aligned}$$

We call this last quantity (except for the factor of 2) the *Rademacher complexity*. It turns out the only randomness we need for this to go to 0 is in σ, so we can bound this in turn by the *worst-case Rademacher complexity*:

$$\mathcal{R}_{\mathcal{F}}(n) = \sup_{\bar{x}} \mathcal{R}_{\mathcal{F}}(\bar{x}) = \sup_{\bar{x}} \frac{1}{n}\mathbb{E}_\sigma \left[\sup_{S\in\mathcal{F}} \left| \sum_{i=1}^n \sigma_i \chi_S(x_i) \right| \right].$$

If we fix $\bar{x}$, instead of taking a sup over $S \in \mathcal{F}$, we can let $A = \{x_1, \ldots, x_n\}$ and take a sup over $S \cap A \in \mathcal{F} \cap A$.
As we know that $|\mathcal{F} \cap A| \leq \binom{n}{\leq d}$, we can apply the following to $\mathcal{F} \cap A$:

Fact 6.4.3 (Massart's Lemma)**.** *There is a constant C such that if $|X| = n$ and $\mathcal{F}$ is finite, then*

$$\frac{1}{n}\mathbb{E}_\sigma \left[\sup_{S\in\mathcal{F}} \left| \sum_{i=1}^n \sigma_i \chi_S(x_i) \right| \right] \leq C\sqrt{\frac{\log|\mathcal{F}|}{n}}.$$

We then find that

$$\frac{1}{n}\mathbb{E}_\sigma \left[\sup_{S\in\mathcal{F}} \left| \sum_{i=1}^n \sigma_i \chi_S(x_i) \right| \right] \leq C\sqrt{\frac{\log\binom{n}{\leq d}}{n}} = \mathcal{O}\left(\sqrt{\frac{\log n^d}{n}}\right) = \mathcal{O}\left(\sqrt{\frac{\log n}{n}}\right),$$

and the limit of this is indeed 0. □

6.5 PAC Learning

For an application of VC-Dimension, let's look at learning theory.

Let's fix a set X, with a set family $\mathcal{F}$, and a finitely supported probability measure μ on X.

I'm thinking of a secret set $S \in \mathcal{F}$, and you'd like to guess S. In order to you to make your guess, we get to pick n random points in X, and I have to tell you if they're in S. It's unlikely that your guess will be correct - there may be infinitely many sets in $\mathcal{F}$ that would give the same answer! However, it'll be good enough if your guess is *approximately* correct - but what's a good notion of error?

We're going to say that the error of a guess S' is the probability that a random point in X will give a different answer between S and S'. That is - it's the probability of getting a point in the *symmetric difference* $S\Delta S' = (S \setminus S') \cup (S' \setminus S)$. We have to decide how much of an error we're ok accepting - say we pick some $\varepsilon > 0$, and we'll say you're *approximately correct* when the probability of $S\Delta S'$ is at most ε.

We also can't completely guarantee that you're approximately correct, because you could just get really unlucky with the randomly-selected points. So we'll settle for *probably approximately correct* learning - we pick some $\delta > 0$, and you're doing well if you can be approximately correct with probability $\geq 1 - \delta$.

This depends on δ, ε, and the source of random points, but we'll say $\mathcal{F}$ can be PAC learned when for every δ, ε, there is some number n of guesses that'll work, regardless of the source of random points.

6.5.1 Error Family

Tomorrow, we'll show that every family with finite VC-dimension can be PAC learned, and we'll even give an upper bound on the number of samples we need. To do that, we're going to look first

at another related family - the *error family* of deviations from my secret set.

Definition 6.5.1. Given $\mathcal{F}$, and $S \in \mathcal{F}$, define $\Delta(S) = \{S' \Delta S : S' \in \mathcal{F}\}$.

Exercise 6.5.2. Show that if $A \subseteq X$, that $\mathcal{F}$ shatters A if and only if $\Delta(S)$ shatters A, and conclude that $\Delta(S)$ and $\mathcal{F}$ have the same VC-dimension.

We'll see that if we understand the shatter function of a set family, then any random sample of enough points is (with high probability) going to intersect any large (high probability) sets in the family. Applying this logic to the error family, we see that in the PAC learning setup, there's a high probability that our random sample will notice any large error sets, allowing us to avoid them and be approximately correct.

6.5.2 PAC Learning Lower Bound

What does PAC learning have to do with shattering and VC-dimension? Suppose $\mathcal{F}$ shatters a set $\{x_1, \ldots, x_d\}$. We're going to see that this situation makes $\mathcal{F}$ hard to learn. More specifically, we're going to see that it makes learning hard for *some probability distribution* - namely, when we choose points uniformly from $\{x_1, \ldots, x_d\}$.

In this situation, the error is $\frac{1}{d}|(S\Delta S') \cap \{x_1, \ldots, x_d\}|$. In particular, you only need to get a similar intersection with $\{x_1, \ldots, x_d\}$, so we could just assume $\mathcal{F}$ *is* the power set of $\{x_1, \ldots, x_d\}$.

We're going to see that if we shoot for error less than $\varepsilon \leq \frac{1}{8}$ with probability $\delta \leq \frac{1}{8}$, then no matter what your guessing procedure is, you'll have a bad probability of being approximately correct. I'm going to choose a set in $\mathcal{F}$ uniformly at random, and we'll see that there's a high probability you're not doing well.

Suppose you try to guess my random set from $\frac{d}{2}$ data points. These data points are also random, so there's a chance of repetition - say we actually get $m \leq \frac{d}{2}$ distinct points. So, maybe you know whether $x_1, \ldots, x_m$ are in my set, but you have no info at all about the rest of the d points, so you get each of them wrong or right by coin flip. On average, you'll get $\frac{d-m}{2} \geq \frac{d}{4}$ of them wrong, so your average error is at least $\frac{1}{4}$. But what's the probability that your error is more than $\frac{1}{8}$?

Suppose the probability the error is more than $\frac{1}{8}$ is P. No matter what, the error is at most 1. So the average is at most $\frac{1}{8}(1-P) + P \leq \frac{1}{8} + P$, but we know the average is at least $\frac{1}{4}$, so $P \geq \frac{1}{8}$.

Because this is the *average* chance of error over all of my choices for $S \in \mathcal{F}$, there must be one of them that's at least this hard to guess! This tells us that to PAC learn $\mathcal{F}$, you need at least $\frac{d}{2}$ data points. If $\mathcal{F}$ has infinite VC-dimension, you'll never get there.

6.5.3 PAC Learning Upper Bound and Epsilon Nets

Meanwhile, if $\mathcal{F}$ has finite VC-dimension, your strategy will be simple: just guess some S' compatible with all n random data points. There's not much else you can do. There always will be at least one - my secret set S. We want to find out the probability that the n random data points are good enough that you're guaranteed to be approximately correct if you follow them.

If we know that $\mathcal{F}$ has VC-dimension at most d, and we fix $\varepsilon, \delta > 0$, then we sample n data points, where n (depending only on d, ε, δ) is large enough that with probability at least $1 - \delta$, our sample $(x_1, \ldots, x_n)$ is a $\frac{\varepsilon}{2}$-approximation to $\Delta(S)$, which also has VC-dimension at most d.

Then our PAC learning algorithm is simple: given the sample $x_1, \ldots, x_n$, and the information of $\{i : x_i \in S\}$, we choose any $S' \in \mathcal{F}$ with $|\{i : x_i \in S'\} \Delta \{i : x_i \in S\}| < \frac{\varepsilon n}{2}$. Then with high

probability we can assume $(x_1, \ldots, x_n)$ is a $\frac{\varepsilon}{2}$-approximation, so

$$\left|\mu(S\Delta S') - \frac{1}{n}|\{i : x_i \in S'\}\Delta\{i : x_i \in S\}|\right| < \frac{\varepsilon}{2},$$

and thus $\mu(S\Delta S') < \varepsilon$.

6.6 Definable Graphs

We now shift the "set family" model of definable relations a bit to focus on definable bipartite graphs. For us, bipartite graphs will have their two parts labelled:

Definition 6.6.1. A *bipartite graph* consists of (V, W, E), where V, W are sets and $E \subseteq V \times W$.
Such a graph is *definable* in some structure $\mathcal{M}$ when V, W, E are definable sets. (Frequently we will just consider $V = M^m, W = M^n$.)

We can state Ramsey's theorem in this context:

Fact 6.6.2. *For any $k \in \mathbb{N}$, there is a number $n \in \mathbb{N}$ such that if (V, W, E) is any bipartite graph with $|V|, |W| \geq n$, then there is an induced subgraph $(A, B, E \cap (A \times B))$ (which we abbreviate as (A, B, E)) with $|A| = k, |B| = k$, such that either $E \cap (A \times B) = \emptyset$ or $E \cap (A \times B) = A \times B$.*

This tells us that somewhere in a graph, there is structure. However, in general, n is vastly larger than k, so even if we were able to break an entire graph up into structured pieces of this size, we would need an enormous amount of them to understand the graph in a structured way. It will turn out that we can do better in the context of definable graphs in NIP or o-minimal structures.

6.6.1 Zarankiewicz's Problem

Ramsey's theorem tells us that in an arbitrary graph, there are subgraphs of a certain size that are either complete (cliques) or have no edges (anticliques). To specify our study of what's happening here, let's rule out one of these cases, by excluding cliques of some fixed size.

Definition 6.6.3. Call a bipartite graph $K_{s,t}$*-free* when there are no sets $A \subseteq V, B \subseteq W$ with $|A| = s, |B| = t$ such that the induced subgraph $(A, B, E \cap (A \times B))$ is complete ($A \times B \subseteq E$). Let the *Zarankiewicz number* $Z_{s,t}(m, n)$ be the largest that $|E|$ can be if $|V| = m, |W| = n$ and (V, W, E) is $K_{s,t}$-free.

Zarankiewicz's problem simply asks how big $Z_{s,t}(m, n)$ is, asymptotically in m, n, for fixed s, t.

Fact 6.6.4 (Kővarí-Sós-Turán)**.** *If we fix s, t, then*

$$Z_{s,t}(m, n) = O(mn^{1-1/s} + n).$$

You may ask - what does this have to do with VC-dimension? We can always look at (V, W, E) as a family of sets on V defined by $\{\{v \in V : (v, w) \in E\} : w \in W\}$, or analogously, a family of sets on W, which is its dual. We can then use VC-dimension to improve the Kővarí-Sós-Turán bound:

Fact 6.6.5 ([7])**.** *Let (V, W, E) be a finite graph with VC-dimension (or VC-density) at most d, with $|V| = m, |W| = n$. Then*

$$|E| = O(mn^{1-1/d} + n).$$

By VC-density, I mean the following quantity, which is bounded by VC-dimension by Sauer-Shelah:

Definition 6.6.6. Given a set family $\mathcal{F}$, let the *VC-density* of $\mathcal{F}$ be the infimum of all d such that $\pi_{\mathcal{F}}(n) = O(n^d)$, or phrased differently,

$$\limsup_{n\to\infty} \frac{\log \pi_{\mathcal{F}}(n)}{\log n}.$$

6.7 NIP Regularity

We will now work up to the most general structural theorem we can say about definable graphs in NIP structures.

Lemma 6.7.1 (Related to Haussler's Packing Lemma)**.** *Let (V, W, E) be a bipartite graph of VC-dimension at most d, let μ be a finitely supported measure on V. Then for every $\varepsilon > 0$, there is n only depending on ε, d such that W can be partitioned into sets $Y_1, \ldots, Y_n$ such that for $w, w' \in Y_i$, $\mu(E(V, w)\Delta E(V, w')) < \varepsilon$.*
Furthermore, if (V, W, E) are all definable, with E definable by $\phi(x, y)$, then the sets Y_i are definable by a formula only depending on ϕ and n.
Also, we will not fully prove this, but $n = O(\varepsilon^{-C})$ for a constant C depending only on d.

Proof. Let $\mathcal{F}$ be the family of subsets of V given by $E(V, w)\Delta E(V, w')$ for $w, w' \in W$. This also has finite VC-dimension, with a bound d' we can calculate in terms of d. Thus we can find a ε-approximation to μ over $\mathcal{F}$, which we call $A = \{v_1, \ldots, v_m\} \in V$.
Now for each $S \subseteq A$, let Y_S be the subset of W defined by $\{w \in W : E(v, w) \iff v \in S\}$. The number of nonempty such sets is at most $\binom{m}{\leq d}$ by Sauer-Shelah, so for the polynomial bound, suffices to improve our earlier bounds to show that we could have chosen m polynomial in ε^{-1}.
Now if we fix S and let $w, w' \in Y_S$, then for all $v \in A$, $v \notin E(V, w)\Delta E(V, w')$. Thus

$$\mu(E(V, w)\Delta E(V, w')) \leq \frac{1}{m}|\{i : v_i \in E(V, w)\Delta E(V, w')\}| + \varepsilon.$$

□

Theorem 6.7.2 (NIP Regularity)**.** *Let (V, W, E) be a bipartite graph of VC-dimension at most d, let μ be a finitely supported measure on V, and let ν be a finitely supported measure on W. For all $\varepsilon > 0$, there is some set D which is a finite union of disjoint rectangles $A \times B$ for $A \subseteq V, B \subseteq W$ such that*

$$\mu \times \nu(E\Delta D) < \varepsilon.$$

Furthermore, the number of rectangles is polynomial in ε^{-1} if d is fixed.

Proof. Partition W into $Y_1, \ldots, Y_n$ as above. For each i, choose some $w_i \in Y_i$. Then let $D = \bigcup_{i=1}^n E(V, w_i) \times Y_i$.
Then we calculate $\mu \times \nu(E \Delta D)$, we partition it as

$$\begin{aligned}
\mu \times \nu(E \Delta D) &= \sum_{i=1}^n \mu \times \nu((E \Delta D) \cap Y_i) \\
&= \sum_{i=1}^n \int_{w \in Y_i} \mu(E(V, w) \Delta D(V, w))\, d\nu \\
&= \sum_{i=1}^n \int_{w \in Y_i} \mu(E(V, w) \Delta E(V, w_i))\, d\nu \\
&\leq \sum_{i=1}^n \int_{w \in Y_i} \varepsilon\, d\nu \\
&= \varepsilon \sum_{i=1}^n \nu(Y_i) \\
&= \varepsilon.
\end{aligned}$$

□

This tells us that, on *most* of these rectangles $A \times B$, E is *very close to* either $\emptyset$ or $A \times B$. Not quite Ramsey's theorem, but as close as we can get in the general NIP context. To prove something closer to Ramsey in the o-minimal context, we'll need to know that o-minimal structures are *distal*.

6.8 Distal Theories

The following definition could make sense at the level of set families, but we will want to modify it in the specific case of formulas:

Definition 6.8.1. If $\phi(\bar{x}; \bar{y})$ is an $\mathcal{L}$-formula and $\mathcal{M}$ an $\mathcal{L}$-structure, then an *abstract cell decomposition* for ϕ is a function $\mathcal{T}$ that given a finite set $B \subseteq M^{|\bar{y}|}$ of parameters, returns a cover $\mathcal{T}(B)$ of $M^{|\bar{x}|}$ with *cells* such that for each $\Delta \in \mathcal{T}(B)$, and each $\bar{b} \in B$, Δ is *not crossed by* $\phi(x; \bar{b})$, meaning that the formula $\phi(x; \bar{b})$ is either true on all of Δ or false on all of Δ.

One way of building an abstract cell decomposition is just to construct a cell Δ_S for each $S \subseteq B$ consisting of all $\bar{a} \in M^{|\bar{x}|}$ such that for $\bar{b} \in B$,

$$\mathcal{M} \vDash \phi(\bar{a}; \bar{b}) \iff \bar{b} \in S.$$

When we do this, frequently some of the cells Δ_S will be empty, so we can skip them. If $\phi^*(\bar{y}, \bar{x})$ is the dual formula of ϕ, then the number of nonempty cells is exactly $\pi_{\phi^*}(B)$. This is minimal:

Lemma 6.8.2. *For any abstract cell decomposition $\mathcal{T}$, $|\mathcal{T}(B)| \geq \pi_{\phi^*}(B)$.*

Proof. Each cell of $\mathcal{T}(B)$ must be a subset of exactly one Δ_S in the above construction. □

The only issue preventing us from using this cell decomposition for more interesting applications is that the definitions of the cells could be arbitrarily complicated. Each one is defined as the intersection of $|B|$ definable sets. We will want them to be uniformly definable:

Definition 6.8.3. Call an abstract cell decomposition $\mathcal{T}$ a *distal cell decomposition* when the cells are uniformly definable in the following sense: there exist formulas $\psi(\bar{x}; \bar{y}_1, \ldots, \bar{y}_k)$ and $\theta(\bar{y}; \bar{y}_1, \ldots, \bar{y}_k)$ such that for each B,

$$\mathcal{T}(B) = \{\psi(M; \bar{b}_1, \ldots, \bar{b}_k) : \forall \bar{b} \in B, \mathcal{M} \vDash \neg\theta(\bar{b}; \bar{b}_1, \ldots, \bar{b}_k)\}.$$

Basically, ψ uniformly defines the shape of the cells, and θ says when to exclude ψ based on an additional $\bar{b} \in B$. The most basic example of that rule is when $\theta(\bar{b}; \bar{b}_1, \ldots, \bar{b}_k)$ indicates that $\phi(\bar{x}; \bar{b})$ crosses $\psi(M; \bar{b}_1, \ldots, \bar{b}_k)$.

Technically, we're allowed to use a finite collection of formulas ψ to define the cells, but this doesn't make a difference as long as $|B| \geq 2$.

Definition 6.8.4. A theory T is *distal* if every formula $\phi(\bar{x}; \bar{y})$ admits a distal cell decomposition.

Theorem 6.8.5. *Any distal theory is NIP.*

Proof. Suppose $\phi(\bar{x}; \bar{y})$ has a distal cell decomposition $\mathcal{T}$, defined by $\psi(\bar{x}; \bar{y}_1, \ldots, \bar{y}_k)$. Then for any finite B,

$$\pi_{\phi^*}(B) \leq |\mathcal{T}(B)| \leq |B|^k,$$

so ϕ^* can only shatter B with $2^{|B|} \leq |B|^k$. □

This depended on putting a polynomial bound on the number of cells in a distal cell decomposition:

Definition 6.8.6. Given a formula $\phi(\bar{x}; \bar{y})$, say a distal cell decomposition $\mathcal{T}$ has *exponent* d if $|\mathcal{T}(B)| \leq |B|^d$. Call the *distal density of* ϕ the infimum of all d such that there exists a distal cell decomposition of exponent d.

Fact 6.8.7. *If every formula $\phi(x; \bar{y})$ with $|x| = 1$ has a distal cell decomposition, then T is distal.*

See [1] for a construction of distal cell decompositions with more variables.

Theorem 6.8.8. *Any o-minimal theory T is distal.*

Proof. Given $\phi(x; \bar{y})$, there is some uniform bound on the number of intervals of $\phi(M; \bar{b})$, say it's k. Then the intervals of $\phi(M; \bar{b})$ divide M into at most $2k + 1$ intervals, consisting of the connected components of both $\phi(M; \bar{b})$ and its complement. We can write down formulas such that $\psi_i(x; \bar{b})$ denotes the ith interval of that sequence.

Then for $B \subseteq M^{|\bar{y}|}$, we can construct a cell decomposition $\mathcal{T}(B)$ consisting of all atoms in the boolean algebra generated by the intervals of each separate set $\phi(M; \bar{b})$ for $\bar{b} \in B$. Each such cell will be an interval, which is the intersection of a collection of intervals defined by $\psi_i(x; \bar{b})$ for different $\bar{b} \in B$. However, an intersection of an arbitrary collection of intervals can be written as the intersection of only two of those intervals, with the maximum left endpoint and the minimum right endpoint. Thus our cells are all defined by some formula $\psi_i(x; \bar{b}_1) \cap \psi_j(x; \bar{b}_2)$, and we want to use one of these cells exactly when it is not crossed by any other $\phi(x; \bar{b})$. This gives us finitely

many uniform definitions, and there are standard tricks to find one formula that can handle all $(2k+1)^2$ cases of (i,j). $\square$

The inductive construction for distal cell decompositions for formulas with more variables strongly resembles the construction of the familiar o-minimal cell decomposition.

The important thing for combinatorial applications is that the formula *defining the cells in our decomposition* is itself NIP. This allows us to prove, for instance, the *distal cutting lemma*:

Theorem 6.8.9 (Distal Cutting Lemma [4])**.** *Given a distal theory T and a formula $\phi(\bar{x};\bar{y})$ with a distal cell decomposition whose cells are defined by $\psi(\bar{x};\bar{y}_1,\ldots,\bar{y}_k)$ of exponent d, for any finitely-supported measure ν on $M^{|\bar{y}|}$ and real $r>1$, the family $\{\phi(x;\bar{b}) : \bar{b}\in M^{|\bar{y}|}\}$ admits a $\frac{1}{r}$-*cutting *over ν of size $t=O(r^d)$:*
A cover $\Delta_1,\ldots,\Delta_t$ of $M^{|\bar{x}|}$ such that for each Δ_i, the set of $\bar{b}$ such that Δ_i is crossed by $\phi(x;\bar{b})$ has ν-measure at most ε.

Proof. We'll outline a construction that doesn't quite get this bound.
Let the distal cell decomposition $\mathcal{T}$ be defined by $\psi(\bar{x};\bar{y}_1,\ldots,\bar{y}_k)$ and $\theta(\bar{y};\bar{y}_1,\ldots,\bar{y}_k)$. Find a $\frac{1}{r}$-approximation to μ over θ, call it B. Then let our $\Delta_1,\ldots,\Delta_t$ can be $\mathcal{T}(B)$, with $t=O(|B|^d)$, which can be made quite close to $O(r^d)$.
For each $\vec{b}=(\bar{b}_1,\ldots,\bar{b}_k)$ such that $\psi(M;\vec{b})=\Delta_i\in\mathcal{T}(B)$, we have that $B\cap\theta(M;\vec{b})=\emptyset$, so $\nu(\theta(M;\vec{b}))<\frac{1}{r}$. $\square$

We can use this to improve Zarankiewicz's problem:

Theorem 6.8.10 ([4], or [7] for the semialgebraic case:)**.** *Let (V,W,E) be a definable graph, where E has dual VC-density d and is defined by $\phi(\bar{x};\bar{y})$, with distal density t. Assume (V,W,E) is $K_{s,s}$-free.*
Then for finite $A\subseteq V, B\subseteq W$ with $|A|=m, |B|=n$,

$$|E\cap(A\times B)| = O\left(m^{\frac{(t-1)d}{td-1}}n^{\frac{(d-1)t}{td-1}}+m+n\right).$$

Proof. Essentially, apply Kővarí-Sós-Turán on each piece of an ε-cutting, for optimally chosen ε, and then add up the resulting edges. $\square$

For a concrete example of what this buys us:

Theorem 6.8.11 (Szemerédi-Trotter)**.** *Given a set P of m points and a set L of n lines in $\mathbb{R}^2$, if E is the* incidence graph *consisting of edges (p,ℓ) with $p\in\ell$, then*

$$|E\cap(P\times L)| = O\left(m^{2/3}n^{2/3}+m+n\right).$$

Proof. This graph is $K_{2,2}$-free, as no two distinct lines go through the same pair of points.
We can view L as a subset of $\mathbb{R}^2$ consisting of parameters for the lines (in say, slope-intercept form) at which point this graph becomes a definable subset of $\mathbb{R}^2\times\mathbb{R}^2$. Then it suffices to bound d and t by 2. $\square$

We can also prove a quantitatively better version of Ramsey's theorem:

Theorem 6.8.12 (Definable Strong Erdős-Hanjal Property)**.** *Given a definable graph (V, W, E) in a distal structure, for any $0 < \beta < \frac{1}{2}$, there is $\alpha > 0$ such that for any measures μ on V, ν on W, there are definable (with definitions not depending on μ, ν) subsets $A \subseteq V, B \subseteq W$ with $\mu(A) \geq \alpha, \nu(B) \geq \beta$ such that $A \times B \subseteq E$ or $E \cap (A \times B) = \emptyset$.*

Proof. Let E be defined by $\phi(\bar{x}; \bar{y})$ have a distal cell decomposition of exponent d.
Fix r to be determined later, and let $\Delta_1, \ldots, \Delta_t$ be a $\frac{1}{r}$-cutting over ν, and recall that we can choose $t = O(r^d)$. At least one Δ_i must satisfy $\mu(\Delta_i) \geq \frac{1}{t}$, let $A = \Delta_i$. Now let D be the set of all $\bar{b} \in M^{|\bar{y}|}$ such that $\phi(\bar{x}; \bar{b})$ does not cross A, and note that $\nu(D) \geq 1 - \frac{1}{r}$. Then we can partition D into two sets based on whether $\phi(\bar{x}; \bar{b})$ is true on all of A or false on all of Δ_i, let B be the one with larger ν-measure, so $\nu(B) \geq \frac{1}{2} - \frac{1}{2r}$.
If r is chosen such that $\beta = \frac{1}{2} - \frac{1}{2r}$, and $\alpha = \frac{1}{r^d}$, then we are done. □

If we iterate this repeatedly, we can prove the following structure theorem:

Theorem 6.8.13 (Distal Regularity [5])**.** *Given a definable graph (V, W, E) in a distal structure, for every $\varepsilon > 0$, there exists n such that for any measures μ on V, ν on W, we can partition V into $X_1, \ldots, X_n$ and W into $Y_1, \ldots, Y_n$, such that for some set $\Sigma \subseteq [n]^2$ of* bad indices*, we have both*

- $\sum_{i,j} |\mu(X_i)\nu(Y_j)| \leq \varepsilon$
- *If $(i, j) \notin \Sigma$, then either $X_i \times Y_j \subseteq E$ or $(X_i \times Y_j) \cap E = \emptyset$.*

Chapter 7

Bonus Material

This chapter consists of material that will be covered a bit out of order with the other chapters. Most of it is material that I would include in a first class on "pure" rather than "applied" model theory, and some of it is here as a prerequisite to some of the student presentation papers.

7.1 Saturated Models

If the focus on this class had been on "pure" rather than "applied" model theory, one of the first things I would have done would have been to introduce *types* and *type spaces*. For more information on these, I recommend [9, Chapter 4] or eventually a deep dive into [15], but as a prerequisite for some of the student presentations, I'd like to introduce us to one consequence of type-based model theory: saturated models.

First, let's state one consequence of compactness:

Lemma 7.1.1. *Let $\mathcal{M}$ be an $\mathcal{L}$-structure and let $A \subseteq M$. Suppose Σ is a set of formulas $\phi(x, \bar{a})$ with $\bar{a} \in A^n$ and $|x| = 1$ that is* finitely satisfiable*, in that any finite subset Σ_0 is* realized in M*: there is $b \in M$ such that for all $\phi(x, \bar{a}) \in \Sigma_0$, $\mathcal{M} \vDash \phi(b, \bar{a})$.*
Then there is an elementary extension $\mathcal{N} \succeq \mathcal{M}$ such that Σ is realized in N: there is $b \in N$ such that $\mathcal{N} \vDash \phi(b, \bar{a})$ for all $\phi \in \Sigma$.

Proof. Analogously to the atomic diagram, there is a theory $\mathrm{Diag}_{\mathrm{el}}$ in a language with added constants for the elements of M whose models are precisely *elementary* extensions of $\mathcal{M}$.
Add to this language an additional constant c, and the sentences $\phi(c, \bar{c}_{\bar{a}})$ for $\phi(x, \bar{a}) \in \Sigma$. This theory is finitely satisfiable because Σ is, so it is satisfiable. We can let $\mathcal{N}$ be any model of this, with b the interpretation $c^{\mathcal{N}}$. □

We call a finitely satisfiable collection of sentences like this a *partial 1-type with parameters in A*. Many applications of compactness can be boiled down to realizing types like this, and rather than keep referring back to an arbitrary elementary extension, we'd like to be able to always use the same one.

Definition 7.1.2. If κ is a cardinal, call a structure $\mathcal{M}$ *κ-saturated* when for all $A \subseteq M$ with $|A| < \kappa$, every partial 1-type Σ with parameters in A is realized.

One can use the saturation property much as we did the various extension properties of Fraïssé limits to prove the following important properties of saturated models, which we can think of as a

much larger cardinality version of finite/countable Fraïssé theory.

Fact 7.1.3. *Let T be a complete theory, and $\mathcal{M} \vDash T$ a κ-saturated model, with $\kappa > |T|$. Then if $\mathcal{N} \vDash T$ satisfies $|N| < \kappa$, there is an elementary embedding $f : N \to M$.*
Also, if $A \subseteq M$ has size $|A| < \kappa$, and $f : A \to B \subseteq M$ is a bijection that preserves the interpretations of all formulas on tuples in A, which we call a partial elementary map*, then f extends to an automorphism of $\mathcal{M}$. (We call this property κ-*homogeneity*.)*

These properties aren't so unfamiliar:

Exercise 7.1.4. If T is an $\aleph_0$-categorical theory (let's say in a finite relational language) whose unique countable model $\mathcal{M}$ is a Fraïssé limit, then $\mathcal{M}$ is $\aleph_0$-saturated.

The usual setting of model theory relies on these ideas. To study a complete theory T, we fix a cardinal κ that is larger than any of the sets we expect to encounter, and then construct a κ-saturated model $\mathcal{M}$, which we call the *monster model*. For more on this step, see [2, 8] or [15, Section 6.1], as choosing κ and constructing $\mathcal{M}$ takes some effort. Sometimes, we will want κ to be an inaccessible, or perhaps even proper-class-sized, in which case any actual set is "small"! Be warned that these sources use definitions and results about types that we have not discussed.

We call any set or model of cardinality $< \kappa$ *small*, and up to isomorphism, we can assume that every small model is an elementary substructure of $\mathcal{M}$. To study T we usually only need to study its small models, and to do that, we just need to study the small elementary substructures of $\mathcal{M}$. Then these are highly symmetric with each other, to the extent that any isomorphism between them extends to an automorphism of $\mathcal{M}$. We can then start equating logical properties with properties of the natural group actions of $\mathrm{Aut}(M/A)$, the group of automorphisms of M fixing a small set $A \subseteq M$.

There are many consequences of this viewpoint, we observe one here:

Fact 7.1.5. *Let $\mathcal{M}$ be a κ-saturated structure, let $A \subseteq M$ be small, and let $D \subseteq \mathcal{M}$ be definable (with parameters). Then D is definable* with parameters in A *if and only if it is fixed setwise under* $\mathrm{Aut}(M/A)$.

Corollary 7.1.6. *If $b \in M$, then $b \in \mathrm{dcl}(A)$ is equivalent to b being a fixed point under $\mathrm{Aut}(M/A)$, and $b \in \mathrm{acl}(A)$ is equivalent to the orbit of b being finite.*

7.2 Elimination of Imaginaries

We have started to see how if $\mathcal{M}$ is sufficiently saturated, and $A \subseteq M$ is small, then studying the action of automorphism groups $\mathrm{Aut}(M/A)$ describes A-definability.

This group action perspective lets us characterize when a definable set is A-definable, but given a definable set $D \subseteq M$, does not provide us with the parameters A. That is, if we look at the group of automorphisms that fixes D setwise, we know it is a supergroup of $\mathrm{Aut}(M/A)$ for any A over which D is A-definable, but we don't know if it is *equal* to any $\mathrm{Aut}(M/A)$. If it is, then to understand when D is fixed setwise by automorphisms, we can just study when A is fixed pointwise, which fits into this sort of Galois-theoretic setup more easily. We call such an ideal A a *canonical parameter*, because D is definable with parameters from A, and this is the best way for that to happen:

Definition 7.2.1. Call a tuple $\bar{a} \in M^n$ a *canonical parameter* for a definable set $D \subseteq M$ when $\sigma \in \mathrm{Aut}(M)$ fixes D setwise if and only if it fixes $\bar{a}$ pointwise.

If canonical parameters don't exist, how can we find them? It turns out, it suffices to find canonical parameters for equivalence classes:

Definition 7.2.2. The complete theory T *eliminates imaginaries* if whenever $E \subseteq M^n \times M^n$ is an $\emptyset$-definable equivalence relation, every equivalence class has a canonical parameter. (Here $\mathcal{M}$ is a monster model.)

Theorem 7.2.3. *If T eliminates imaginaries, then every definable $D \subseteq M$ has a canonical parameter.*

Proof. If D is defined as $\phi(M, \bar{a})$, then we can look at all possible choices of $\bar{a}$ as the equivalence class of $\bar{a}$ under the following relation:

$$\forall z, \phi(z, x) \leftrightarrow \phi(z, y).$$

We can then find a canonical parameter for that equivalence class, which will be a canonical parameter for D. $\square$

One way of eliminating imaginaries is to go and manually add to our structure a new *sort* for each definable quotient M^n/E. The resulting *many-sorted* structure is called $\mathcal{M}^{\mathrm{eq}}$, and does indeed eliminate imaginaries.

Rather than study this structure in full, we will let Ava present on [10], which uses a weaker form of elimination of imaginaries to still expound on enough of this Galois-inspired approach to model theory.

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